FORTRA

Robot Alert
6.03
User Guide

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About Robot Alert

Robot Alert sends messages from any IBM i system, from other Fortra products, and from your own programs. Robot Automated Operations Solution for the IBM i uses Robot Alert to summon an operator whenever the machine needs human assistance.

You must have an alphanumeric device to receive a message from another Fortra product.

Job Status

Robot Schedule, Fortra's automatic computer operator and job scheduler, uses Robot Alert to send messages to devices when important jobs fail. Robot Alert messages that are sent on a regularly-scheduled basis can be set up as Robot Schedule jobs to run automatically.

Reporting

Robot Reports, Fortra’s report manager, can use Robot Alert to page experts if reports contain troubling information. You can also use Robot Alert to e-mail attachments from Robot Reports.

Locate Problems Anywhere in a Network

Robot Autotune, Fortra’s IBM i performance monitoring and tuning package, works with Robot Network, our networking software, to send messages to devices using Robot Alert when problems occur on your network and need attention.

Backup Messages

Robot Save, Fortra’s automatic backup and tape management system, uses Robot Alert to send a message to a device when a tape mount is needed, or when the tape drive fails.

Power Failure Messages

Robot UPS, Fortra’s software for UPS hardware control and power event management, can use Robot Alert to send a message to a device in the middle of the night when a power failure occurs and your IBM i switches to battery power.

Messages and Pages from PCs

Robot Client, Fortra's IBM i-to-client event manager, uses Robot Alert to send messages from PC mail systems to devices.

Answer Messages with Two-Way Paging

Robot Console, Fortra's message management package, used with Robot Network, Fortra's IBM i network control package, can use Robot Alert to page you when there are messages waiting to be answered anywhere on your network. With a two-way device, you can answer the messages right from your device.

Robot Alert is Easy to Use and Install

Robot Alert can use your ECS line, or any communication line, and an IBM-compatible modem or TCP/IP. We take care of the complexities of communications for you. Automatically.

Robot Alert works with any local or national paging service that uses the industry standard computer interface (TAP) for alphanumeric, numeric, and tone devices. Since most modern paging services use this protocol, Robot Alert should work with your present paging service. Robot Alert supports the protocols of more than 90 paging services used in major countries of the world. Robot Alert can also send pages to an email address using Simple Mail Transfer Protocol (SMTP), and email responses using Post Office Protocol, version 3 (POP3). Call us for more information.

Take an Electronic Mailbox with You

Robot Alert turns your device into an electronic mailbox because it is so easy to send a message to a device. Pick the person from your device list and enter the message. That's all you have to do.

Most devices will alert you quietly, by vibrating, when they receive a message. You can receive a Robot Alert message when you're in a meeting, at home, in a customer's office, or just walking around the office.

Communicate Using Multiple Devices and Email

With Robot Alert, you get much more than a phone number on your device. You get an alphanumeric message, up to 1,000 characters long, that can be stored and reviewed later. Plus, you can send pages to an email account, or to paging devices that receive email messages, to send and receive email messages (and attachments) quickly and effectively.

Use a Broadcast List for Automatic Problem Escalation

- As a simple way to page a group of people who always receive the same message.
- As an automatic method of paging the person on duty by entering each person's work schedule into the broadcast list and using Robot Schedule's calendar feature.
- As an automatic problem escalation system to notify people up the chain of command if someone is not responding to an emergency page.

Just code our RBASNDMSG command into your program. The command has only two required parameters, message text and device name.

Have Your Programs Send Messages to Devices when Fast Action is Needed

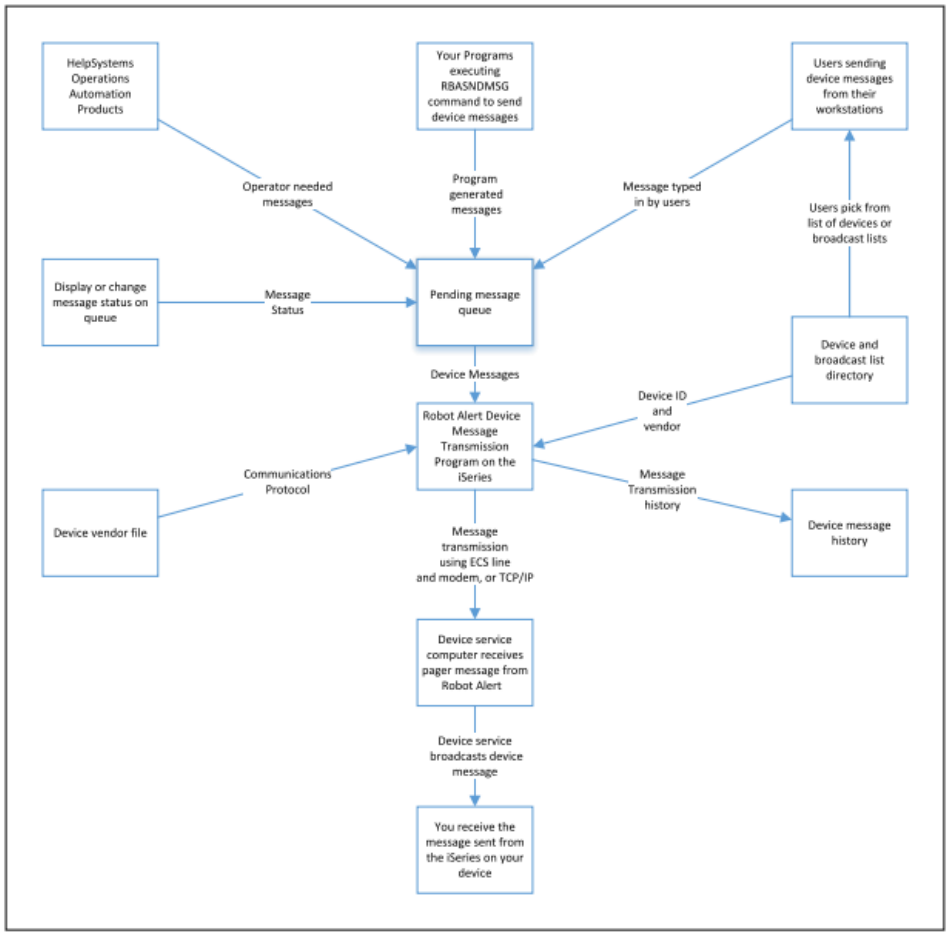
The old way for your program to handle exceptions or errors was to print the exception on an exception report, or send a program error message. The new, more effective way is to have your program send a device message to the responsible person.

Robot Alert makes it very easy for your IBM i to notify your important people when fast action is necessary.

Use SNMP Traps for Notification of IBM i Events and Enterprise Management

Robot Alert supports Simple Network Management Protocol (SNMP) communication. You can use Robot Alert to send one-way SNMP traps to various enterprise monitoring solutions, including CA Unicenter, Tivoli, Netcool, HP OpenView, and Remedy. When you use SNMP communication, an event sent by Robot Alert is configured as an SNMP trap that your enterprise monitor can capture, interpert, and use to respond to IBM i events.

How Robot Alert Works



Five Ways to Send Messages to Devices

There are five ways to send device messages:

- You can send a device message from an IBM i machine by typing a message, or selecting one from a list of standard messages.
- You can send device messages from any MAPI-compatible PC mail system with Robot Client.
- Your program can send device messages using the RBASNDMSG command.
- Fortra Operation Automation Products use Robot Alert to summon an operator whenever the IBM i needs human assistance.
- You can send SNMP traps to Enterprise Monitoring software for notification of IBM i events.

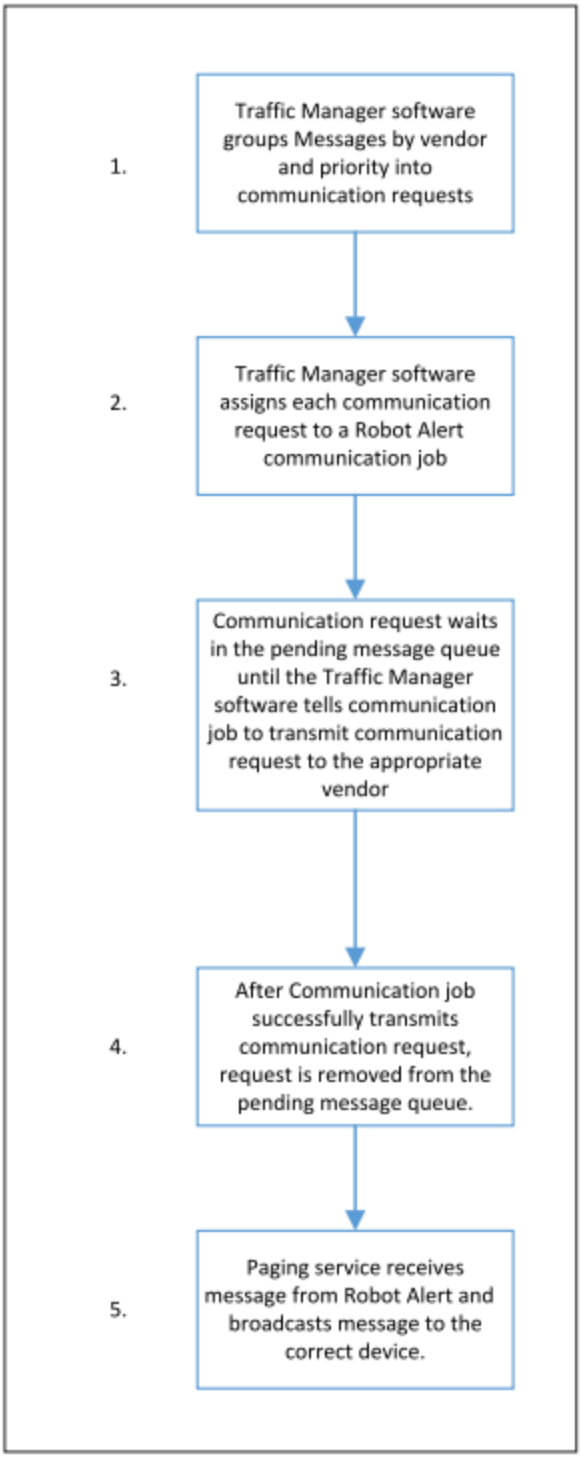
You can send the message to a device, or multiple devices on a broadcast list. The recipients on the broadcast list who get the device message can be determined by time of day, or day of the week. The number of uses for Robot Alert is limited only by your imagination.

Many Device Types and Protocols Supported

Robot Alert allows you to transmit to alphanumeric devices, tone-only devices (devices that only beep or vibrate), and numeric-only devices (devices that show only numbers and special characters).

- Robot Alert supports the protocols of over 90 paging services used in major countries of the world, including the industry standard, Telocator Alphanumeric Protocol (TAP).
- Robot Alert supports some two-way paging protocols to vendors that use a modem connection.
- Robot Alert supports two-way paging for TCP/IP communications.
    - Robot Alert can use your SMTP e-mail server to send pages to an e-mail account, or to paging devices that receive e-mail messages. Then, Robot Alert can use your POP3 server to receive replies to these messages.
    - Robot Alert can also use SNPP to send and receive pager messages using supported vendors.

How Robot Alert Processes Messages



1. The Robot Alert Traffic Manager software groups messages, by vendor and priority, into communication requests.

2. The Robot Alert Traffic Manager software assigns each communication request to a Robot Alert communication job. The communication jobs that transmit messages operate in RBTSLEEPER (the subsystem used by other Robot Automated Operations Products). The controlling program stays in a wait state until it receives a communication request from the Traffic Manager software.

3. The communication job transmits the communication request to the appropriate vendor.

- When a message arrives on the pending message queue, the message transmission program dials the paging service's computer and establishes a communication dialogue. Robot Alert gives the paging service the device ID, the message, and a checksum. If the paging service confirms acceptance of the message, Robot Alert reads the next message in the communication request and repeats the procedure. When there are no messages left, Robot Alert breaks contact with the paging service. All of the dialogue is written to the transmission log, and all of the messages sent are removed from the pending message queue and placed in the message history file.
- For TCP/IP communication using SMTP and POP3, Robot Alert connects to your SMTP e-mail server to send a message to the email address that you provided.
- For TCP/IP communication using SNPP, Robot Alert connects to your SNPP server to send a pager message to the device that you specified.
- For TCP/IP communication using SNMP, Robot Alert sends an SNMP trap to communicate with Enterprise Monitoring software. This communication is one-way, Robot Alert sends the trap to the monitor to notify it of an IBM i event.

4. After the communication job successfully transmits the request, Robot Alert removes the request from the pending message queue.

- Two-way requests stay on the queue until they are answered.
- If a request cannot be sent, it remains on the queue.

You can display the queue to see the status of requests waiting to be sent. You can also display and correct error conditions. If the paging service does not answer Robot Alert's call, or other communication problems occur, Robot Alert tries to re-send the messages. If the problems persist, the administrator is sent a message. The messages remain on the pending message queue until the problems are resolved.

5. After the paging service receives the message from Robot Alert, it broadcasts the message to the correct device.

How Robot Alert Communicates

Within Robot Alert there are two methods of communication, Internet or modem, and different protocols you can use within each method.

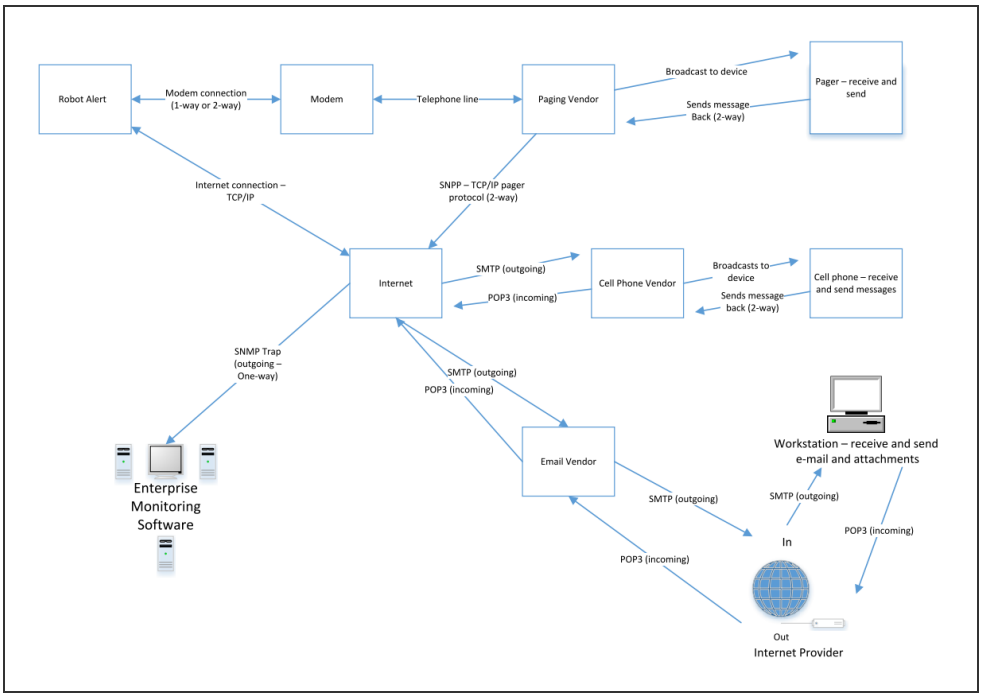
1. Internet communication using TCP/IP:

- Email to workstation or cell phone using SMTP protocol (for outgoing) and POP3 protocol (for incoming, two-way messaging)
- Send messages to/from a pager using SNPP protocol
- Send traps to enterprise Monitoring software using SNMP protocol

2. Phone line and modem communication using a protocol (over 50 to choose from), modem, and pager

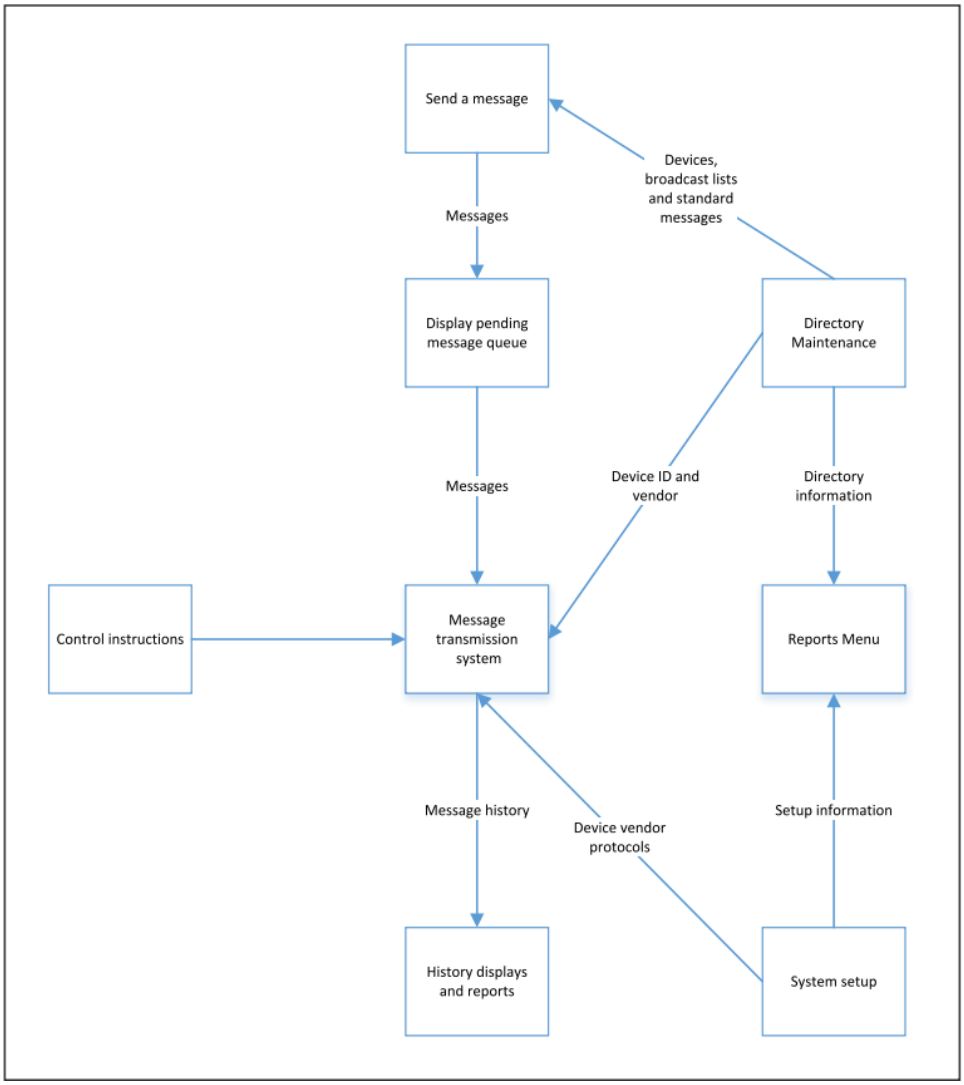
The table and diagram below further illustrate these concepts. For more information about terms, refer to the glossary.

Type of Communication	**Devices**	**Types of Messages**	**Protocols**
TCP/IP (Internet)	Work stations and cell phones Pager Enterprise Monitoring Software	Email (with or without attachments) and messages Alphanumeric and digital SNMF traps	SMTP (outgoing) POP3 (incoming) SNPP (2-way) SNMF (1-way)
Modem (phone line)	Pagers	Alphanumeric and digital	Over 50 to choose from



Robot Alert Administration

The diagram below shows how the pieces of Robot Alert work together and provides an overview of the information in the rest of this User Guide. The message transmission system, shown in the center of the diagram, is described in the topic How Robot Alert Works at the beginning of this User Guide. You use the administration part of Robot Alert to set up and maintain the product so users and programs can send messages.



Send Messages and Display All Pending Messages

The Send a Message option lets you send messages to devices or broadcast lists. The Display All Pending Messages option lets you work with all of the messages currently waiting to transmit. All messages are sent to the pending message queue to await transmission by the message transmission program. As an administrator, you can use this display to determine why a message was not transmitted.

Directory Menu

This menu has three options. The first option lets you create and maintain vendors. The second option lets you maintain the device directory and information about devices. The

third option lets you reduce the amount of typing you have to do by creating broadcast lists containing multiple devices.

Control Menu

From the Control Menu, you control the operation of Robot Alert by starting, stopping, holding, and releasing Robot Alert transmission programs. There is also a display that lets you see the jobs running in RBTSLEEPER, the subsystem used by other Robot Operations Automation products, and whether Robot Alert is running.

History Menu

Robot Alert creates a message history record for every message it creates. You can display this history using five selection options, or use a menu option to delete it. You can also display the Transmission Log, which shows each line of the dialog between Robot Alert and the vendor computer. It helps you troubleshoot communication or vendor dialog problems. You can specify a date range and print (or schedule to print) two reports—Transmission Log, and Message History.

Setup Menu

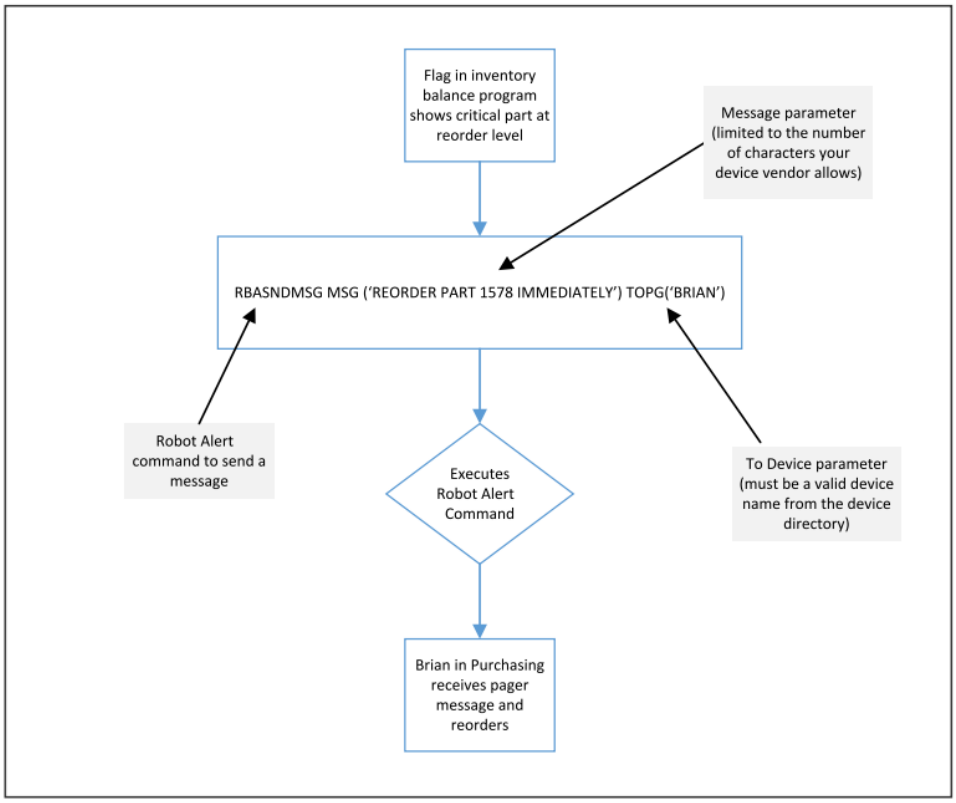
To install Robot Alert, follow the installation instructions included with the software. To set up Robot Alert, use the Setup menu for system defaults, communication job information, security, and standard messages.

Reports Menu

The Reports menu provides history, device, and setup reports. You can submit a report immediately or schedule it on Robot Schedule, Fortra's job scheduler.

Sending A Message From Your Program

You can use Robot Alert for more than just emergency messages. You can code your program to automatically send a message whenever an event requiring immediate action occurs. The example below shows a message being sent automatically to the purchasing agent of a company when the quantity of an important part in inventory drops below a certain level and must be reordered.



The RBASNDMSG Command

The RBASNDMSG command lets you enter a message to be sent by your program to the specified device or broadcast list. To access the prompt panel for the command, type RBASNDMSG at the command line and press **F4**. Press **F10** to display additional parameters.

```
                  Send a Message to a Device (RBASNDMSG)

Type choices, press Enter.

Message Text . . . . . . . . . . > 'Message text here'
                                   ___________________________________________
                                   ___________________________________________
                                   ___________________________________________
                                   ___________________________________________
                                   ___________________________________________
                                   ___________________________________________
                                                                           ...
Device ID or Broadcast List  . .   _________      Character value
Response Required  . . . . . . . > *YES           *SETUP, *YES, *NO
Truncate Message for Vendor  . .   *NO            *YES, *NO
Repeat Limit . . . . . . . . . .   *SETUP         1-9, *SETUP
Minutes Between Repeats  . . . .   *SETUP         1-99, *SETUP


                                                                       Bottom
F3=Exit    F4=Prompt    F5=Refresh    F10=Additional parameters    F12=Cancel
F13=How to use this display         F24=More keys
```

Field Descriptions

Message Text

Enter the message you want to send. The message length is limited to the number of characters your device vendor allows.

Device ID or Broadcast List

Enter the device ID or broadcast list name to which you want to send the message. The device ID or broadcast list you specify must be set up in Robot Alert, and must be spelled the same.

Truncate Message for Vendor

***YES** Messages will be truncated to the maximum length allowed by your vendor. This option is useful for applications that send messages whose length cannot be changed.

***NO** Messages are not truncated (the default). If you use this value and a message exceeds the vendor's maximum length, you will receive an error message.

Response Required

Use the Response Required parameter to specify whether someone must respond to the message.

***SETUP** The RBASNDMSG command uses the defaults specified at system setup. If you're sending to a broadcast list, the values specified when the list was defined are used.

***YES** The message requires a response.

***NO** The message does not require a response.

If you specify *YES or *NO, the values override any default values specified elsewhere.

Repeat Limit and Minutes Between Repeats

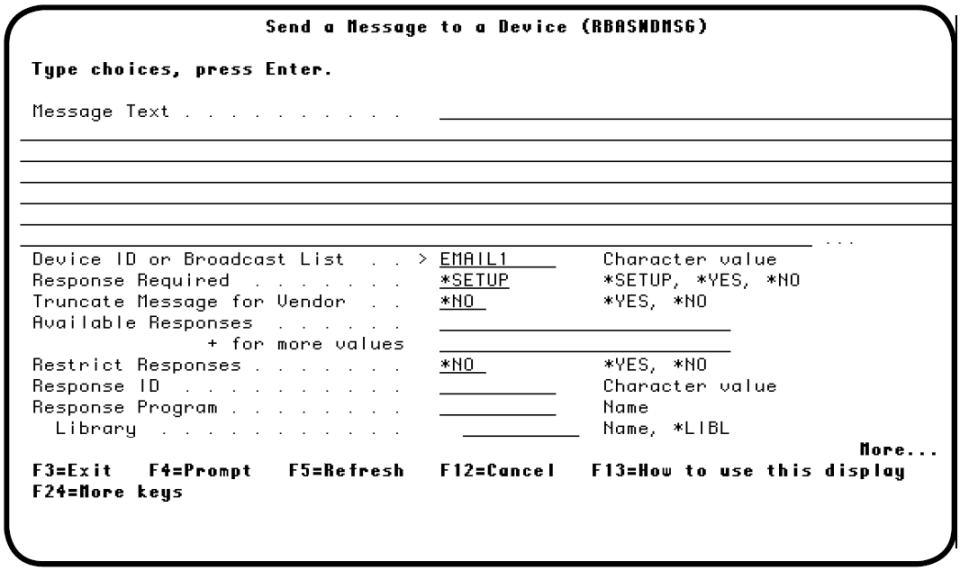
If the message is a response-required message, the Repeat Limit and Minutes Between Repeats parameters appear. *SETUP uses the default values specified at system setup, or when a broadcast list was defined. If you do not want to use these value, do the following:

- Enter a value between **1** and **9**, inclusive, for the number of times the message should be repeated.

- Enter a value between **1** and **99**, inclusive, for the number of minutes between repeats.

The RBASNDMSG Command—Two-Way Paging

If the device you specify on the RBASNDMSG command is associated with a two-way vendor, several more parameters display when you press Enter. The response parameters let you specify how the device will respond to the message and whether you want RBASNDMSG to call a response program that you've written to handle the response.



Response Program

If you're using a response program, enter the following:

- A value identifying this message. When Robot Alert receives a response, it will send this value, the response, and the device that responded, to the response program.
- The program's name and the library where it is located.

Restrict Responses

***YES** Enter if the device must use one of the responses specified in the Available Responses field.

***NO** Enter if the device is not required to use a specified response.

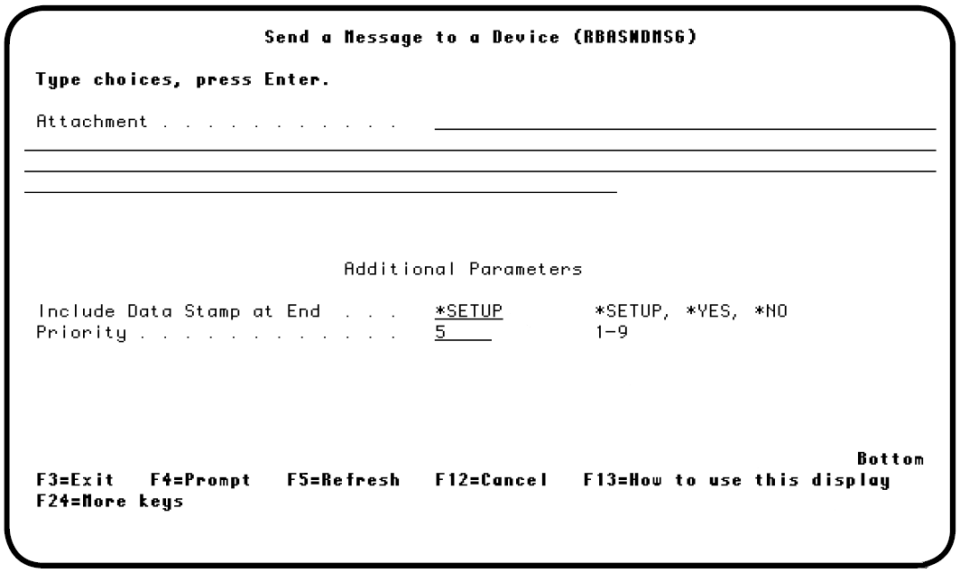
Available Responses

Enter the responses the device can use. Enter a plus sign (+) to display more fields for responses. The number of responses allowed is determined by your paging vendor.

If Truncate = *YES, the message is truncated if the total number of characters in the Available Responses fields and Message field exceed the maximum allowed by your vendor.

The RBASNDMSG Command—Email Attachments

You can designate an IFS file and send it as an email attachment using the Attachment parameter. This parameter is displayed only if the device you selected supports email attachments.



On the attachment field option, you can indicate an IFS file to use as an email attachment to your message. You must specify the full path to the file and you (the sender) must have read authority for the file.

Example:
/financials/reports/3Q2001.PDF

This field is displayed only if the device you have selected accepts email attachments.

For additional parameters, you can specify whether you want to include informational data at the end of your alphanumeric messages. This data includes the date and time sent, and the user who sent the message.

***SETUP** Use your default specifications

***YES** Include the data block

***NO** Do not include the data block

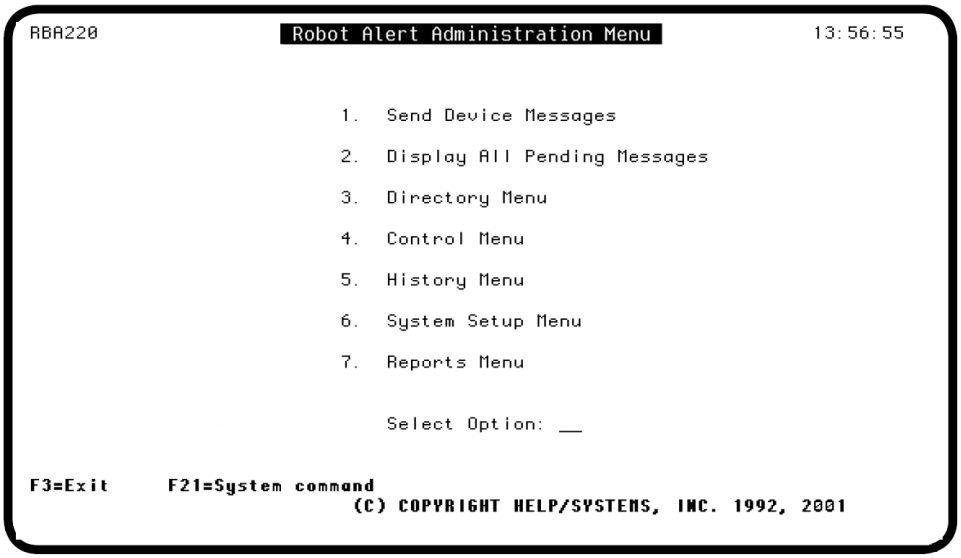
Specifying Yes or No here overrides your default specification.

You can also specify the priority the message should have from 1-9, with 1 being the highest priority.

Robot Alert Administration Main Menu

To access the Robot Alert Administration Menu, enter the command RBTALRLIB/RBTALR.

The Robot Alert Administration Menu is not meant for all users. Limit access to users who are authorized to set up new devices and deal with communication job problems.



Send Device Messages

Sends a message. Refer to the topic Sending a Robot Alert Message to a Device for more information.

Display All Pending Messages

Displays the pending message queue set up on your system and the associated messages.

Directory Menu

Lets you maintain Robot Alert directories, including devices, broadcast lists, and vendors.

Control Menu

Displays Robot Alert's control options. These include starting, stopping, holding, releasing, and displaying the Robot Alert subsystem.

History Menu

Displays Robot Alert's history options, including:

- Displaying message history
- Displaying the transmission log
- Printing a history report
- Deleting history information

System Setup Menu

Displays Robot Alert's system setup options, including:

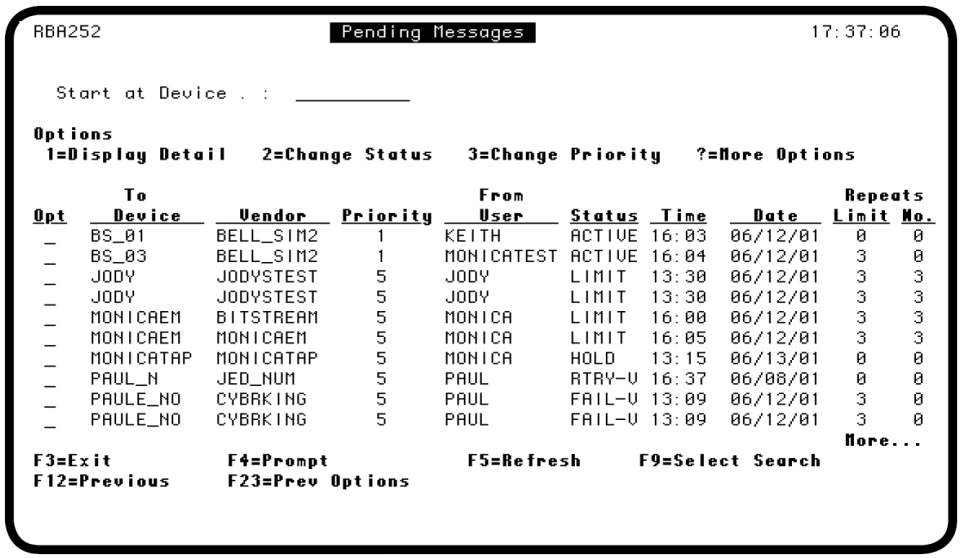
- Maintaining Robot Alert system defaults
- Maintaining communication jobs
- Security
- Standard Messages

Reports Menu

Displays Robot Alert's reporting options, including history, device, and setup reports.

Display All Pending Messages

Select option **2** from the Robot Alert Administration menu to view pending messages. Information about the message appears, including the device where the message is being sent, the device's vendor, the priority level assigned, who sent the message, the message's status, the time and date of the last attempt, and the repeat limits and number of times tried.

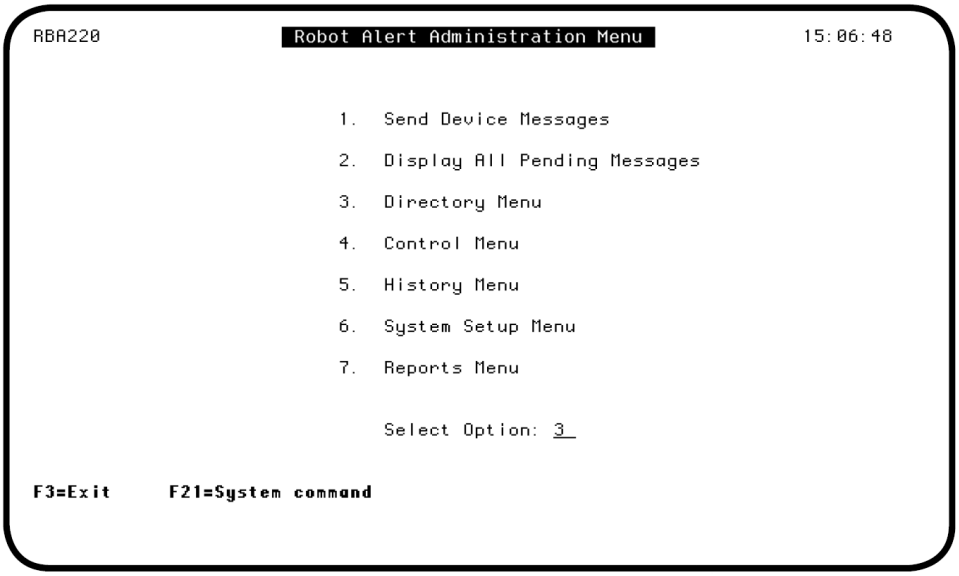


The status of the message. The possible statuses are:

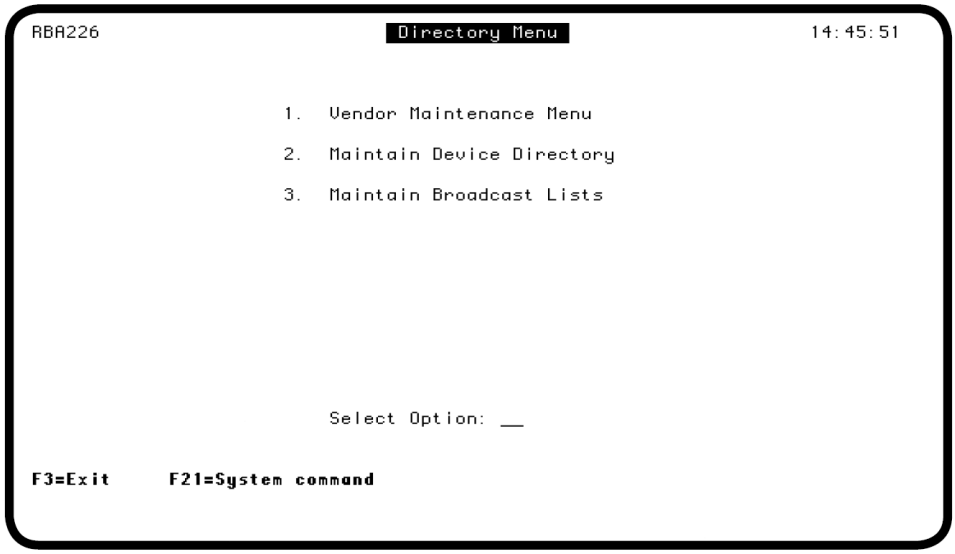
ACK	Response-required message has been acknowledged.
ACTIVE	Message is being sent.
FAIL-V	Didn't connect with vendor, or connected with vendor and failed.
FAIL-P	Device ID rejected by vendor.
FAIL-R	Two-way message failed trying to get a response.
HOLD	Message is on hold. Robot Alert will not send the message nor look for a response.
HOLD-D	Message was sent to a held device.
LIMIT	Repeat limit reached with no response.
READY	Message is ready and waiting for transmission.
REPEAT	Message not responded to; waiting to repeat send.
SENT	One-way message completed.
SENT-R	Two-way message sent; waiting for response.

Directory Menu

To access the Directory Menu, select option **3**, Directory Menu, on the Robot Alert Administration Menu.



The Directory Menu offers three options that allow you to set up and maintain vendors, devices, and broadcast lists.



Vendor Maintenance Menu

Displays the Vendor Maintenance Menu. Use this menu to create vendors or perform maintenance on existing vendors.

Maintain Device Directory

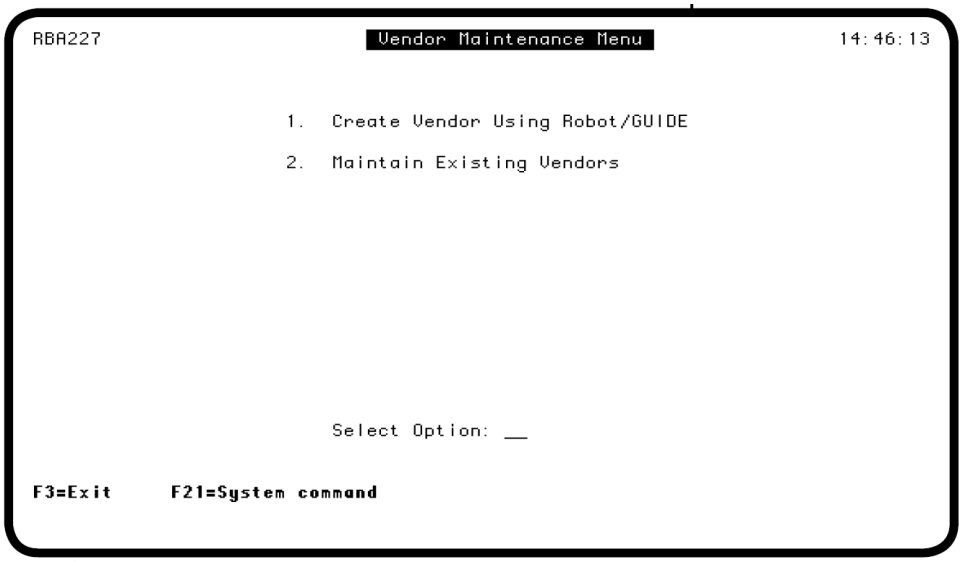
Displays the Maintain Devices panel. Use this option to set up new devices or perform maintenance on existing devices.

Maintain Broadcast Lists

Displays the Maintain Broadcast Lists panel. Use this option to set up new broadcast lists or perform maintenance on existing broadcast lists

The Vendor Maintenance Menu

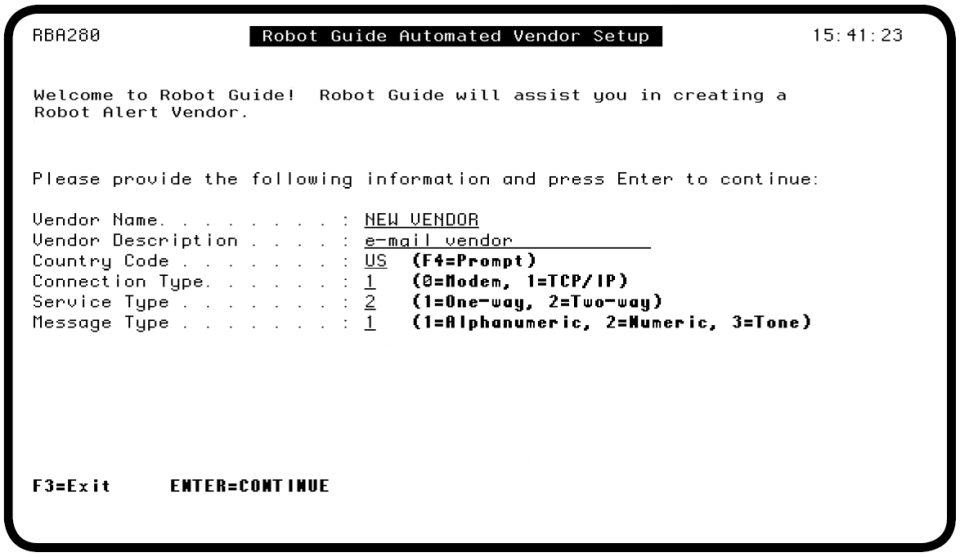
The Vendor Maintenance Menu gives you access to the options for adding new vendors or maintaining existing vendors. To access the menu, select option **1** from the Directory Menu.



Robot Guide Automated Vendor Setup

Select option **1** to add a new vendor using Robot Guide. Robot Guide walks you through the process of setting up a new vendor

The Robot Guide Automated Vendor Setup panel lets you select options for adding a new vendor. You can specify the name, description, and various details about the service and type of communication for this vendor. After you complete your selections, press Enter for the next panel (the options you see on subsequent panels vary depending on the selections you make on this panel).



Field Descriptions

Vendor Name and Description

Enter the name of your vendor and a brief description.

Country Code

Enter your vendor's country code (press **F4** for a list of country codes).

Connection Type

Specify the connection type:

0 = Modem

1 = TCP/IP: email, pager (SNPP), or trap (SNMP)

Your selection determines subsequent options that Robot Guide displays.

Service Type

Specify the type of service for this vendor:

1 = One-way service

2 = Two-way service

Your selection determines subsequent options that Robot Guide displays.

Message Type

Specify the type of messages you will be sending to this vendor:

1 = Alphanumeric

2 = Numeric

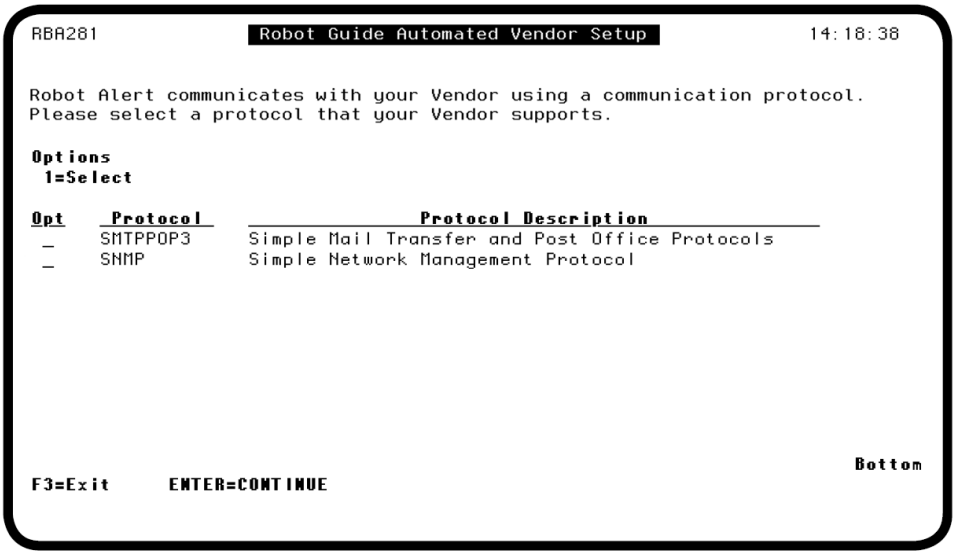
3 = Tone

Press Enter to continue, or **F3** to return to the Vendor Maintenance Menu.

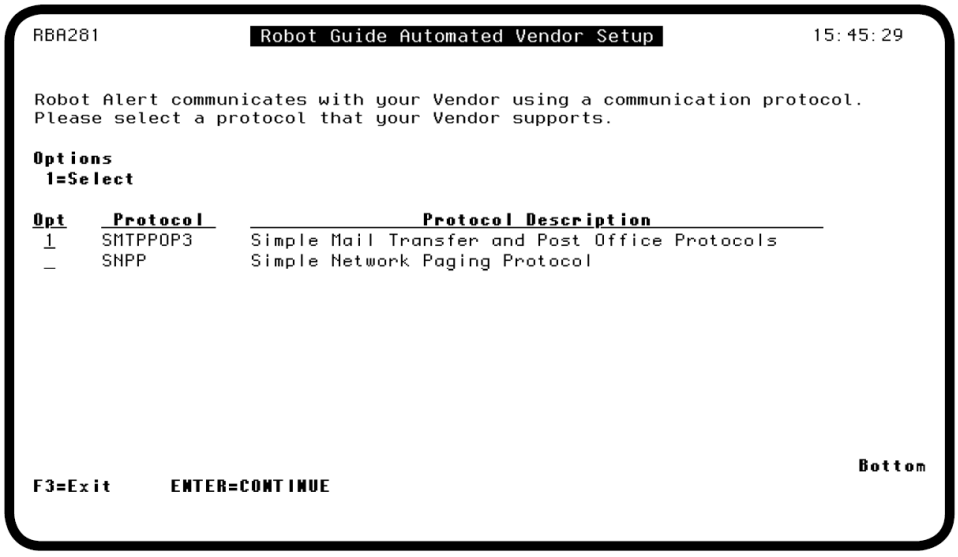
Robot Guide—TCP/IP Connection

The Robot Guide Automated Vendor Setup redisplays. The connection type option you selected on the panel previously determine the options that appear now.

- If you specified TCP/IP (**1**), the TCP/IP options, as shown in the examples below, appear.
- If you specified Modem (**0**), see the subtopic, Robot Guide—Modem Connection.



If you specified one-way communication, you must select either SMTPPOP3 (email), or SNMP (traps) as your protocol.



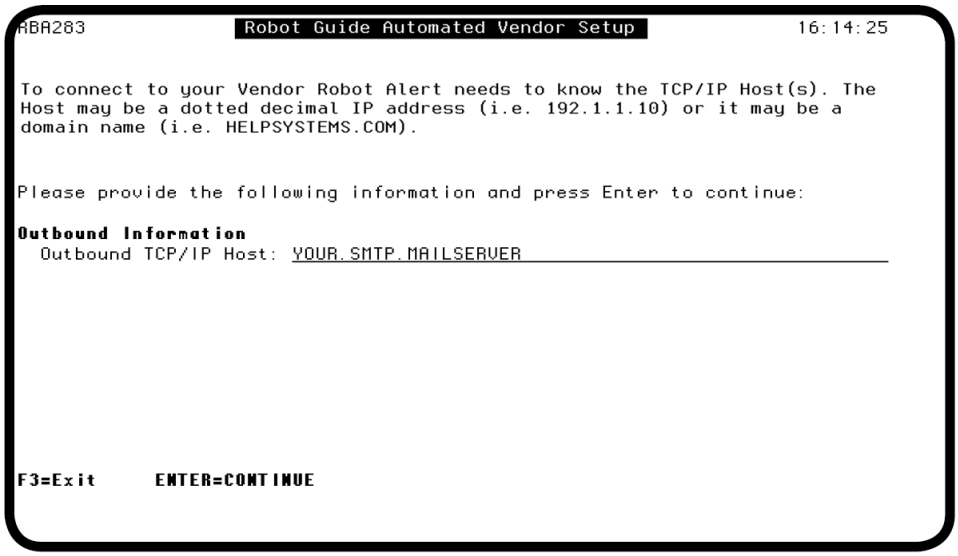
If you specified two-way communication, you can select either SMTPPOP3 (email) or SNPP (pager) as your protocol.

Robot Guide—TCP/IP: One-Way Email (SMTP) or Two-Way Pager (SNPP)

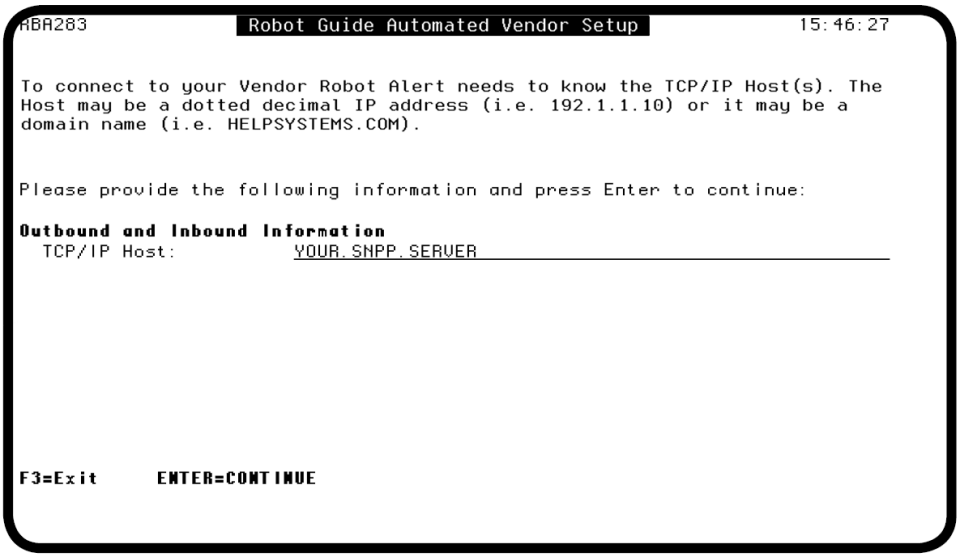
After you have selected your TCP/IP protocol, you must specify the IP address of the TCP/IP Host in decimal format, or by entering the domain name.

- If you specified one-way TCP/IP communication (SMTP), you must enter the outbound Host address (the Host to which you're sending the message).
- If you specified two-way TCP/IP communication using SNPP, you must enter the Host address.

  Robot Alert uses the settings in CFGTCP to determine where to send the trap.
- If you specified two-way TCP/IP communication using SMTP/POP3, see the topic, Robot Guide—TCP/IP: Two-way Email Connection (SMTP/POP3).



Replace this Host name with either the IP address or domain name of your SMTP email server and press Enter.



Replace this Host name with either the IP address or domain name of your vendor's TCP/IP Host and press Enter.

Robot Guide—TCP/IP: Two-way Email Connection (SMTP/POP3)

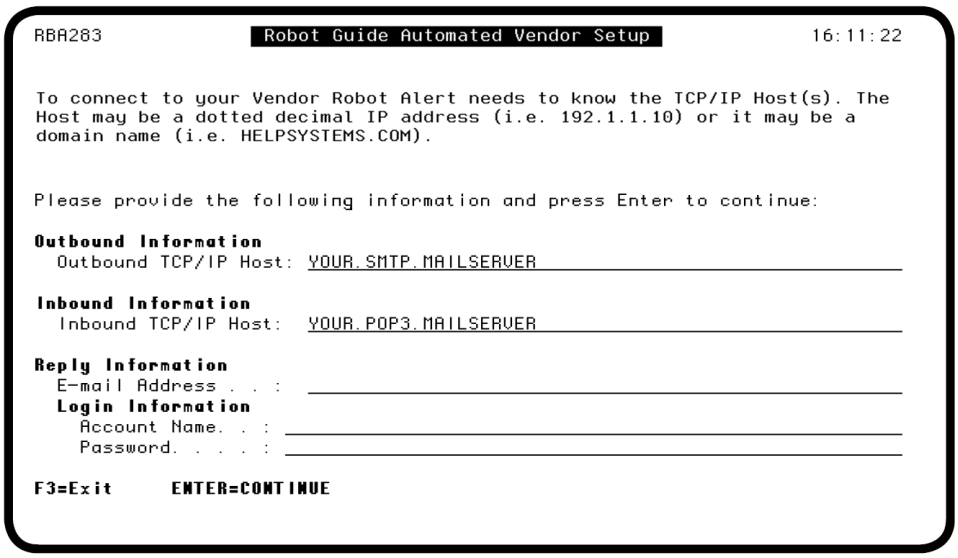
After you have selected your TCP/IP protocol, you must specify the IP address of the TCP/IP Host or Hosts. If you selected two-way communication, you need to specify both the

outbound Host address (the Host to which you're sending the message) and the inbound Host address (the Host receiving the reply to the message). You can enter the IP address in decimal format, or enter the domain name.

You must also enter the email address, user-id, and password for the mailbox on the inbound Host that will be receiving the replies (usually, the Robot Alert mailbox—see the TIP).

Tip:

We recommend that you set up a dedicated Robot Alert mailbox to which replies can be sent. This allows your communication processing to proceed more smoothly and with fewer interruptions. This dedicated Robot Alert mailbox is what we mean when we refer to "the Robot Alert mailbox".



Field Descriptions

Outbound Information

Replace this Host name with either the IP address or domain name of your SMTP email server and press Enter.

Inbound Information

Replace this Host name with the IP address or domain name of your TCP/IP Host and press Enter.

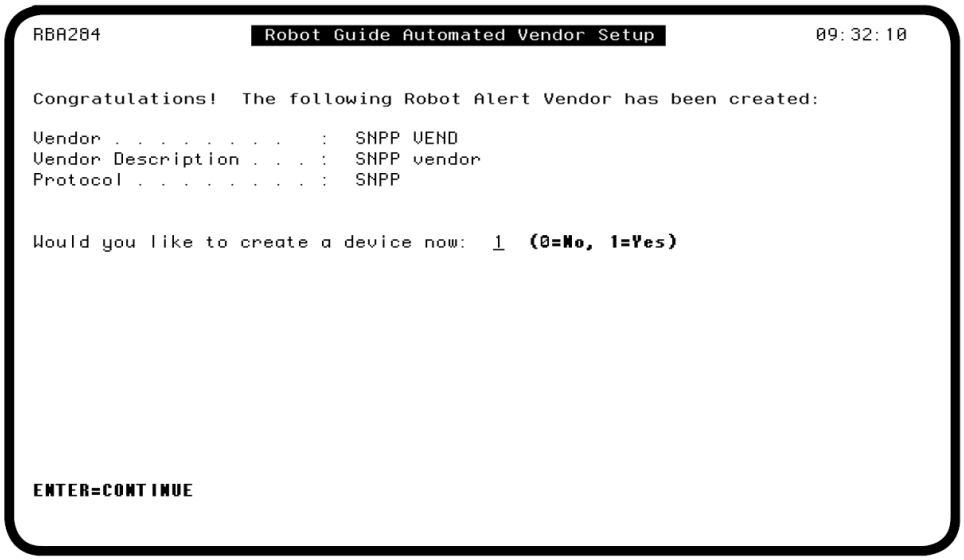
Reply Information

Enter the email address, account name, and password for the mailbox on the inbound Host that will be receiving the replies (usually the Robot Alert mailbox).

Robot Guide—Creating a Device

After you have successfully created your new vendor, Robot Guide offers the option of configuring a device to connect to this vendor.

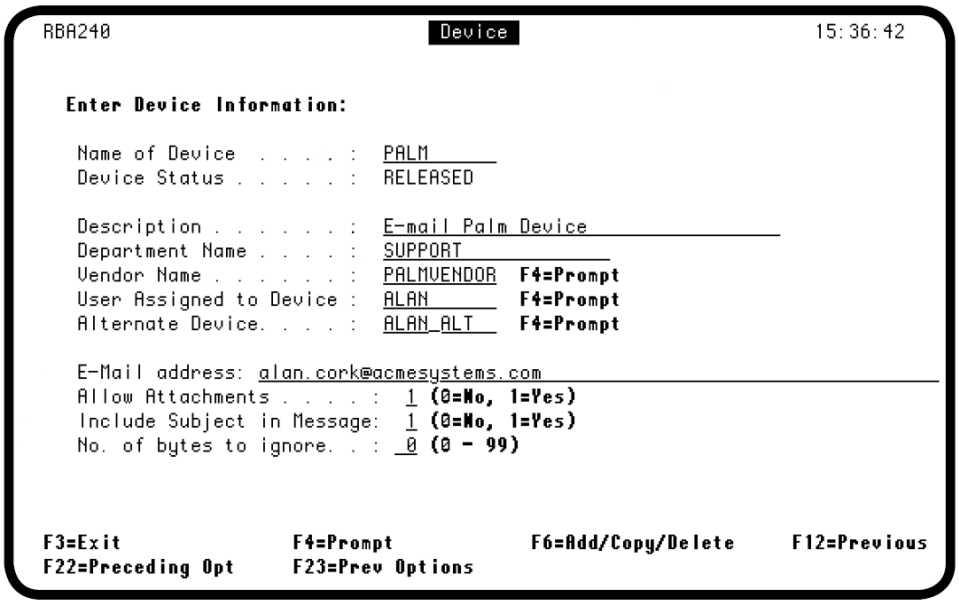
- If you specified SMTPPOP3 as your protocol, refer to the subtopic, Using Robot Guide—Creating an Email Device.
- If you specified SNPP as your protocol, refer to the subtopic, Using Robot Guide—Creating a Modem Device.



Enter a **1** to create a device; **0** to skip it, and press Enter.

Robot Guide—Creating an Email Device

If you specify that you would like to create a device (option **1**) from the Robot Guide Automated Vendor Setup panel, the Device panel displays with options for you to describe the TCP/IP device. You must supply a device name, vendor name associated with the device, user assigned to the device, and the device's email address. The description, department name, and alternate device fields are optional.



Field Descriptions

Name of Device and Description

Enter the name of the device and a brief description.

Department Name and Vendor Name

Enter the department name and vendor name.

Alternate Device

Enter the name of an alternate device (optional) to use if the primary device is in a held state (or press **F4** for list of devices). The following are the rules for specifying an alternate device:

- An alternate device must be an existing device, and the same device can be an alternate device for multiple devices.
- An alternate device must have a different name than its device (for example, the device PALM cannot have an alternate device named PALM).
- An alternate device cannot have an alternate device (only one level of alternate devices allowed).
- An alternate device can be a different type of device than the primary device. For example, an email primary device can have a modem alternate device.

- If both the primary and alternate device are in a held status, the message will be in a held status.
- If the primary device is in a released status, the message is sent to the primary device.
- You cannot use a broadcast list as an alternate device, but a device specified in a broadcast list can be an alternate device.
- You must be authorized to use the device to specify it as an alternate device.

User Assigned to Device

Enter the name of the user assigned to the device (or press **F4** for list of users).

E-Mail Address

The email address of the device user. You may only have one email address for a device.

Allow Attachments

Enter whether the email message sent to this device can include attachments (**0** = NO; **1** = Yes)

Include Subject in Message

Enter whether to include the subject line one-way messages sent to this device. Two-way messages require a subject line (**0** = NO; **1** = Yes)

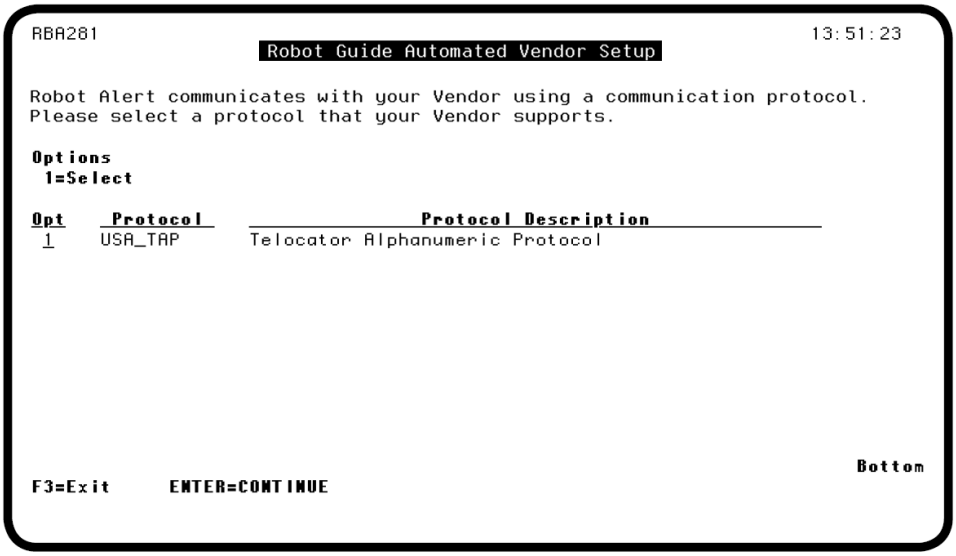
No. of Bytes to Ignore

Enter the number of bytes of message text to ignore, from **0** to **99**. Use this field if your vendor adds text to the beginning of a reply, such as the word REPLY, that is unnecessary to respond to an IBM i message. Determine the length of the unnecessary information (one byte per character—for the word REPLY, it would be 5 bytes), and instruct Robot Alert to ignore that portion of the message.

Robot Guide—Modem Connection

The Robot Guide Automated Vendor Setup redisplays. The connection type option you selected on the panel previously determine the options that appear now.

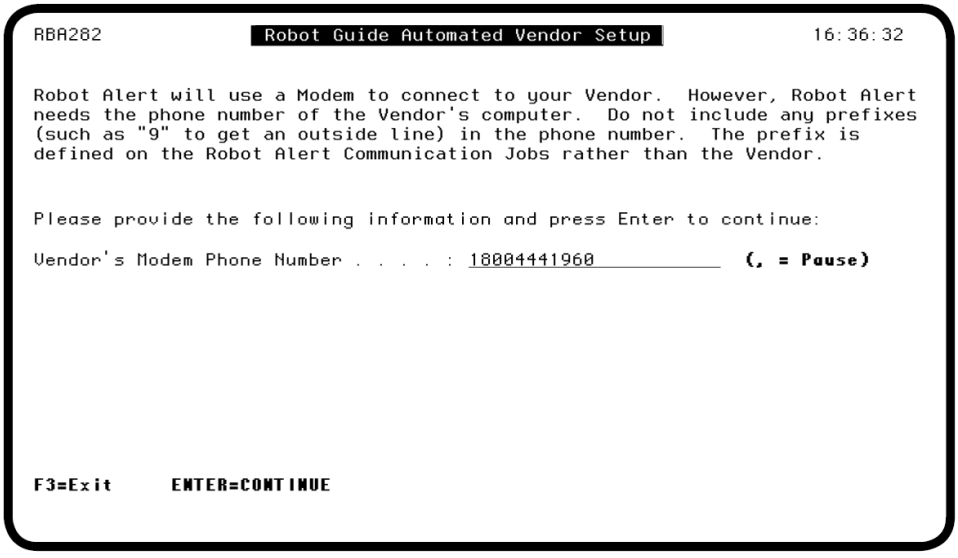
- If you specified TCP/IP (**1**), see the topic Robot Guide—TCP/IP Connection.
- If you specified Modem (**0**), the modem protocol option (shown below) appear.



Select the modem protocol by entering a **1** next to it and pressing Enter.

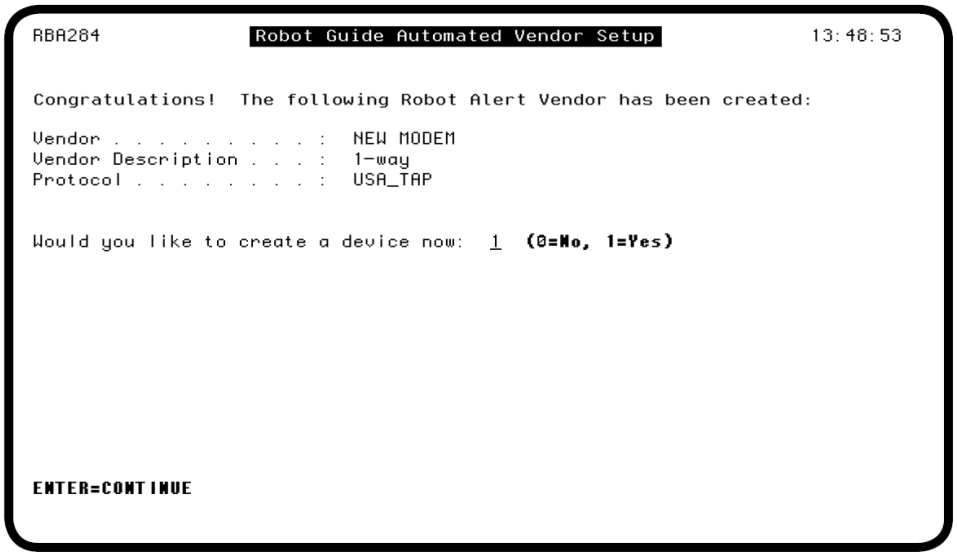
The Robot Guide Automated Vendor Setup redisplays with the option for you to supply the phone number of the vendor's modem. Replace the number displayed with the correct number. Do not include any prefixes, such as 9 for an outside line, in the number. You specify prefixes when you define the communication jobs to associate the prefix with a specific modem.

Press Enter to continue.



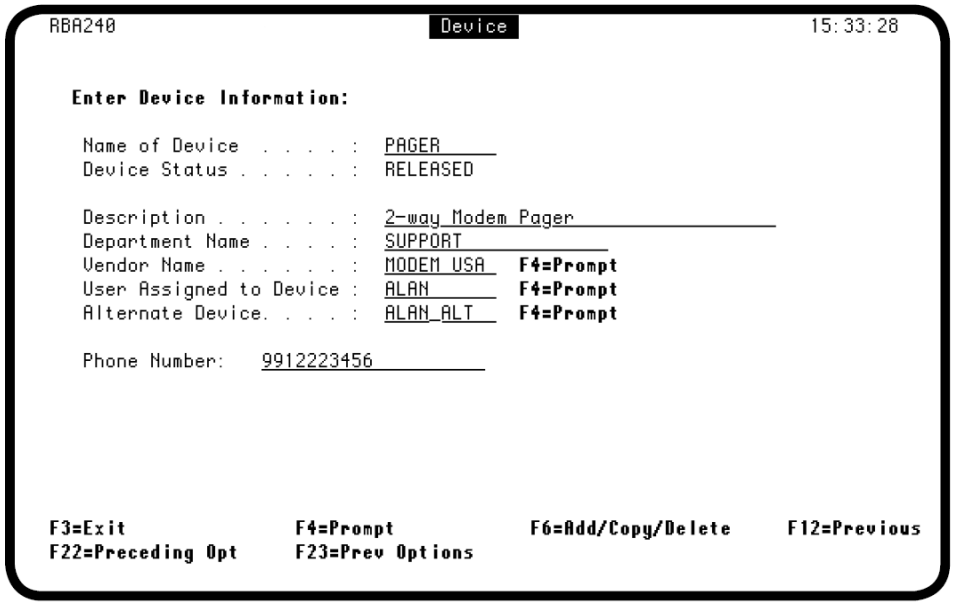
Enter the phone number to be used to contact the vendor. Use a comma (,) to indicate a pause. Each comma pauses for approximately 1 second.

After you have successfully created your new vendor, Robot Guide offers you the option of configuring a device to connect to this vendor. Enter **1** or **0**, and press Enter to continue.



Enter a **1** to create a device; **0** to skip it, and press Enter.

If you specify that you would like to create a device from the Robot Guide Automated Vendor Setup panel, the Device panel displays with options for you to describe the modem device. You must supply a device name, vendor name associated with the device, user assigned to the device, and the device's phone number. The other fields, description, department name, and alternate device, are optional.



Field Descriptions

Name of Device and Description

Enter the name of the device and a brief description.

Phone Number

Specify the phone number (or device ID) of the device receiving the messages.

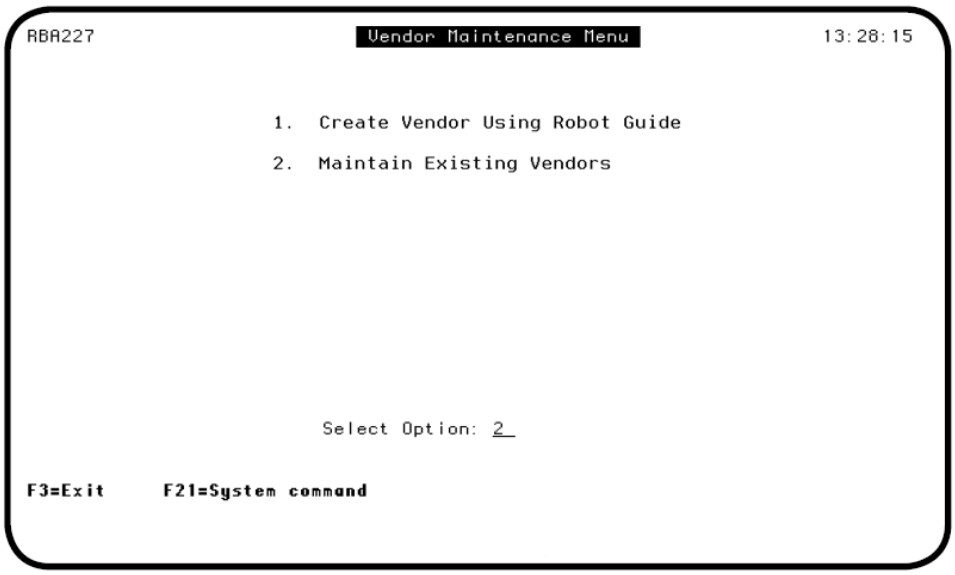
Alternate Device

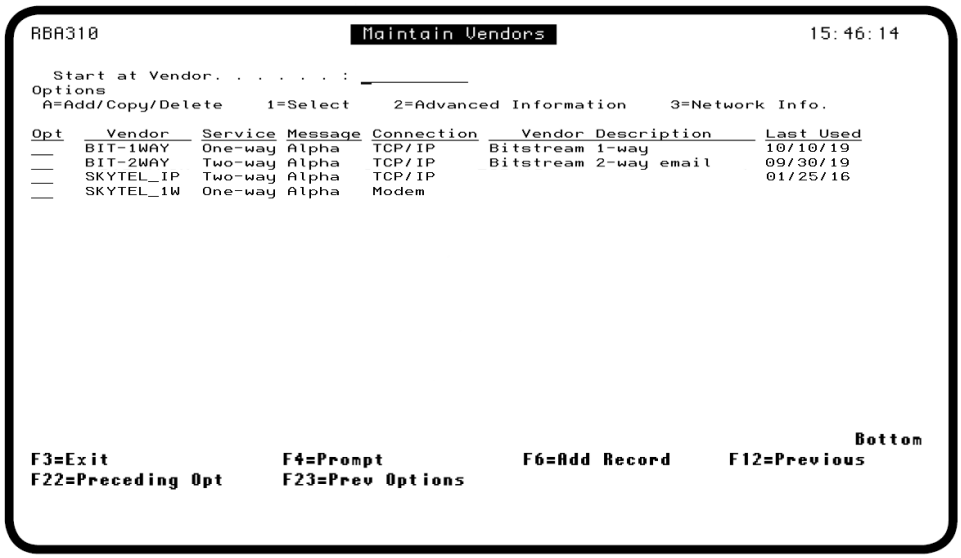
Enter the name of an alternate device (optional) to use if the primary device is in a held state (or press **F4** for list of devices). The following are the rules for specifying an alternate device:

- An alternate device must be an existing device, and the same device can be an alternate device for multiple devices.
- An alternate device must have a different name than its device (for example, the device PAGER cannot have an alternate device named PAGER).
- An alternate device cannot have an alternate device (only one level of alternate devices allowed).
- An alternate device can be a different type of device than the primary device. For example, an e-mail primary device can have a modem alternate device.
- If both the primary and alternate device are in a held status, the message will be in a held status.
- If the primary device is in a released status, the message is sent to the primary device.
- You cannot use a broadcast list as an alternate device, but a device specified in a broadcast list can be an alternate device.
- You must be authorized to use the device to specify it as an alternate device.

Maintaining Vendors

The Maintain Vendors panel allows you to set up vendors for Robot Alert. From this panel you can add, copy, or delete vendors, and view vendor setup information, advanced information, and network parameters. To access it, select option **2** from the Vendor Maintenance Menu.





Field Descriptions

Service

Indicates the type of service the vendor supplies.

Message

Indicates the type of message the vendor supports: alphanumeric, numeric, or tone.

Connection

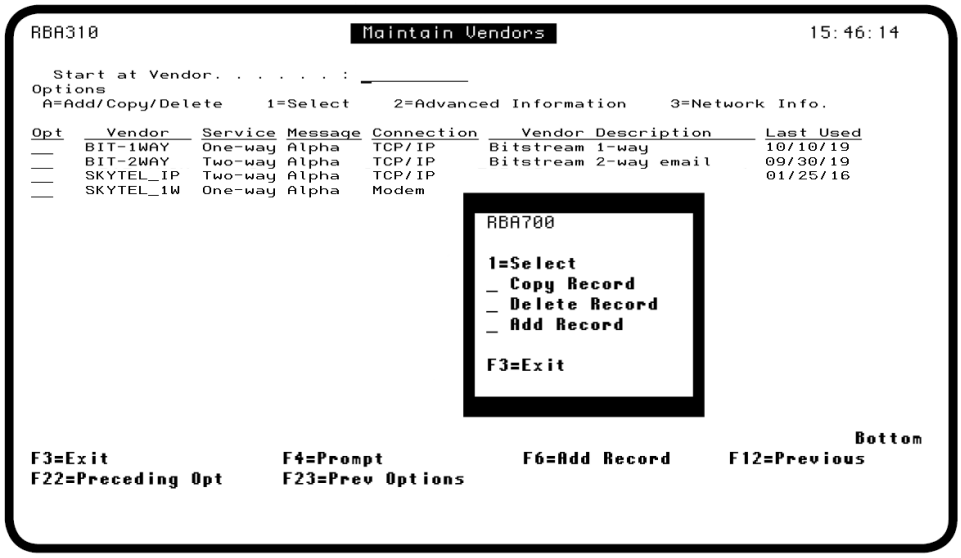
Indicates the type of connection—modem, or TCP/IP.

Vendor Description

Indicates the short description given to the vendor upon creation.

Last Used

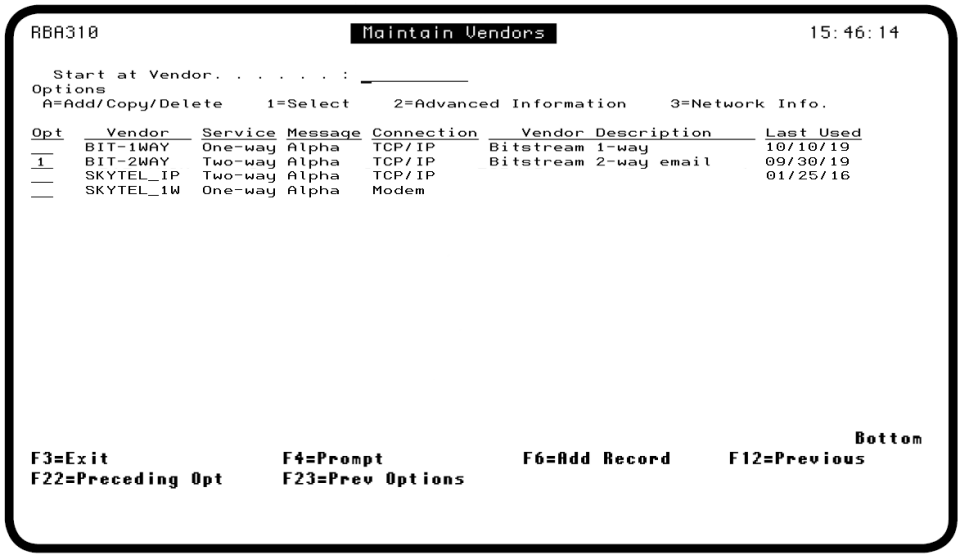
Indicates the last time the vendor was used by Robot Alert.



If you're adding or deleting a vendor, enter **A** next to an existing vendor to add, copy, or delete it. When the options window appears, place a **1** next to the option you want to use and press Enter. You can also use **F6** to add a vendor. This option will start the Robot Guide automated vendor setup process

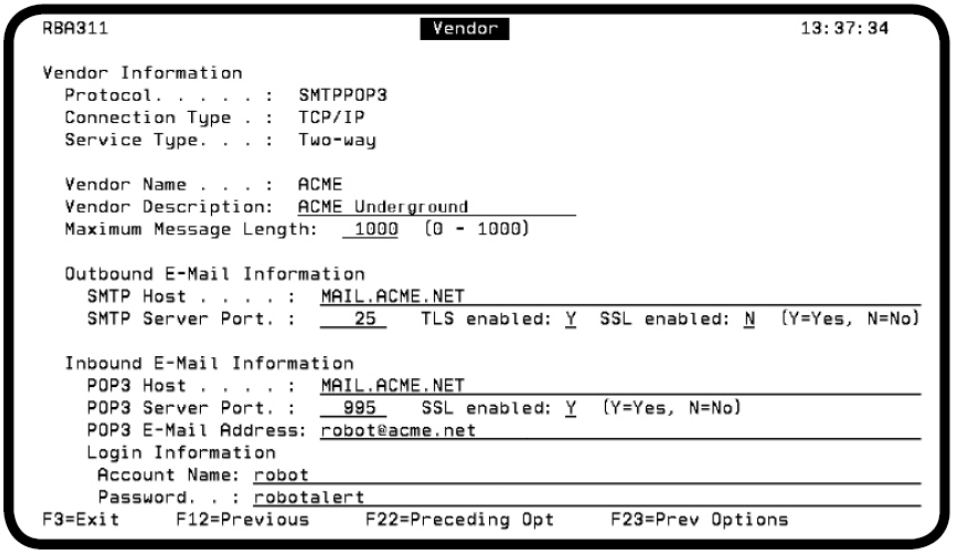
Important

- For one-way and two-way paging, complete the Paging Services Questionnaire in the Getting Started section of this User Guide before you start this section.
- For email paging, complete the TCP/IP Paging Services Questionnaire in the Getting Started section of this User Guide before you start this section.



If you're performing maintenance on an existing vendor, enter **1** next to the vendor and press Enter. The Vendor panel displays. Fill in the fields with the information for your vendor.

TCP/IP Vendor



Field Descriptions

Outbound Email Information

Enter SMTP Host

If your mail server supports it, you can enable Transport Layer Security (TLS) or Secure Sockets Layer (SSL)

The standard SMTP port number is 25. In a TLS environment, it's 587. And, in an SSL environment, it's 465.

Inbound Email Information

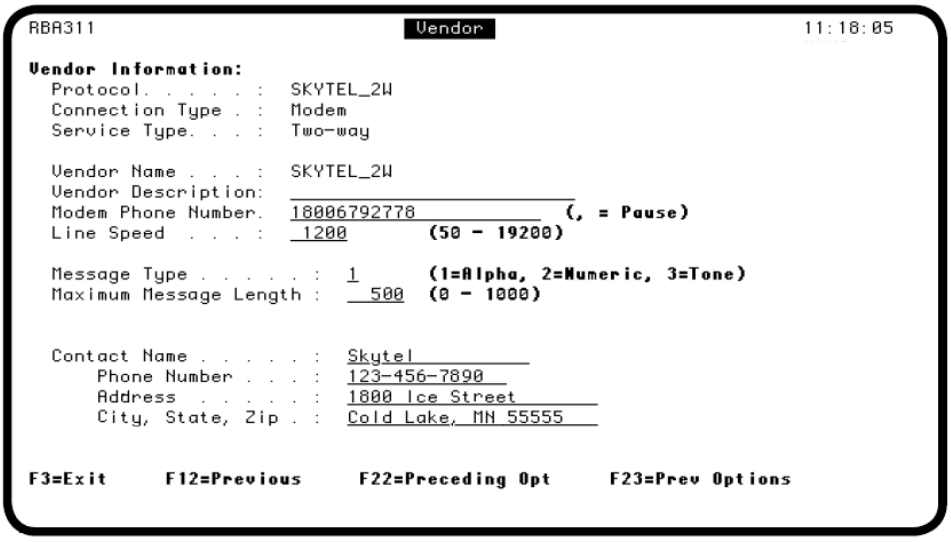
Enter POP3 host to indicate that the vendor supports two-way communication.

If your mail server supports it, you can enable Transport Layer Security (TLS) or Secure Sockets Layer (SSL)

The standard POP3 port number is 110. In an SSL environment, it's 995.

Your mail server may require that different ports be used.

Modem Vendor



Field Descriptions

Modem Phone Number

Enter the phone number of the paging service's computer modem (get this number from your device vendor). This phone number is the one that your system must dial to contact the vendor's computer, **not** the device phone number or device ID number.

This number should not include any prefixes (such as 9) that you may need to dial out. You set up prefixes when you define your communication jobs.

Vendor Name and Description

Enter the name of the vendor and a description.

Line Speed

Enter the BPS rate (line speed) your paging service's computer uses to receive messages (50 to 19200 BPS, inclusive).

Message Type

Enter the type of messages the vendor supports. If you have devices of different types from the same vendor, you must create a vendor record with different vendor names for each type of message. For example, MINCOM_AL for alphanumeric and MINCOM_NM for numeric.

Maximum Message Length

Enter the maximum message length (in characters) that the vendor supports. Robot Alert supports up to 1,000 characters.

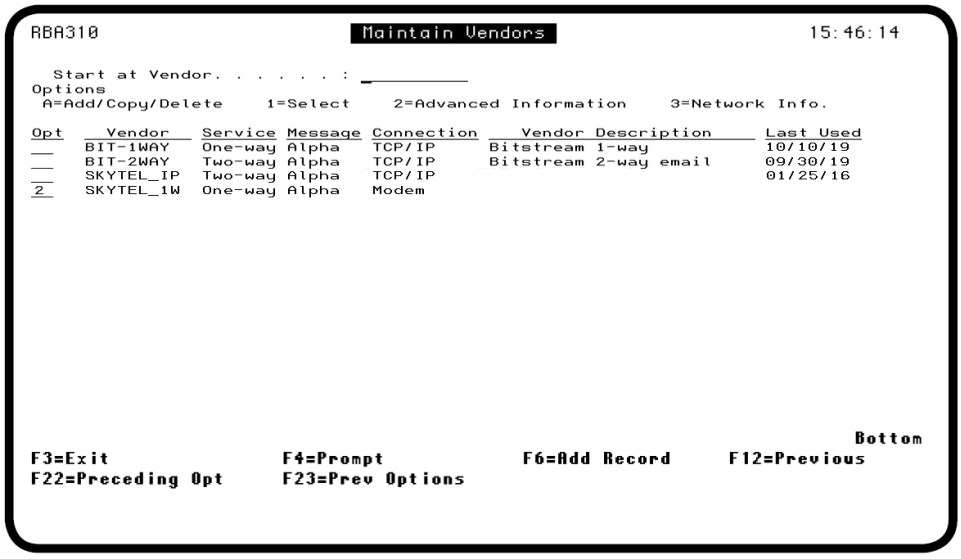
Contact Information

Enter your vendor or technical support contact (for your reference only).

Advanced Vendor Information

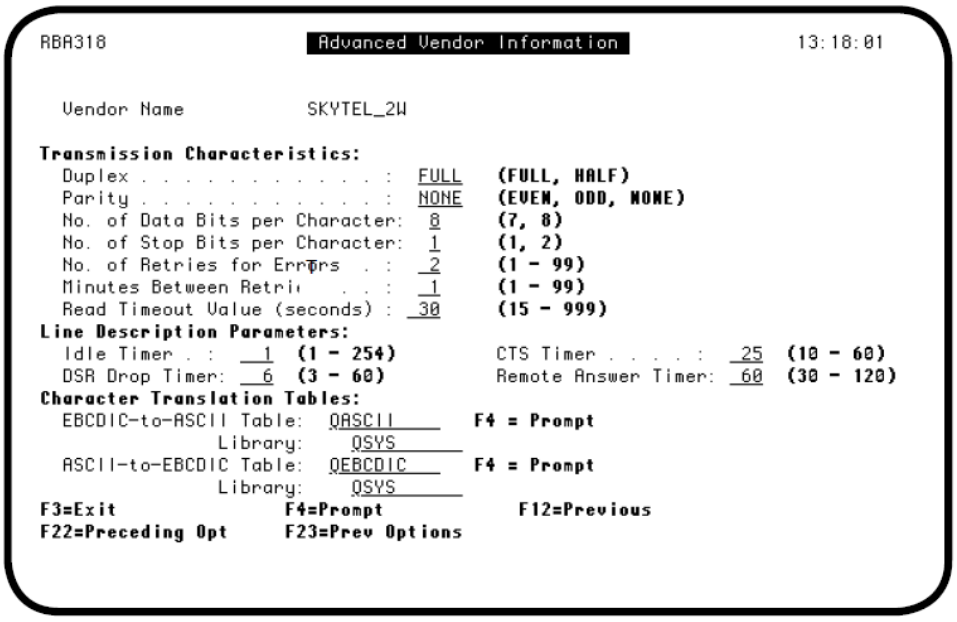
If you're performing advanced maintenance on an existing vendor, enter **2** next to the vendor on the Maintain Vendors panel and press Enter. The Advanced Vendor Information panel displays. On this panel, enter the technical information for a vendor. This information is necessary for Robot Alert to communicate properly with the paging service. Copy the information required for this panel from the One-Way Paging Services Questionnaire you completed in the Getting Started section.

If you're using two-way paging, you probably do not need to change anything on this panel.

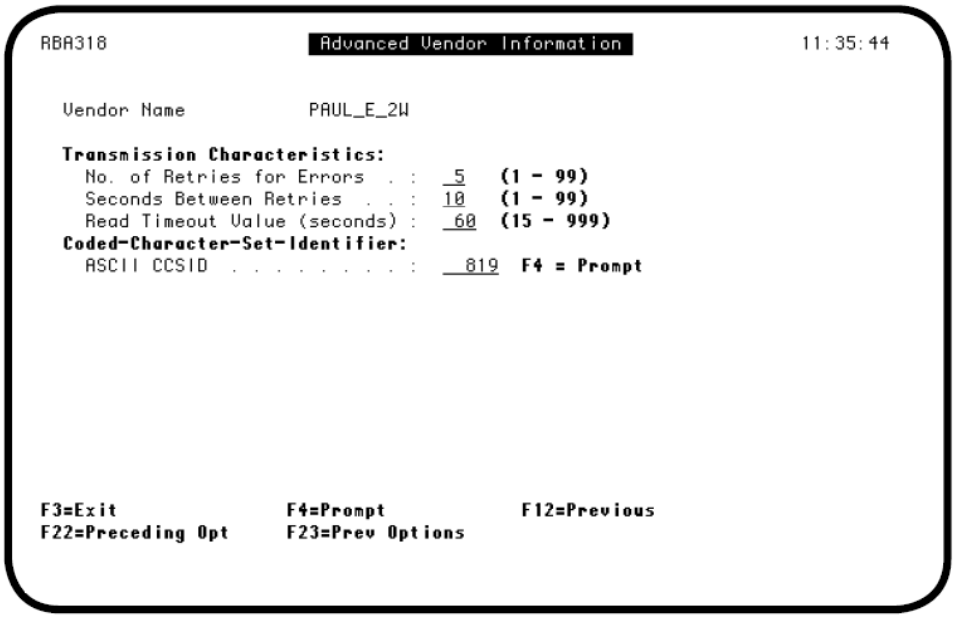


Depending on the type of vendor you select, one of two panels displays.

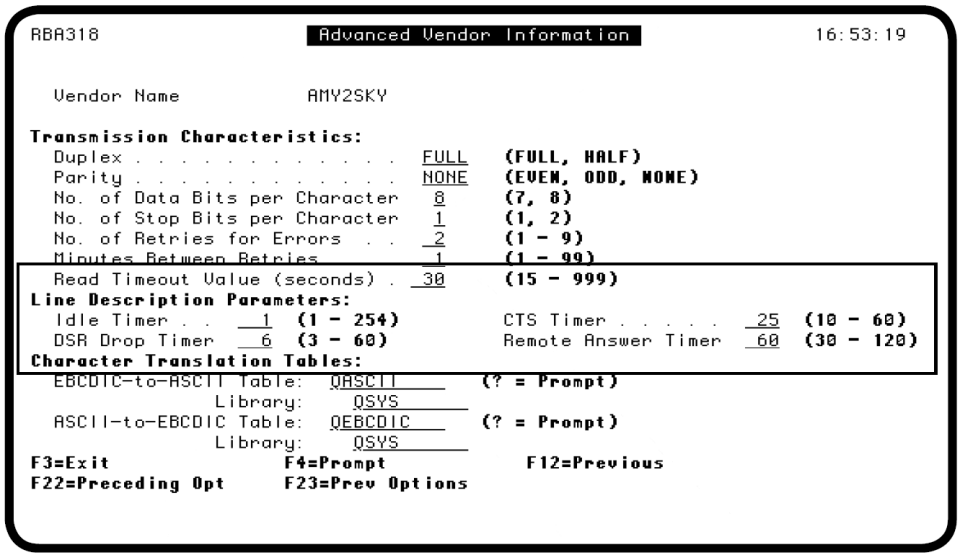
If you select a modem vendor, this panel will appear:



If you select a TCP/IP vendor (email), this panel will appear:



Advanced Vendor Information - Modem Vendor



Field Descriptions

Duplex and Parity

The Duplex and Parity values vary, depending on the modem type. The values must match your vendor's modem.

No. of Data Bits per Character and No. of Stop Bits per Character

The number of Data Bits and Stop Bits must agree with your vendor. Contact your vendor, if necessary, to find the correct values to use.

No. of Retries for Errors and Minutes Between Retries

Enter the number of times Robot Alert will try to dial the paging service if the paging service line is busy and the number of minutes to wait between each retry.

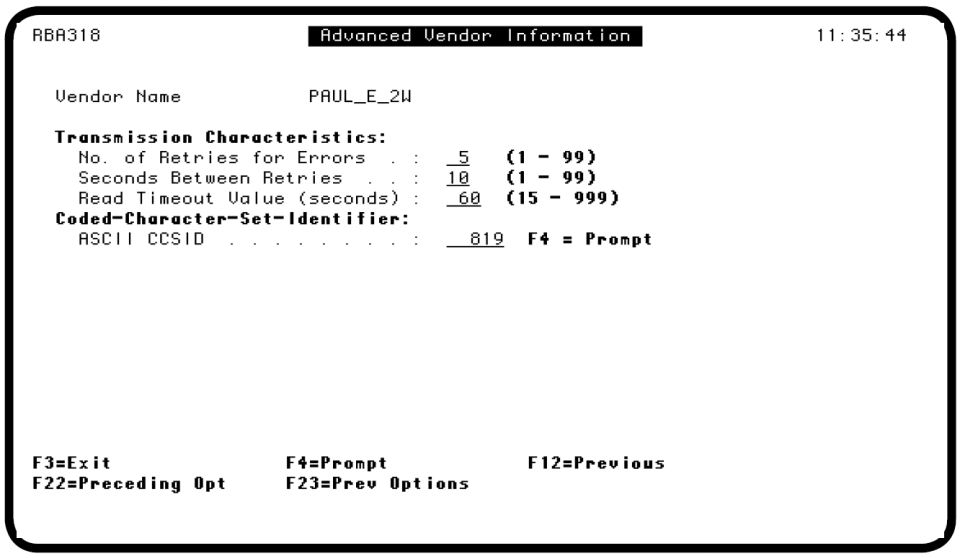
Line Description Parameters

Normally, you can use the default line description values. You may have to change these values if you're using a paging service that is outside of the United States. Check with your paging service (for more information, refer to IBM's Communications Configuration Reference, or the online help for the CRTLINASC command).

Character Translation Tables

These tables translate EBCDIC to ASCII and ASCII to EBCDIC. They may need to be changed to handle different languages. See the IBM manual, National Language Support Planning Guide, for non-U.S. tables.

Advanced Vendor Information—TCP/IP (email) Vendor



Field Descriptions

Transmission Characteristics

Enter the number of times Robot Alert will try to send the message if there are problems with the communication.

Enter the amount of time (in seconds) that Robot Alert will wait between each retry if there are problems with the communication.

Enter the amount of time (in seconds) that Robot Alert should wait before timing out the communication if there are problems.

Coded-Character-Set-Identifier

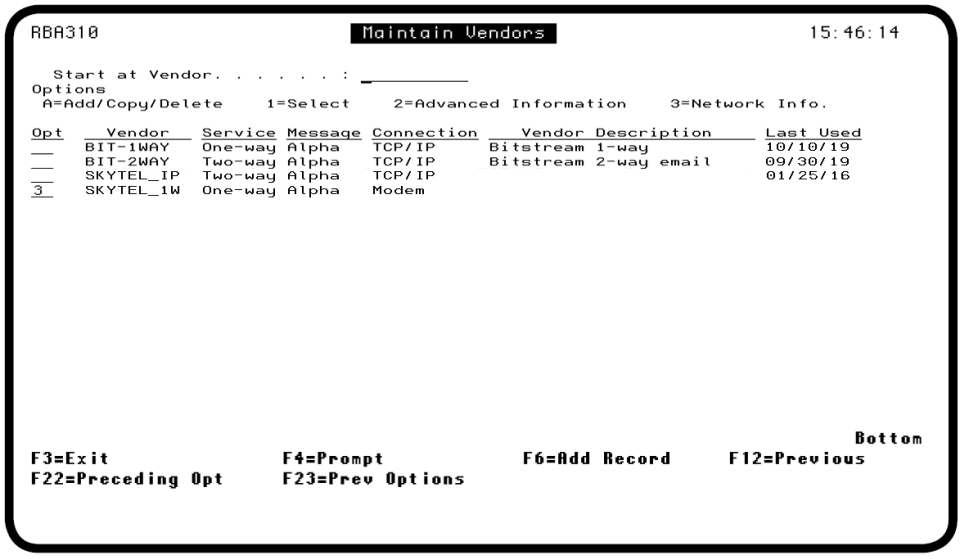
IBM i machines use the EBCDIC character set; email servers (and most other computers) use the ASCII character set. When Robot Alert communicates with other systems, it must convert the data it sends from EBCDIC to ASCII, and the data it receives from ASCII to EBCDIC.

The ASCII CCSID field defines which ASCII set Robot Alert will use to communicate with the vendor and make the appropriate translations. The 819 set (default) is known as full ASCII (includes the special ASCII characters), and covers most translations. In some cases you may need to specify a different CCSID. For example, if you plan to communicate in Hebrew, you will need to use the CCSID that includes those characters.

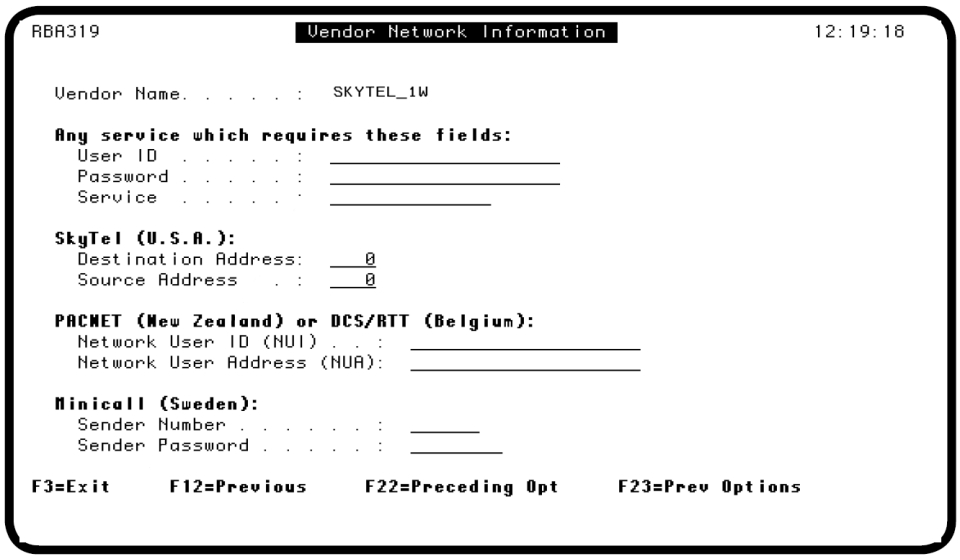
For a list of choices, press **F4** (for more information, refer to the National Language Support Planning Guide, for non-U.S. tables).

Vendor Network Information

On the Network Parameters panel, enter additional information required by vendor paging services that use a packet switching network, such as Tymnet. If your vendor uses such a service, you dial that service which then dials your vendor. The type of information required may include user IDs, passwords, and security codes. Most U.S. paging services DO NOT require entries on this panel. Call Fortra if you have any questions.



Enter option **3** on the Maintain Vendors panel to view the Vendor Network Information panel.



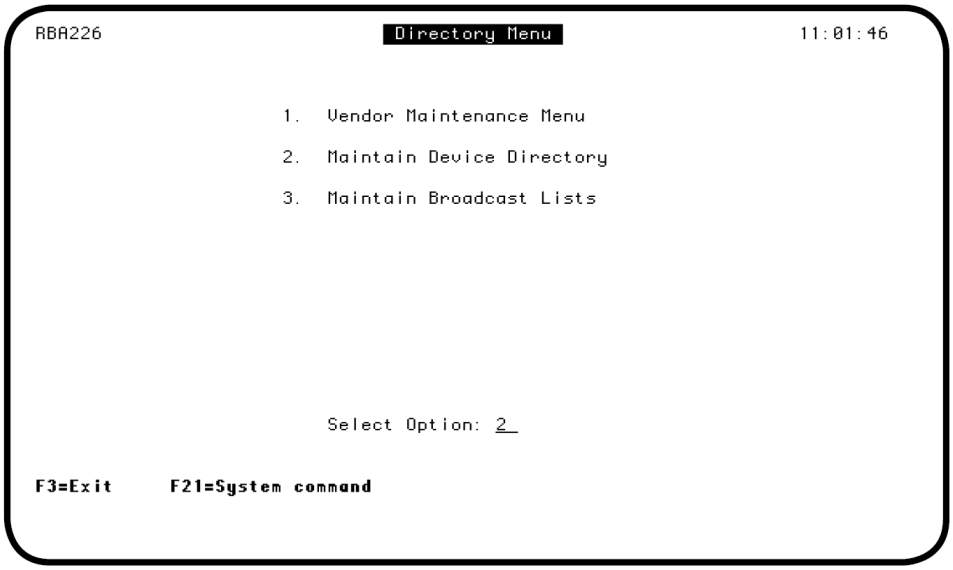
Enter the User ID and password that the service requires.

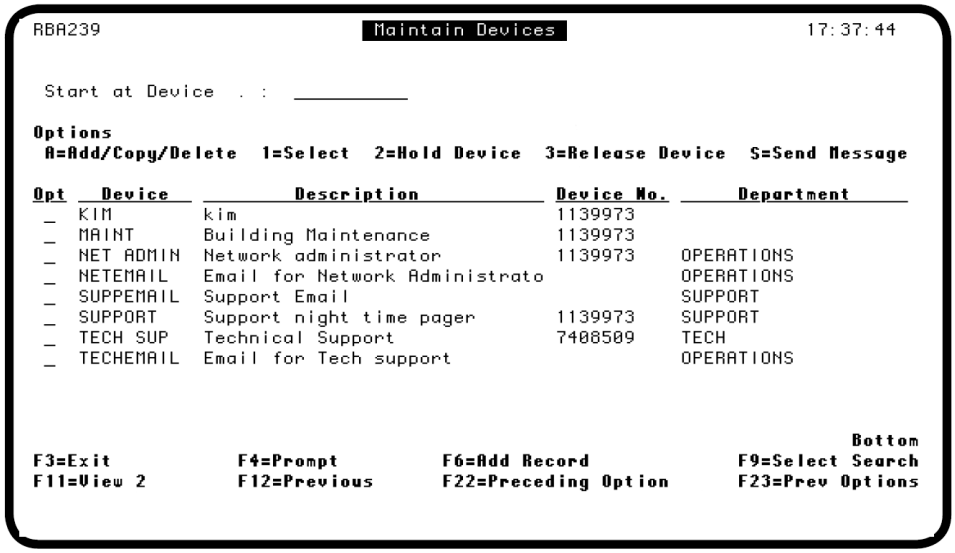
Some vendors require additional information. Enter the required information next to the appropriate service.

Maintaining Devices

The Maintain Devices panel shows the list of all devices that have been set up in Robot Alert for your system. If no devices have been set up, the panel appears blank. See the following page to add devices.

To display the Maintain Devices panel, select option **2**, Maintain Device Directory, from the Directory Menu.





Field Descriptions

Device and Description

Shows the name and a brief description of the device.

Device No.

Shows the telephone number assigned to the device.

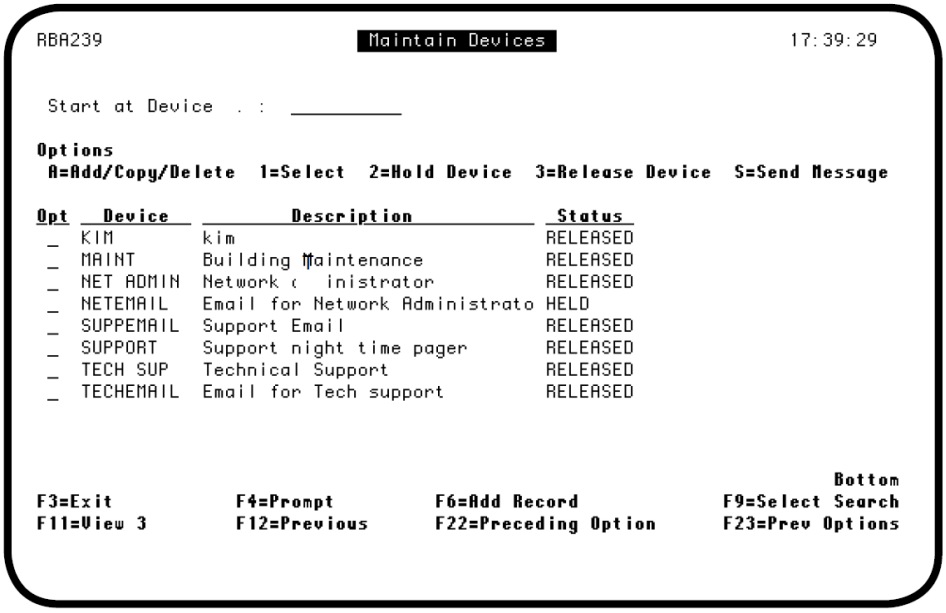
Department

Shows the department, if assigned, for the device. Department is used for documentation purposes only.

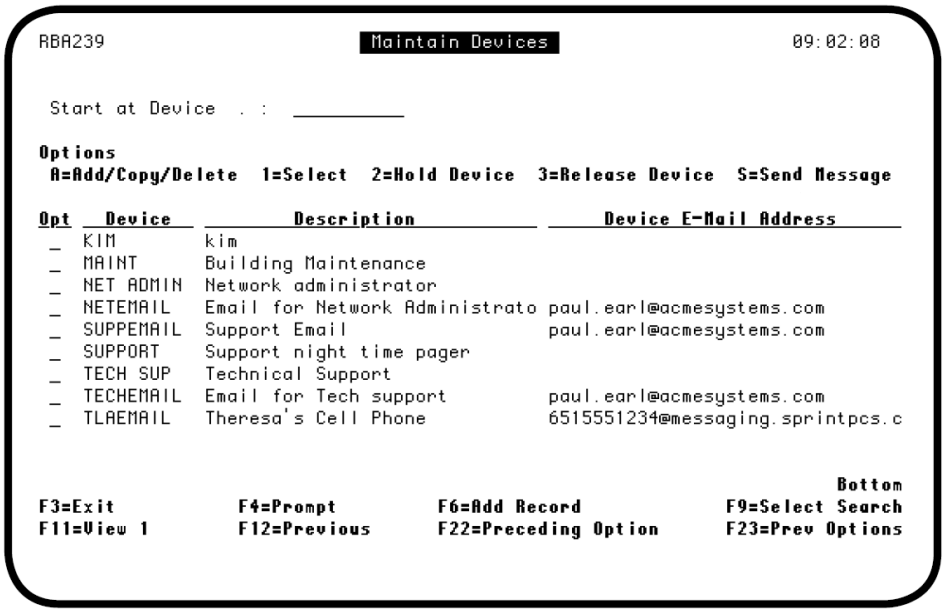
Press **F9** and select an option to display the panel information by device order, or by department and device order.

Press **F11** to toggle through the three different views of the Maintain Devices panel. The next view to display is indicated on the panel (in this example, view 2 will display next).

In view 2, the Device No. and Department columns are replaced by the Status column, which indicates the status of the device—HELD or RELEASED.



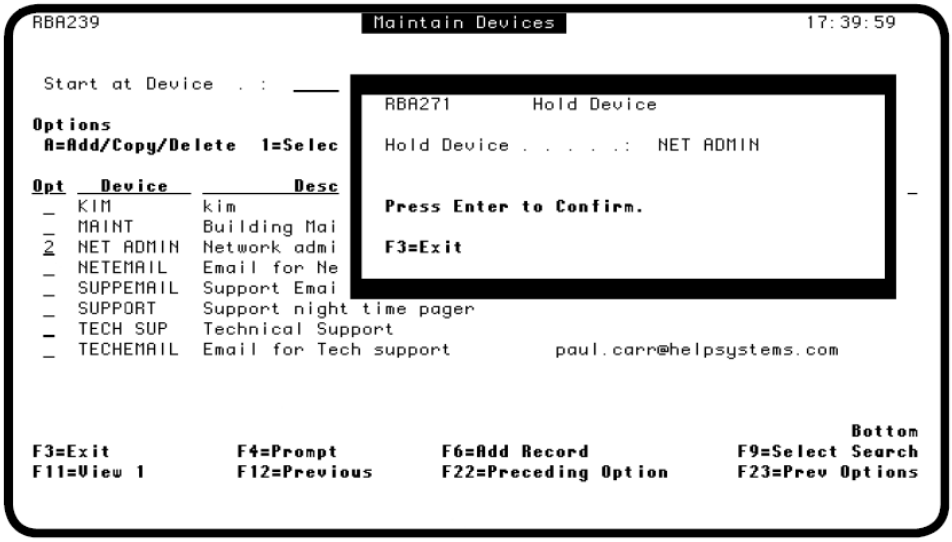
In view 3, the Status column is replaced by the Device Email Address column, which indicates the email address of the devices that can send and/or receive email.



Holding Devices

When you place a device on hold, the following actions occur:

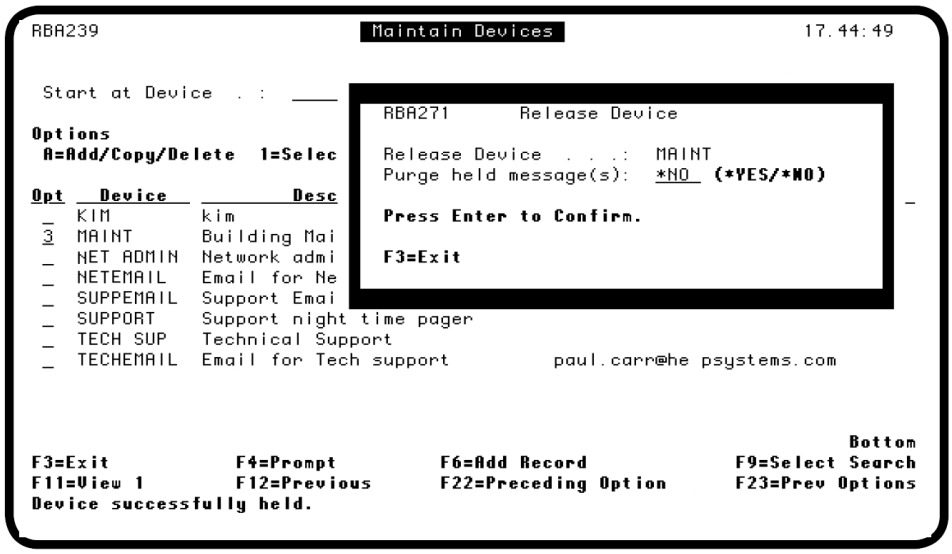
- Incoming messages for the device are queued, but no messages are answered.
- Outgoing messages from the device are placed in the Pending Message queue with a status of HOLD-D.
- To place a device on hold, select option **2** in the Opt column next to the device you want to place on hold. A panel displays to confirm that you want to place the device on hold. Press Enter to hold the device, **F3** to exit.



Releasing Devices

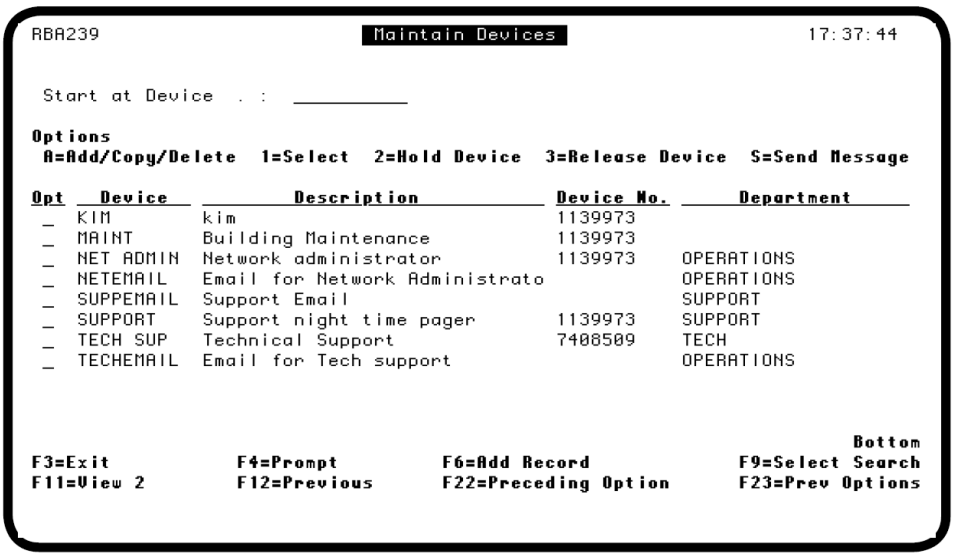
When you release a held device, the messages that were queued for the device are processed according to their priority. You have the option of purging these messages if you do not want to process them.

To release a held device, select option **3** in the Opt column next to the device you want to release. A panel displays to confirm that you want to release the device, and offering you the option to purge the held (queued) messages. To purge the messages that were queued while the device was on hold, change this value to ***YES**. Press Enter to hold the device, **F3** to exit.



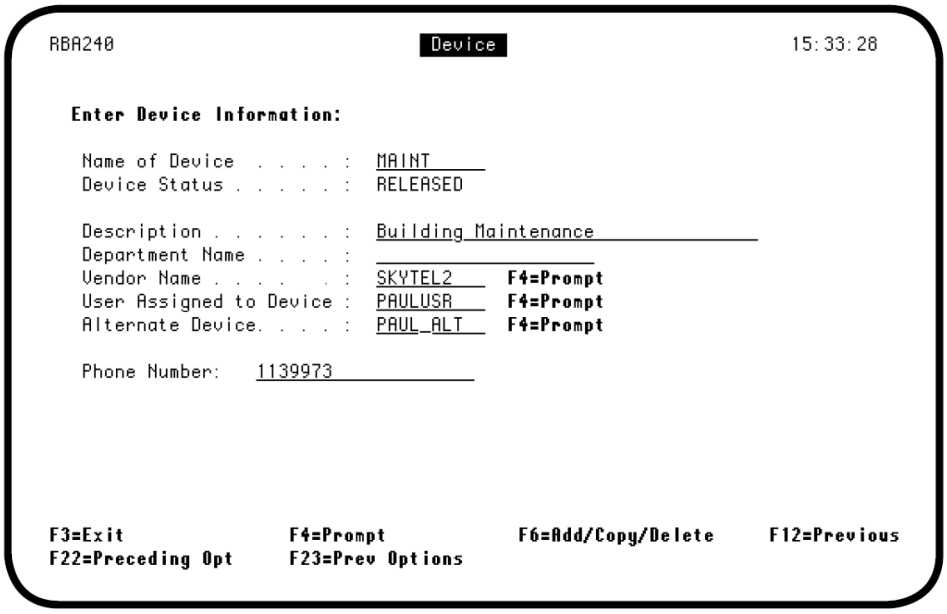
Adding and Updating Devices

In the Device panel, you can enter specific setup information for a device. This information includes the device name, a brief description, phone number, department (optional), vendor, and the user profile assigned to the device. From this panel, you can add another device, copy a device, or delete a device. To change an existing device, enter option **1** on the Maintain Devices panel. To add a new device, press **F6** or enter **A** next to an existing device. If you're adding a new device, the Device panel displays with no information filled in.

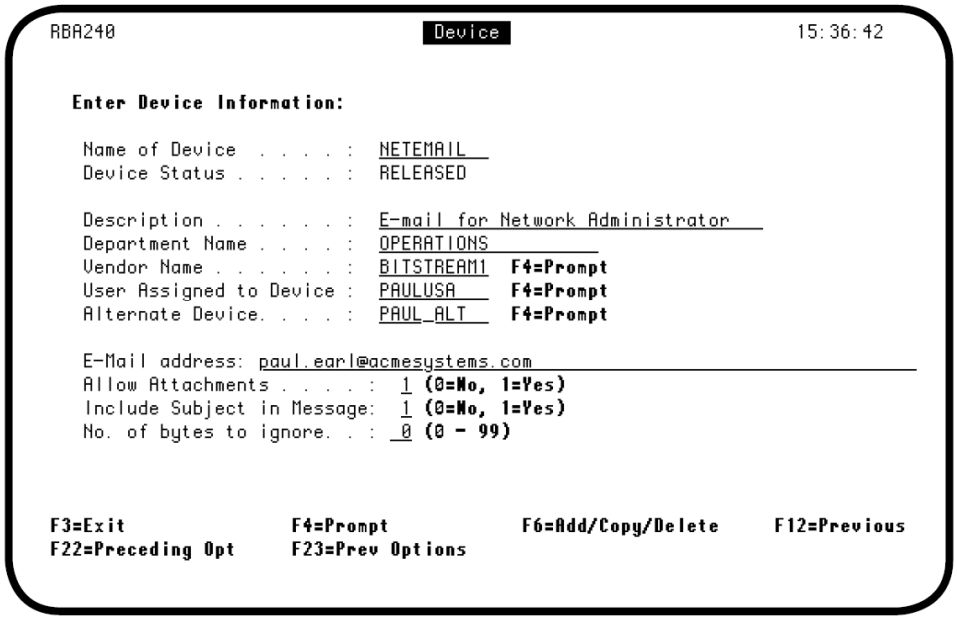


Depending on the type of device you selected, different panels are displayed.

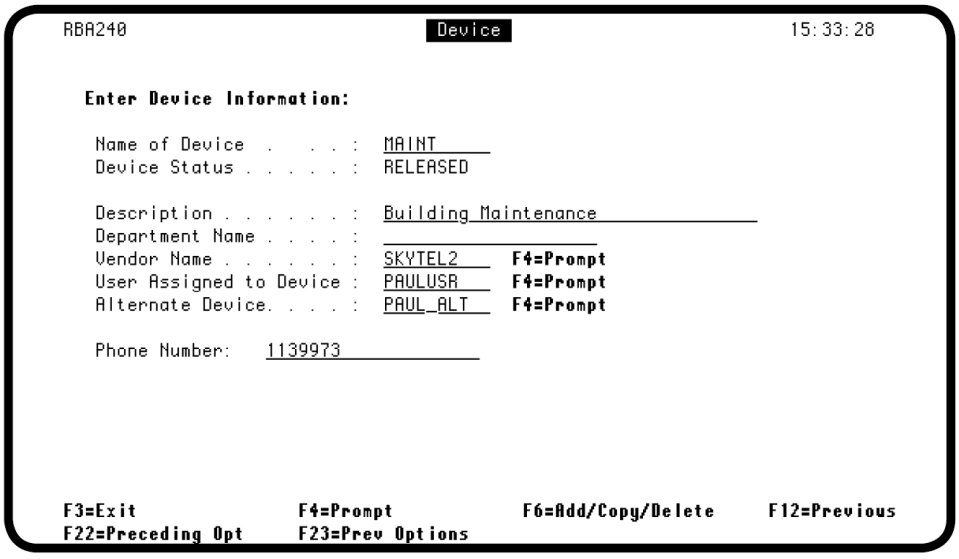
If you selected a phone (modem) device, the panel below is displayed:



If you selected an email device, the panel below is displayed:



Adding and Updating Modem Devices



Field Descriptions

Name of Device

Enter a device name up to ten characters in length.

Device Status

Displays the current status of the device.

Description

Enter a brief description of the device, such as the user assigned.

Department Name

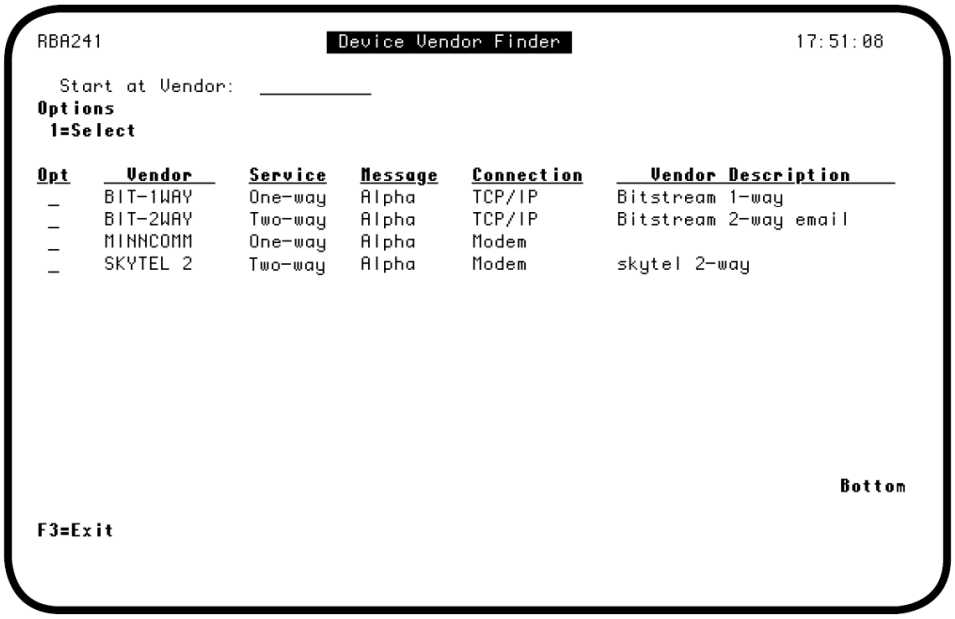
You can enter the name of the department the device is assigned to (optional).

Phone Number

Enter the phone number or device ID assigned to the device (often printed on the side of the device) if the vendor uses modem-to-modem connections.

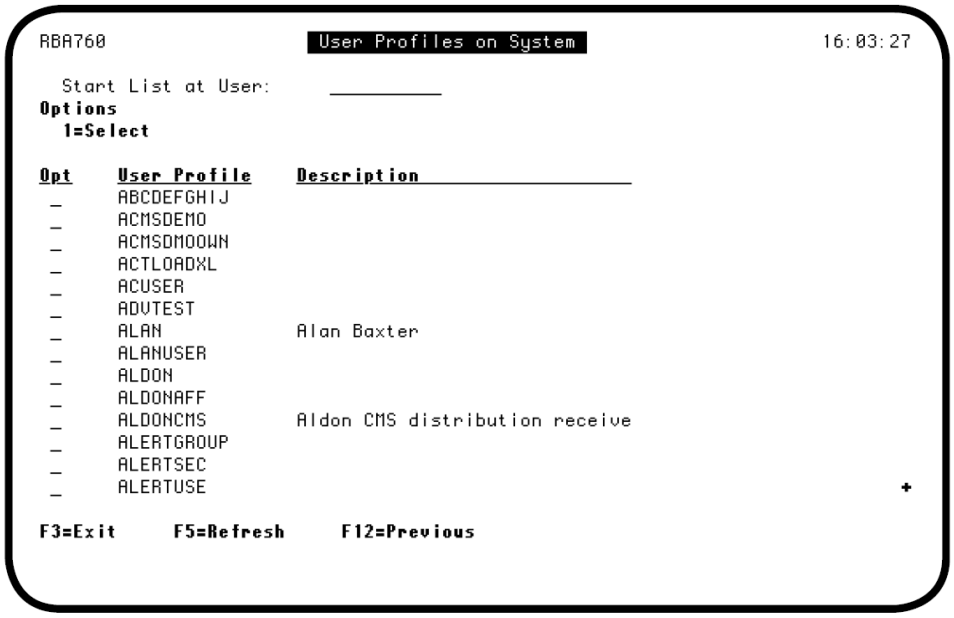
Vendor Name

Enter the name of the vendor the device is to be assigned to. For a list of vendor names defined in Robot Alert, press **F4**. The Device Vendor Finder panel displays. Select a vendor by entering a **1** in the Opt column.



User Assigned to Device

Enter the name of the user the device is to be assigned to. For a list of user names on the system, press **F4**. The User Profiles on System panel displays. Select a user profile by entering **1** in the Opt column.

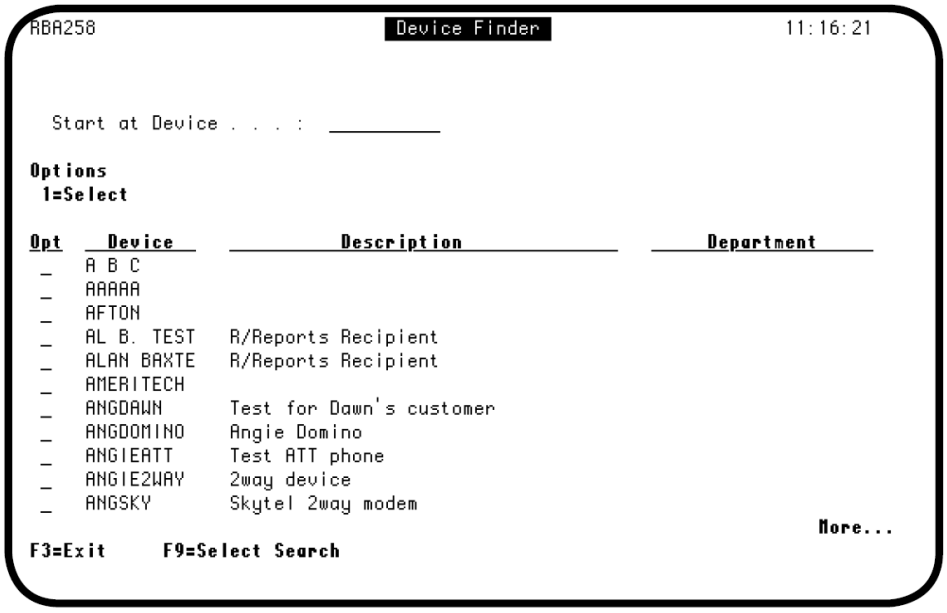


Alternate Device

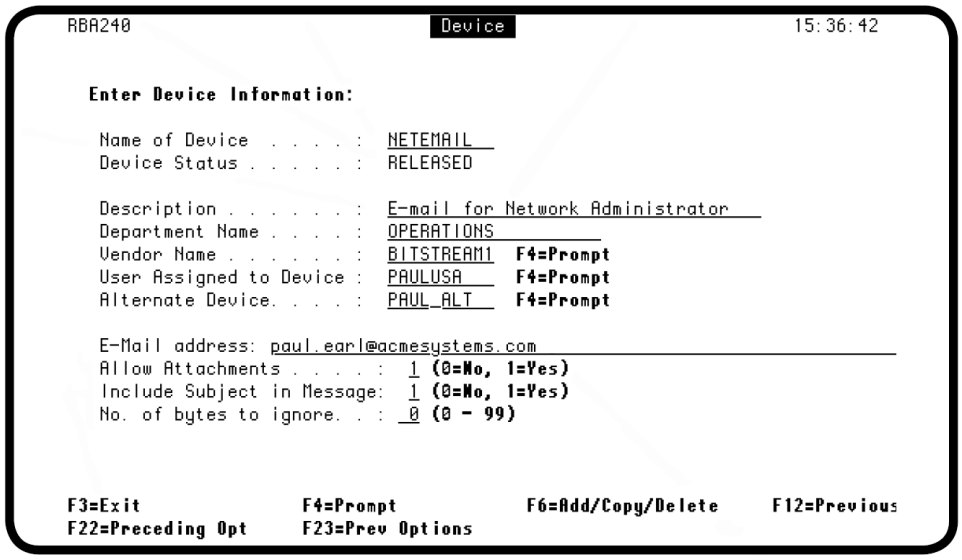
You can also specify an alternate device (optional) to be used if the regular device has a status of held. The following are the rules for specifying an alternate device:

- An alternate device must be an existing device, and the same device can be an alternate device for multiple devices.
- An alternate device must have a different name than its device (for example, the device MAINT cannot have an alternate device named MAINT).
- An alternate device cannot have an alternate device (only one level of alternate devices allowed).
- An alternate device can be a different type of device than the primary device. For example, an e-mail primary device can have a modem alternate device.
- If both the primary and alternate device are in a held status, the message will be in a held status.
- If the primary device is in a released status, the message is sent to the primary device.
- You cannot use a broadcast list as an alternate device, but a device specified in a broadcast list can be an alternate device.
- You must be authorized to use the device to specify it as an alternate device.

Enter the name of an alternate device to be used, For a list of device names defined in Robot Alert, press **F4**. The Device Finder panel displays. Select an alternate device by entering a **1** in the Opt column.



Adding and Updating Email Devices



Field Descriptions

Name of Device

Enter a device name up to ten characters in length.

Device Status

Displays the current status of the device.

Description

Enter a brief description of the device, such as the user assigned.

You can enter the name of the department the device is assigned to (optional).

Email Message Options

Enter the email address if you're sending the page using SMTP protocol with your email server, and the vendor uses an SMTP connection.

You may only have one email address for a device.

Allow Attachments

Specify whether to allow attachments to email messages (see the topic, The RBASNDMSG Command—Email Attachments, earlier in this section).

Include Subject in Message

Specify whether to have the subject of an email message appear in the message. This option applies to one-way messages only; for two-way messages, the subject must appear.

No. of bytes to ignore

Specify whether to ignore the first x number of bytes of data in the reply to a message. Use it to delete unnecessary characters that the device to which you're sending a message may add to the message when it sends a reply.

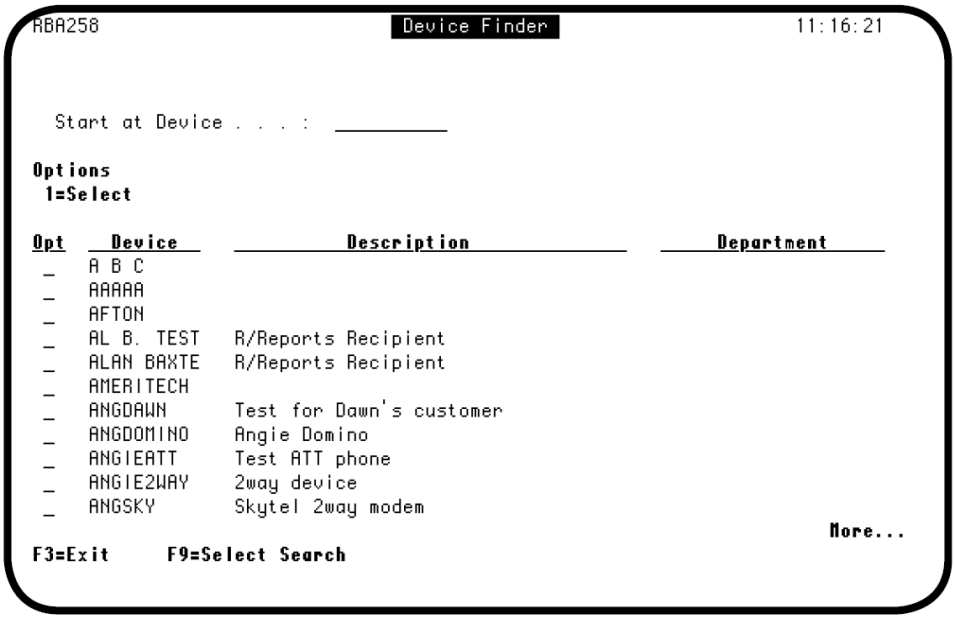
Alternate Device

You can also specify an alternate device (optional) to be used if the regular device has a status of held. The following are the rules for specifying an alternate device:

- An alternate device must be an existing device, and the same device can be an alternate device for multiple devices.

- An alternate device must have a different name than its device (for example, the device NETEMAIL cannot have an alternate device named NETEMAIL).
- An alternate device cannot have an alternate device (only one level of alternate devices allowed).
- An alternate device can be a different type of device than the primary device. For example, an email primary device can have a modem alternate device.
- If both the primary and alternate device are in a held status, the message will be in a held status.
- If the primary device is in a released status, the message is sent to the primary device.
- You cannot use a broadcast list as an alternate device, but a device specified in a broadcast list can be an alternate device.
- You must be authorized to use the device to specify it as an alternate device.

Enter the name of an alternate device to be used, For a list of device names defined in Robot Alert, press **F4**. The Device Finder panel displays. Select an alternate device by entering a **1** in the Opt column.



Broadcast Lists

Want to send the same message to multiple devices? Instead of typing the message many times, use a broadcast list. Broadcast lists are a useful messaging tool and can be used three ways:

- To page a group of people who always receive the same message.
- To page the person on duty, automatically, by entering each person's work schedule into the broadcast list.
- As part of an automatic problem escalation system to notify a person higher in the chain of command if another person does not respond to an emergency page.

There is no limit to the number of broadcast lists you can create, or the number of lists on which a device can be listed.

You can secure a device name so that only a select group can send messages to it. However, if a person is authorized to a broadcast list, but not authorized to every device on the list, those devices will not receive the message.

The broadcast list time restriction function requires the work calendars of Robot Schedule, Fortra's job scheduler. You can enter a special work calendar for your broadcast list into Robot Schedule. If you don't have Robot Schedule, call us.

Page Specific Groups of People

You can set up broadcast lists according to your specific group needs:

- If you send messages with sales meeting information to your field sales force, set up a SALES broadcast list.
- If you send daily sales statistics with a message to your executives on the road, set up an EXECUTIVE broadcast list.

When you send a message to a broadcast list, a message is created for each device in the list and sent to the pending message queue for transmission.

Who's on Duty?

Sending a message to a shift position that is covered by different people, can be difficult. The person sending the message must first determine who is on duty at that time and date. Robot Alert has a better way. Enter each person's work schedule and device IDs into a broadcast list and call it OPERATOR. When the message goes to the OPERATOR list, Robot Alert determines who should get the message and sends it to the proper device. If work schedules change, just change the schedule in the broadcast list.

Problem Escalation

Need someone, anyone, to respond to a page? Robot Alert can automate the process.

1. Enter the devices into the broadcast list in the order of notification.
2. Select the response-required option on the broadcast list.
3. Robot Alert sends a message to the first person on the list for whatever schedule you set.
4. If the first person does not respond with a two-way device, call in, or dial in with a PC to acknowledge the message, Robot Alert pages the next person on the list.
5. If there still is no response, Robot Alert pages the next person, and so forth. You can use the Days Available or Time Restriction option to have different staff backups for different days of the week, or hours of the night.

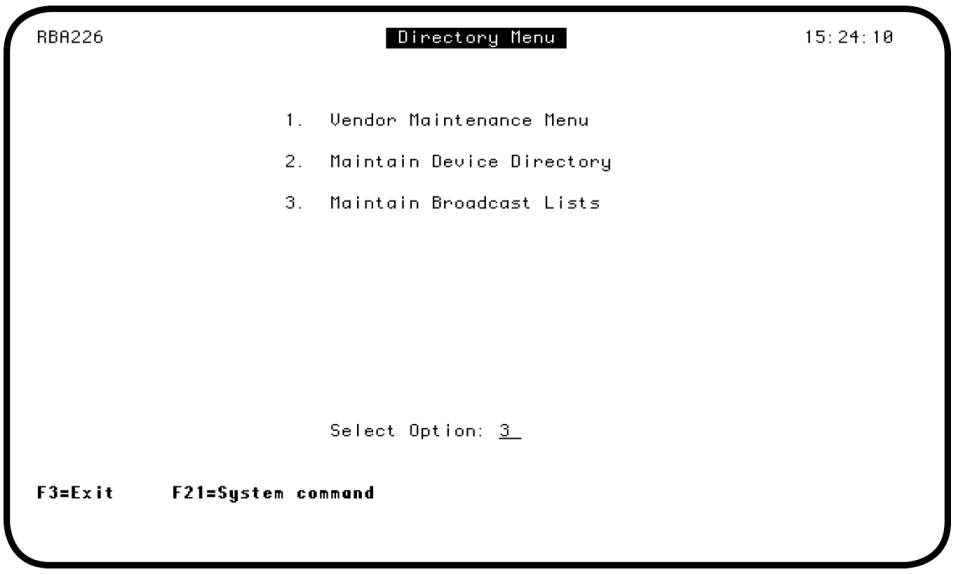
Combine Techniques

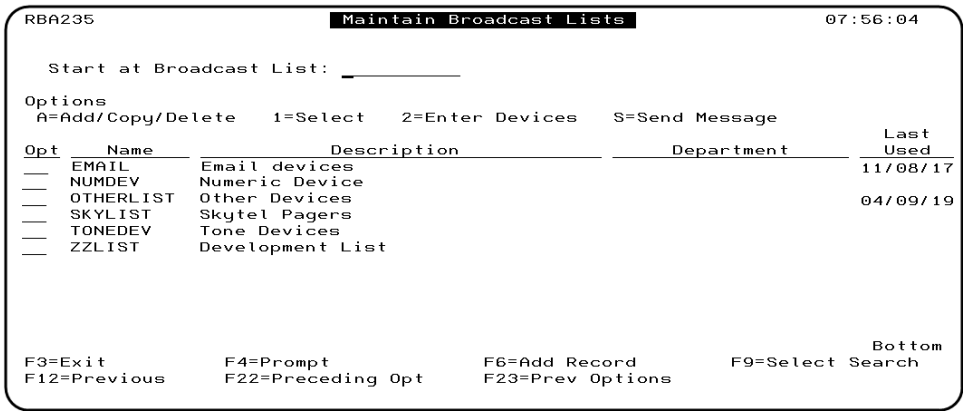
You can combine paging by work schedule with automatic problem escalation in a broadcast list. Or, a supervisor can receive a copy of all staff messages. Uses for broadcast lists are almost unlimited.

Maintaining Broadcast Lists

The Maintain Broadcast Lists panel lists the broadcast lists that have been defined to Robot Alert. Included with each broadcast list is a brief description of the list and the department associated with the list (if applicable). In this panel, you can view more information for a list, add devices to a list, add broadcast lists, copy list information, or delete lists.

To access the Maintain Broadcast Lists panel, select option **3** from the Directory Menu.



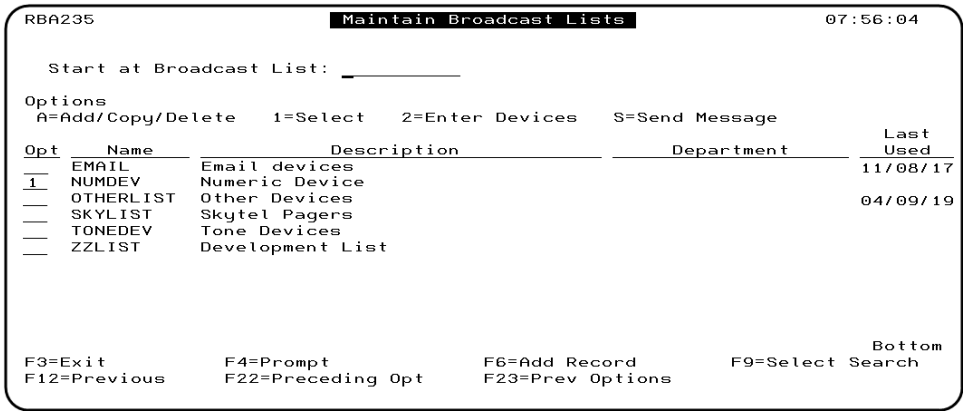


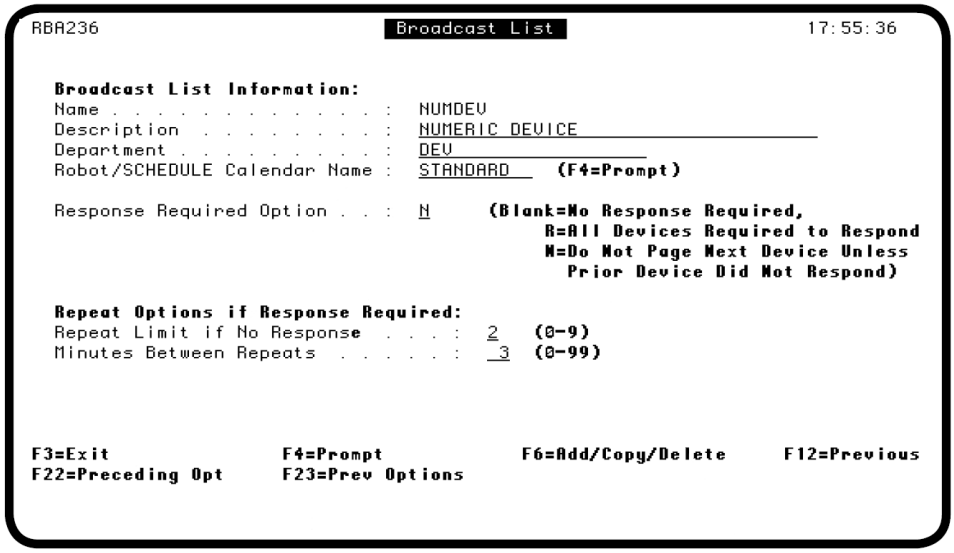
Press **F9** and select an option to display the panel information by broadcast list order, or by department and broadcast list.

Adding or Updating Broadcast Lists

To add a broadcast list, press **F6** or enter **A** in the Opt column on the Maintain Broadcast Lists panel.

To perform maintenance to an existing list, enter **1** next to the list.





Field Descriptions

Name

Enter a broadcast list name up to ten characters in length.

Description

Enter a brief description of the broadcast list

Department

Enter the name of the department for which the broadcast list is being created (optional)

Robot Schedule Calendar Name

If you have Robot Schedule, you can use the time restriction function of the broadcast list. The Robot Schedule calendar you enter determines whether or not it is a workday when broadcasting a message. Press **F4** to display a list of valid Robot Schedule Calendar names (see below). Select a name from the list by entering **1** in the blank next to the name.

Response Required Option

Use a response-required message whenever it is important to have confirmation that the message was received and noted. Robot Alert re-sends the message until somebody acknowledges on the pending message queue that the message was received.

- Enter **R** to send a response-required message to all devices on the list when the message is created.
- Enter **N** to page the next device in the list if the prior device did not respond within the response limit.
- Leave blank if no response is required.

Repeat Limit if No Response

Enter the number of times Robot Alert should repeat the message if no response is received.

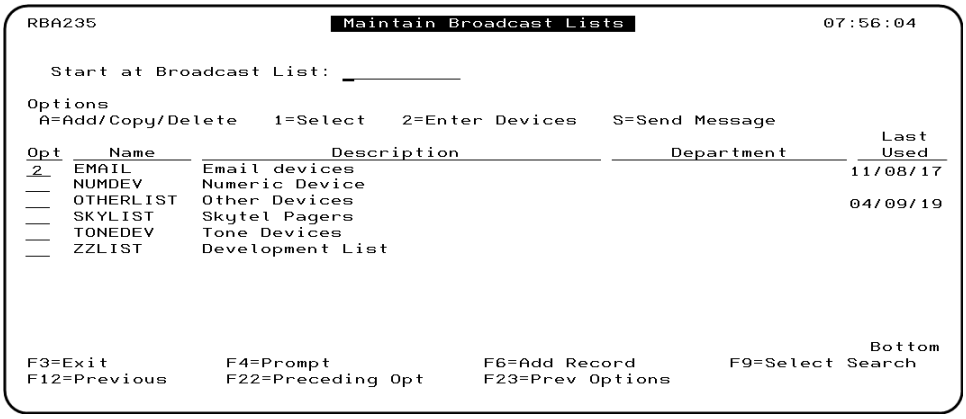
Minutes Between Repeats

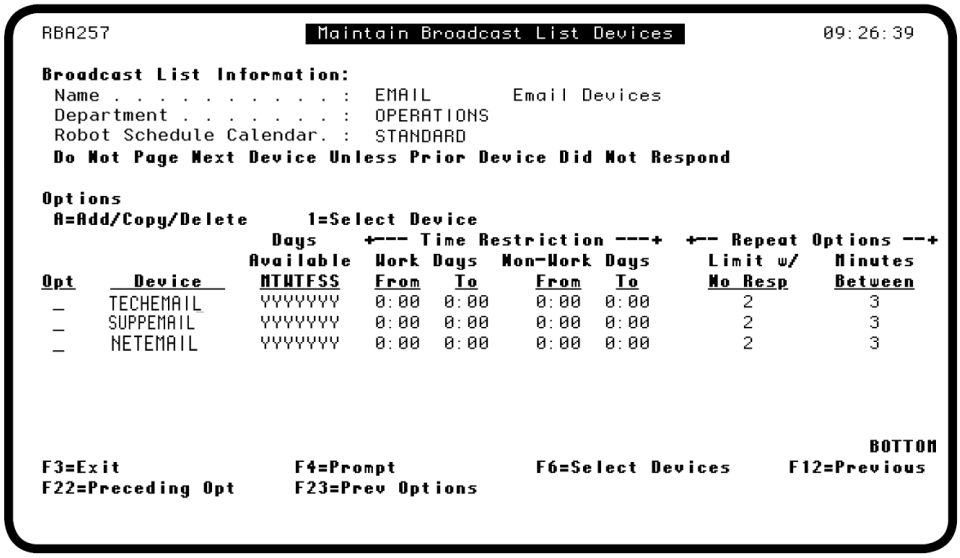
Enter the number of minutes Robot Alert waits before repeating the message.

Adding Devices to a Broadcast List

The Maintain Broadcast List Devices panel lets you add and maintain devices for a broadcast list. Options on the panel include adding, changing, and deleting broadcast list devices; selecting a device to view additional information; and sending a message to a broadcast list. If you use Robot Schedule, you can also set up time restrictions for each device in the list.

To display the Maintain Broadcast List Device panel, enter option **2** next to a broadcast list.





Field Descriptions

Broadcast List Information

Shows the name and brief description of the broadcast list, and department name (if used).

If you use Robot Schedule and have assigned a Robot Schedule Calendar Name to the list, it appears here.

The Response Required Option specified on the Broadcast List panel displays here.

Time Restriction

The times during a workday or non-workday (based on the selected Robot Schedule calendar) that Robot Alert will **not** send a message to the device. You can use these fields only if you have specified a Robot Schedule Calendar Name.

Repeat Options

The number of times (**0-9**) Robot Alert should repeat the message if it gets no response from the response-required device and the number of minutes (**0-99**) that Robot Alert should wait between each attempt.

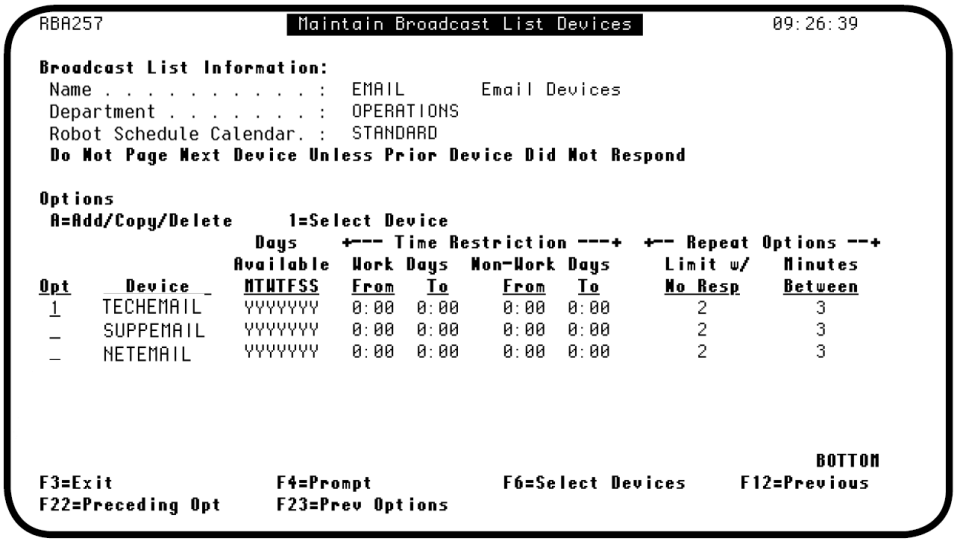
Days Available MTWTFSS

Y Indicates a day Robot Alert will send a message to the device.

N Indicates that no message will be sent on that day.

F6 = Select Devices

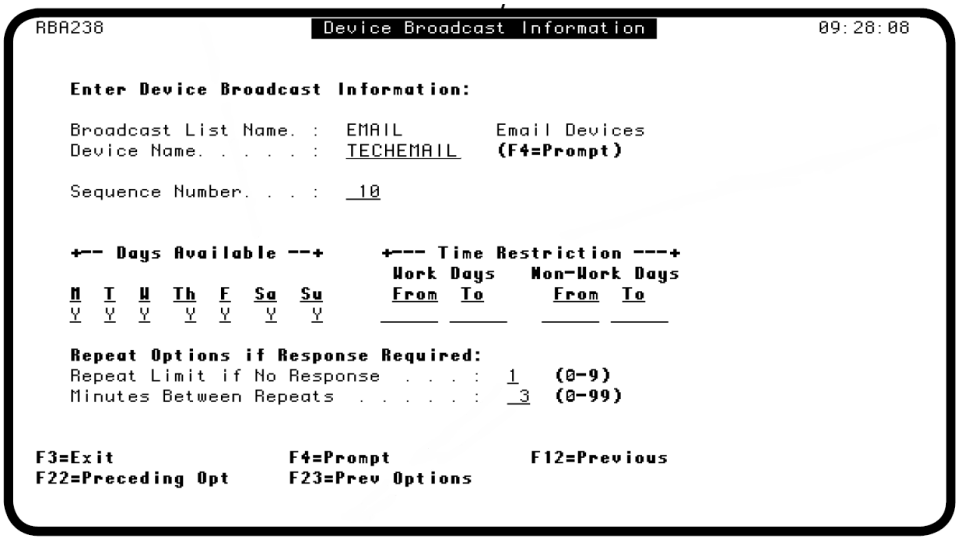
To select from a list of valid devices set up in Robot Alert, press **F6**. The Select Devices for Broadcast List panel displays. Enter **1** next to the device names you want to select.



To view specific information on a particular device, enter option **1** next to the device. The Device Broadcast Information panel displays.

Entering Device Broadcast Information

The Device Broadcast Information panel displays the specific information on a device assigned to the broadcast list. It allows you to change the device's sequence number in the broadcast list and enter or change the days available information for the device. If you have specified a Robot Calendar Name, you also can enter time restrictions for workday and non-workday messaging.



Field Descriptions

Days Available

Enter a **Y** under each day of the week that a message can be sent to the user. Enter an **N** on the days that messages should not be sent to the user.

Time Restriction

The times during a workday or non-workday, based on the selected Robot Schedule calendar, that Robot Alert will **not** send a message to that device.

Repeat Options if Response Required

The number of times (**0-9**) Robot Alert should repeat the message if it gets no response from the response-required device and the number of minutes (**0-99**) that Robot Alert should wait between each attempt.

Getting Started

Modem Setup

Before you set up Robot Alert for paging, ask your paging service representative the following questions. You need this information to set up Robot Alert to use a modem connection.

One-Way and Two-Way Paging Services Questionnaire

Does the service support Telocator Alphanumeric Protocol (TAP)? If not, what protocol do they support?

What is the phone number of the paging service's computer modem?

What is the maximum number of characters in a message that the paging service computer will accept? (Robot Alert handles up to 1,000.)

What are their computer modem settings for the following:

- Baud rate:
- Duplex (FULL or HALF):
- Parity (EVEN, ODD, NONE):
- Number of data bits per character (7 or 8):
- Number of stop bits per character (1 or 2):

TCP/IP Setup

Robot Alert supports three TCP/IP protocols—SMTP, POP3, and SNPP—to send messages using the Internet.

To send external email, your SMTP email server must connect to the Internet. If your email server is not your IBM i, verify that your IBM i can connect to your email server using a TCP/IP connection.

- For one-way email messaging, Robot Alert uses your SMTP email server to send outgoing messages.

- For two-way email messaging, Robot Alert uses your SMTP email server to send outgoing messages and your POP3 email server to receive incoming replies from those messages.
- For paging services, Robot Alert uses SNPP to send and receive pager messages.

Supply the appropriate information to set up your email vendor:

One-Way Email (SMTP) Services Questionnaire

SMTP Host Name (domain name or IP address) _____

SMTP Server Port # _____

Enable TLS or SSL? _____

Send Robot Alert Messages to Email Address_____

Two-Way Email (SMTP and POP3) Services Questionnaire

SMTP Host Name (domain name or IP address) _____

SMTP Server Port # _____

Enable TLS or SSL? _____

Send Robot Alert Messages to Email Address _____

POP3 Host Name (domain name or IP address) _____

POP3 Server Port # _____

Enable SSL? _____

POP3 Account Name _____

POP3 Account Password _____

POP3 Email Address _____

Two-Way Paging (SNPP) Services Questionnaire

SNPP Host Name (domain name or IP address) _____

SNPP Server Port # _____

System Requirements

IBM i version 7.2 or higher.

Installing and Accessing Robot Alert

The first part of automating your messaging process is to install Robot Alert and specify your communication jobs, vendors, and devices. After installation you can check and reset your system default values. Then, you're ready to test the process of sending and receiving messages.

The quick tours on this and the following pages help you through these processes quickly and with a minimum of information. For more detailed information, refer to the Administration section and System Setup section of this user guide.

To install Robot Alert:

1. Complete the appropriate Paging Services Questionnaire earlier in this section for the appropriate types of communication services, modem or TCP/IP.
2. Read and follow the Robot Alert installation instructions included with the package.
3. During installation, the installation process will automatically start Robot Guide, your online installation assistant to help you set up your devices and vendors.

   You can also use Robot Guide to maintain and/or set up additional vendors and devices after you have finished installing Robot Alert.

   Note: To start Robot Guide at a later time, enter the following command:

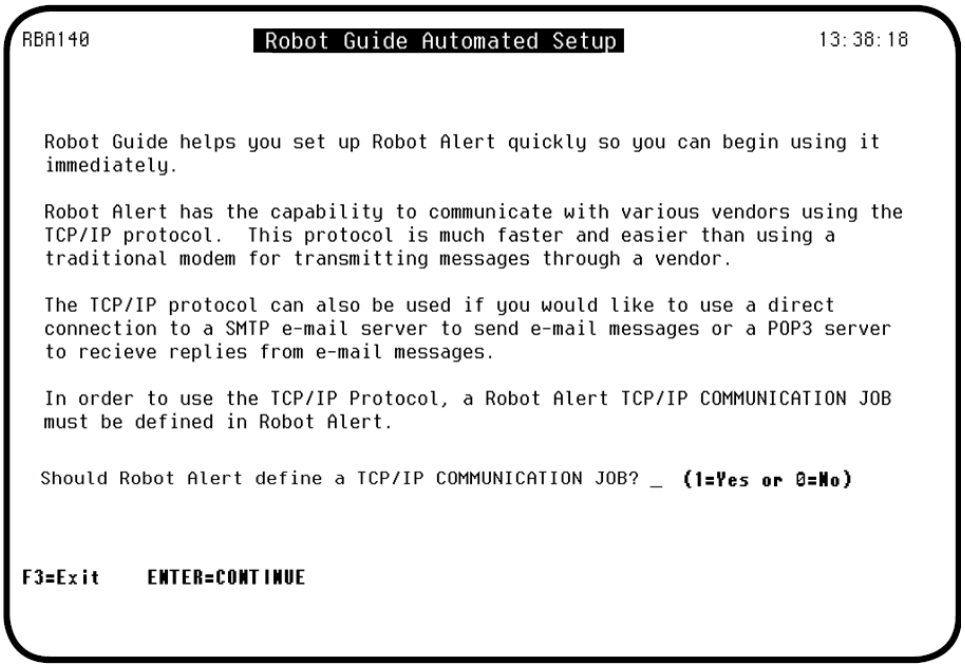
   RBTALRLIB/RBAGUIDE

Quick Tour 1: Using Robot Guide to Set Up Communication Jobs

1. Robot Guide, the online assistant, will guide you through the process of setting up communication jobs, vendors, and devices.

   The first panel that displays, the Robot Guide Automated Setup panel, offers the option of defining TCP/IP communication jobs. You can specify **1** (yes) or **0** (no).

   Select option 1, Define a TCP/IP Communication Job, if you plan to use email or SNPP communications.

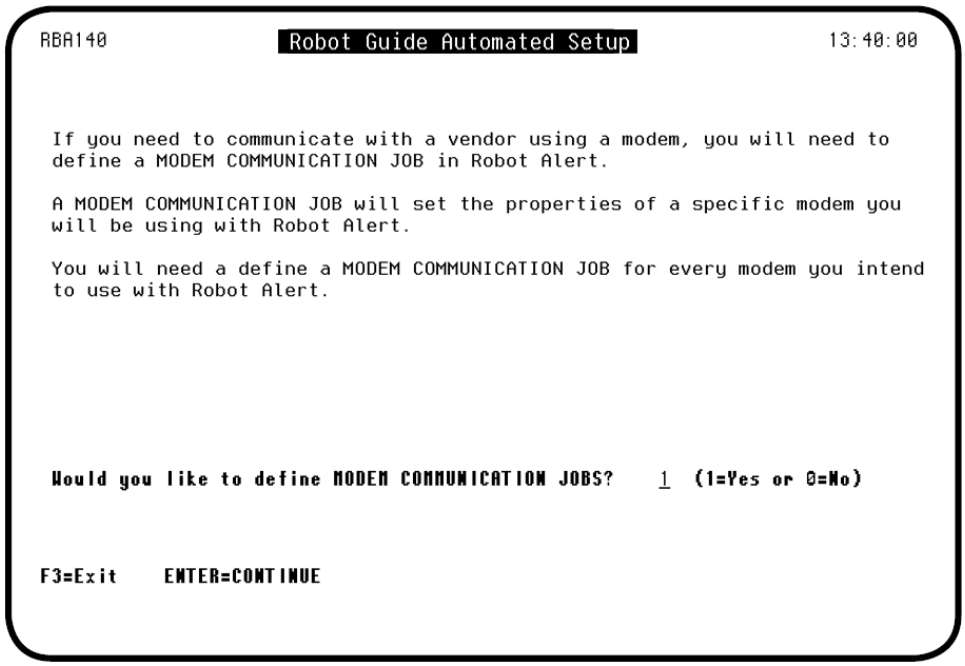


2. The Robot Guide Automated Setup panel displays offering the option of defining modem communication jobs. You can specify **1** (yes) or **0** (no).

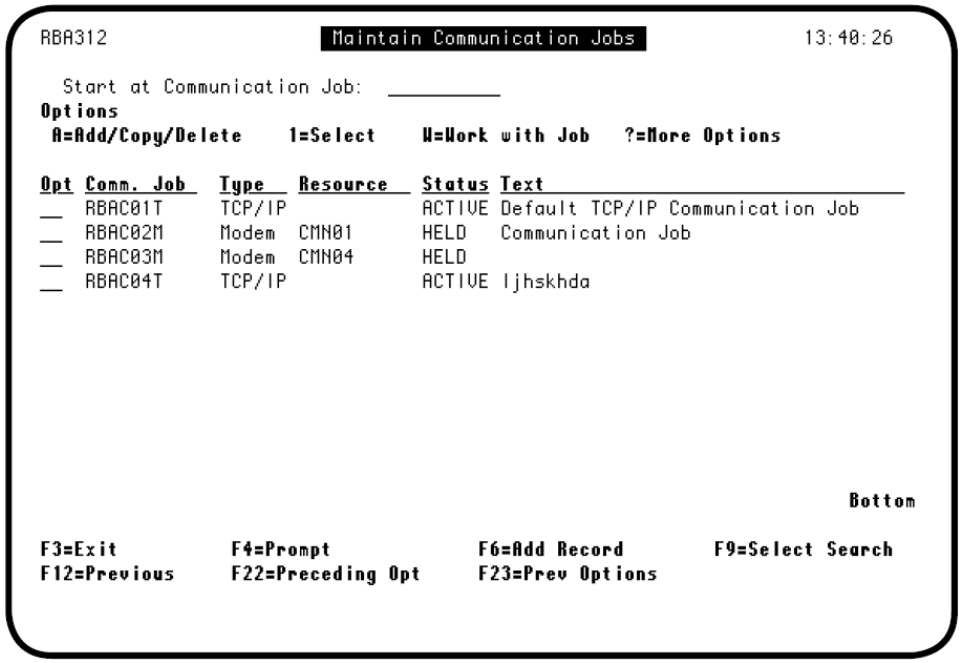
   Select option **1**, Define a Modem Communication Job, if you plan to use modem communications.

   - If you specified Yes (**1**), for either TCP/IP or modem, go to Step 3.
   - If you specified No (**0**), for both TCP/IP and modem, go to Step 6.

   You can specify both TCP/IP and modem communication jobs.



3. The Maintain Communication Jobs panel displays. From this panel, press **F6** to define a communication job.

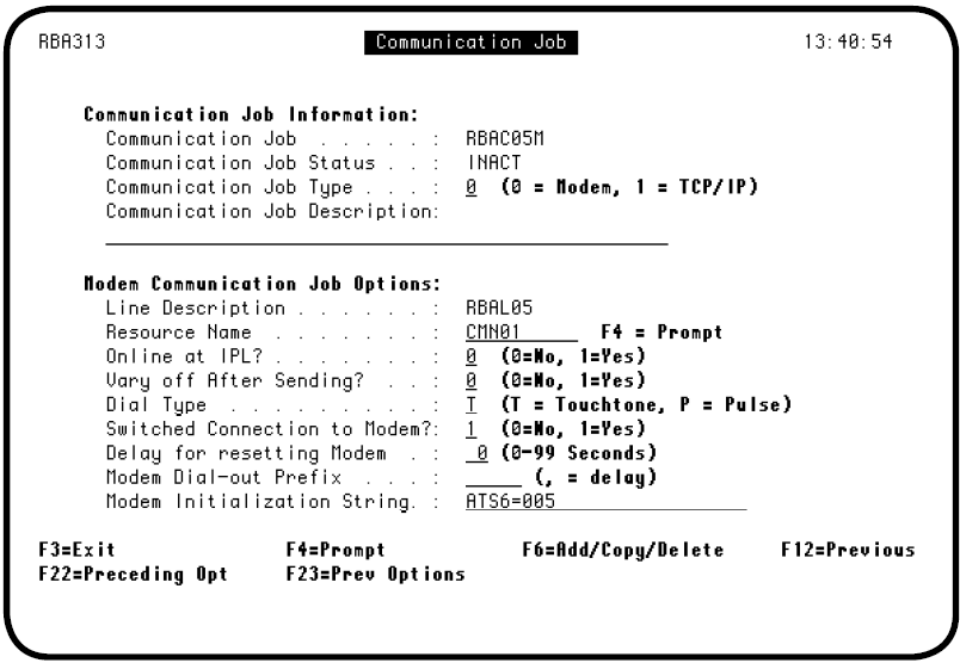


4. The Communication Job panel displays. On this panel you enter information describing the communication job, including the type (modem or TCP/IP). If you specify modem (**0**), you see the following options:

a. Resource Name value is validated against the hardware resources on the system. Press **F4** for a list of options.

b. Vary off After Sending determines whether your communication line will remain varied on.

- Enter **0** (no) if you have a dedicated line, or are using the line solely for Robot Alert.
- Enter **1** (yes) if you want to use the communication line for other purposes. The line will be varied off after messages are sent.

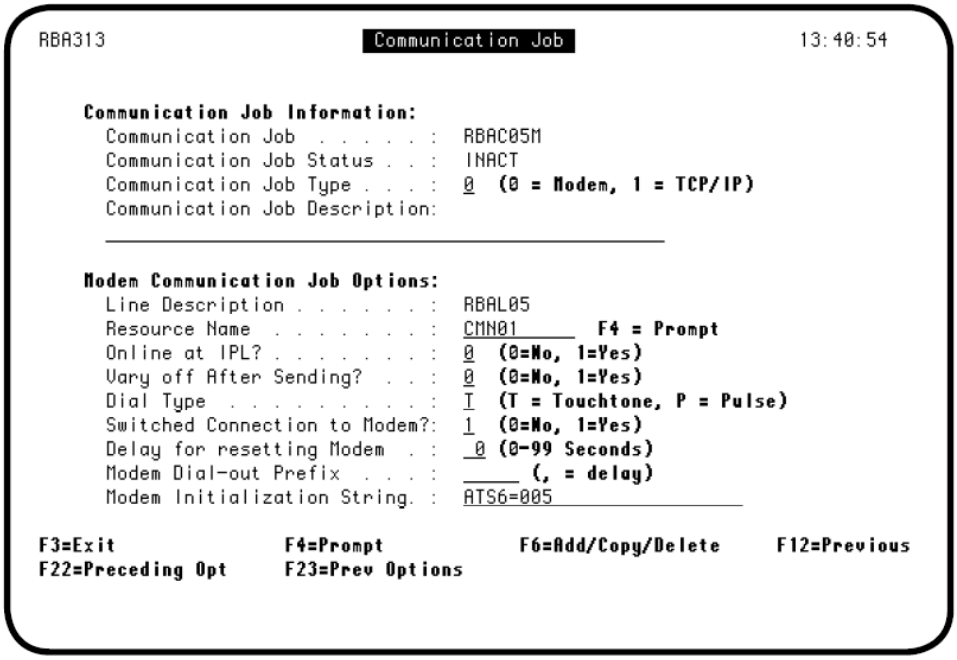


c. Dial type determines the autodial command that Robot Alert sends when it dials out.

- Enter **T** if your phone service supports touch-tone.
- Enter **P** if you have a rotary-style line.

d. For Switched Connection to Modem, specify the following:

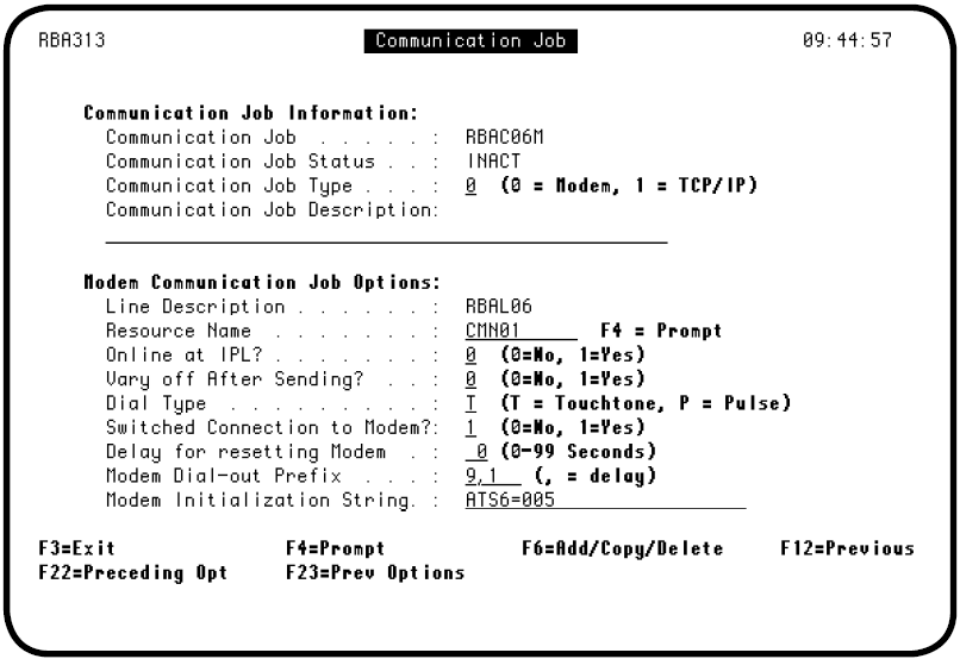
1 IBM modems
0 Hayes and non-IBM modems



e. The Modem Dial-out Prefix is prefixed to the vendor phone numbers when the communication job attempts to connect to a vendor with a modem. Your phone system may require a prefix to dial out; use this option to enter the prefix (such as 9). Use a comma (,) as a signal for the computer to pause to wait for a dial tone.

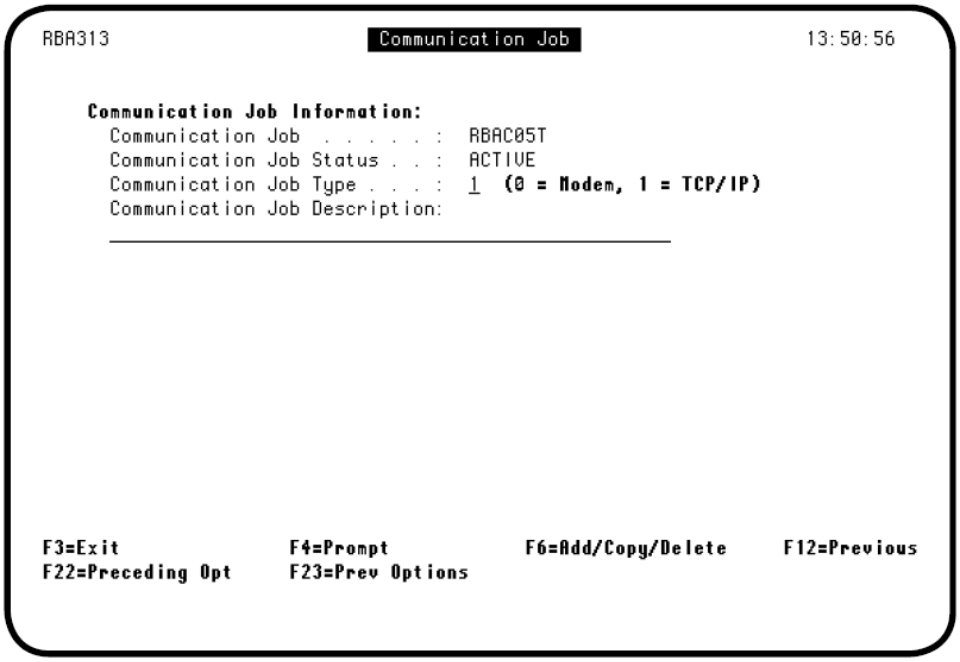
f. The Modem Initialization String defines a modem command that Robot Alert will send to initialize the modem before it dials the vendor's modem number.

   This string should always contain AT as the first two characters.

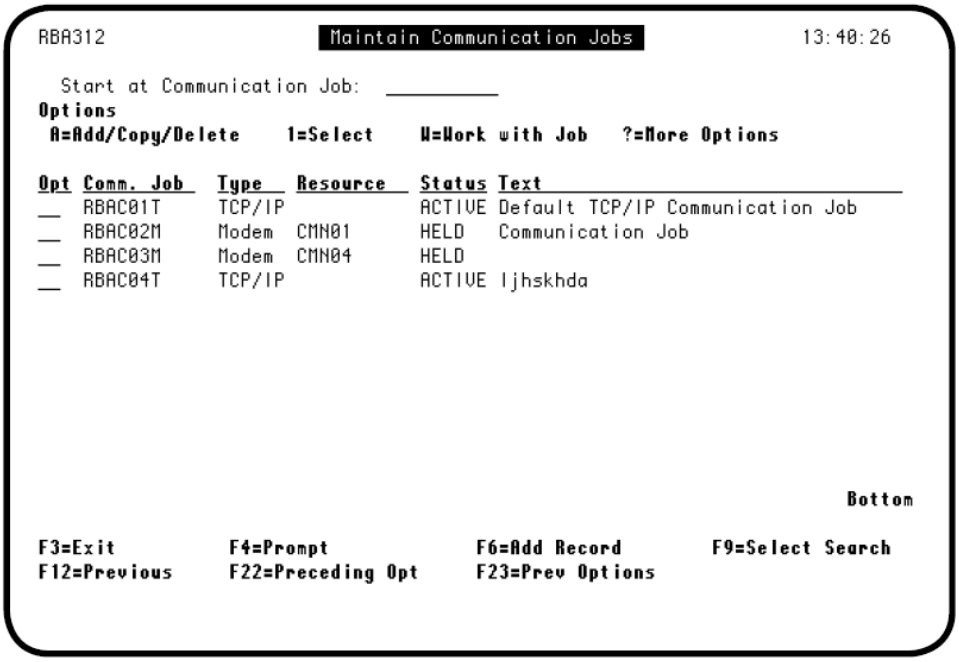


g. If you specify TCP/IP (**1**), the Communications Job panel redisplays with only the options for TCP/IP communication jobs.

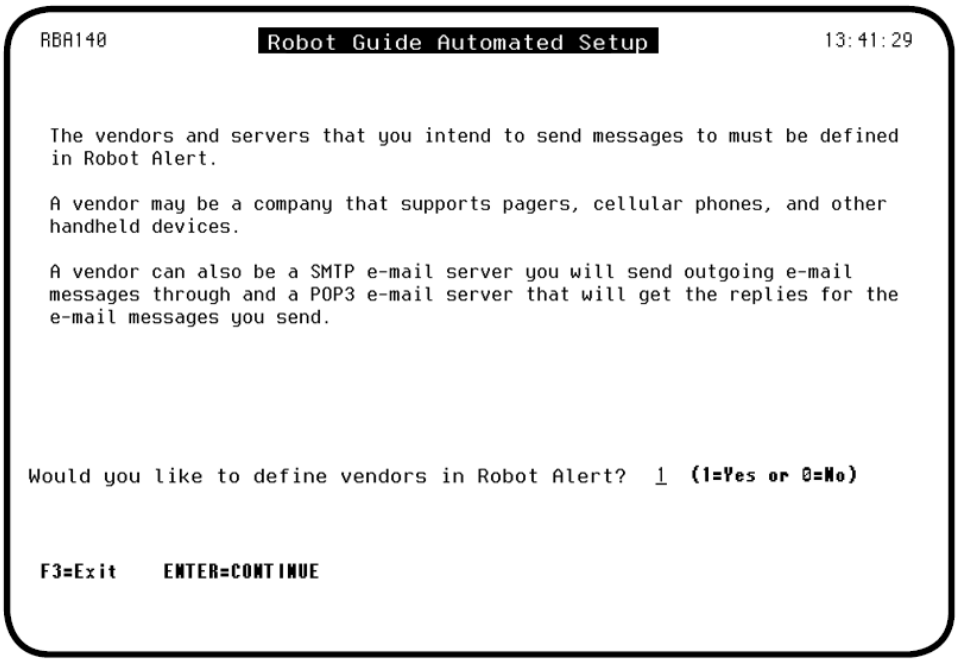
   You can enter a description of the communication job. This description is limited to 50 characters.



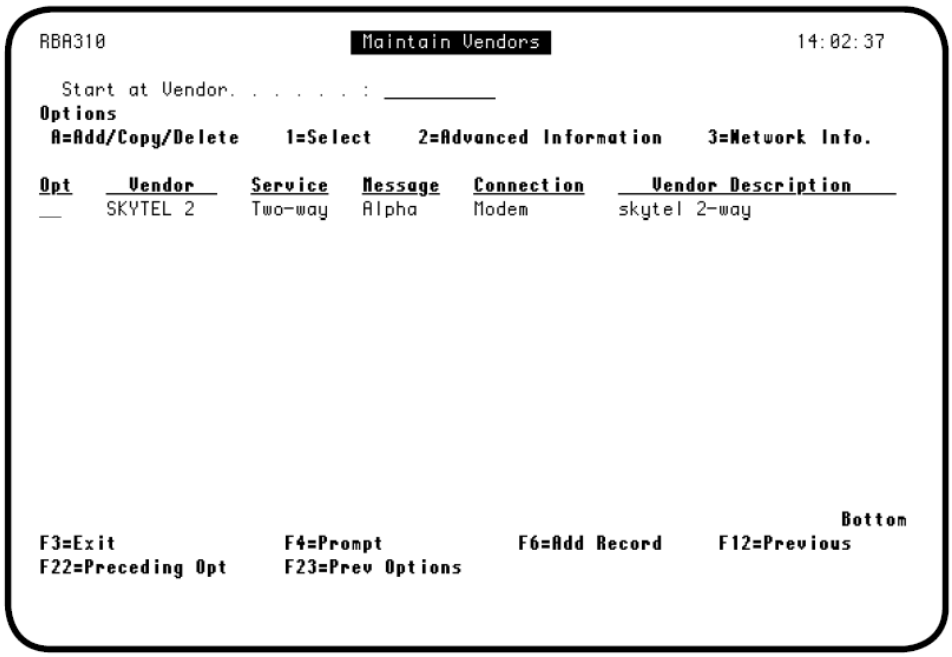
5. When you're finished, press **F3** to return to the Maintain Communication Jobs panel. You can create another communication job by pressing **F6**, or you can proceed to Step 6 by pressing **F3**.



6. The Robot Guide Automated Setup redisplays, offering you the option defining vendors.
   - If you specify Yes (**1**), the panels shown below appear.
   - If you specify No (**0**), go to Step 19.



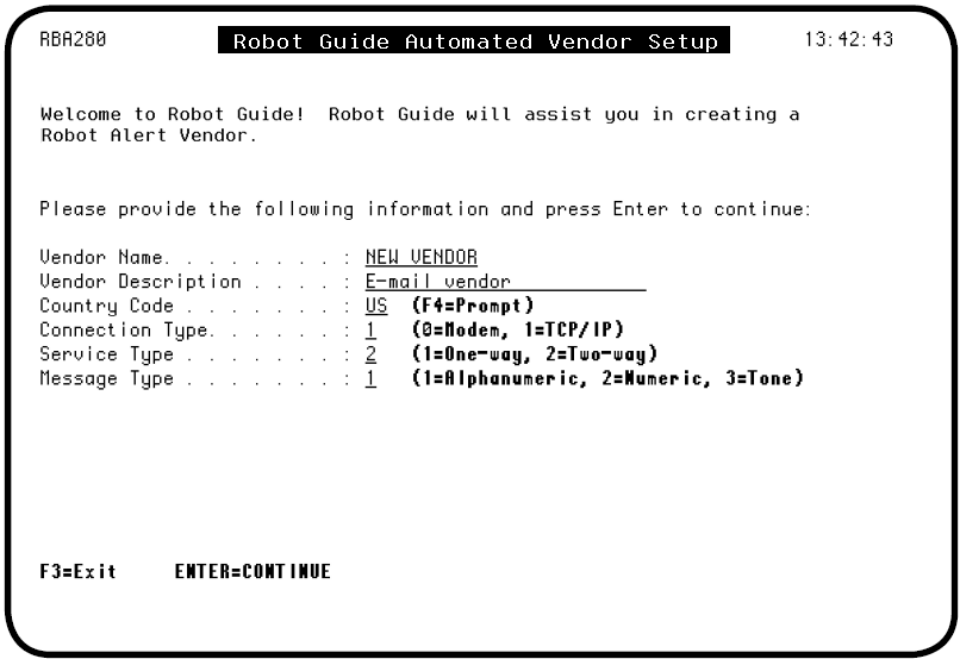
7. The Maintain Vendors panel appears. From this panel, press **F6** to define a vendor.



8. From the panel that displays, enter information to define your vendor. Your selections determine subsequent options that Robot Guide displays.

- Enter the name of your vendor and a brief description. Enter your vendor's country code (press **F4** for a list of country codes).
- Specify the connection type and the type of service for this vendor, one-way or two-way.
- Specify the type of messages you will be sending to this vendor, alphanumeric, numeric, or tone.

9. Press **F3** to return to the Vendor Maintenance panel. You can define another vendor (**F6**). Or, press Enter to continue and go to Step 10.

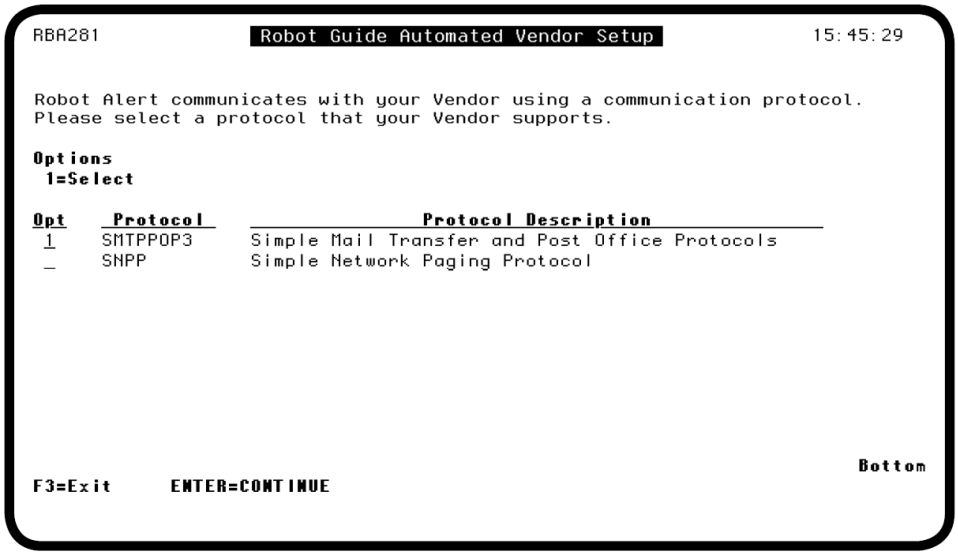


Quick Tour 2: Using Robot Guide to Set Up Vendors (TCP/IP)

1. The Robot Guide Automated Setup panel displays with protocol options:
   - If you specified two-way TCP/IP service in Step 8, the options shown at the left, SMTPPOP3 (email) and SNPP (pager), appear.
   - If you specified one-way TCP/IP service in Step 8, select SMTPPOP3 (email) or SNPP (traps).
   - If you specified Modem in Step 8, go to Step 16.

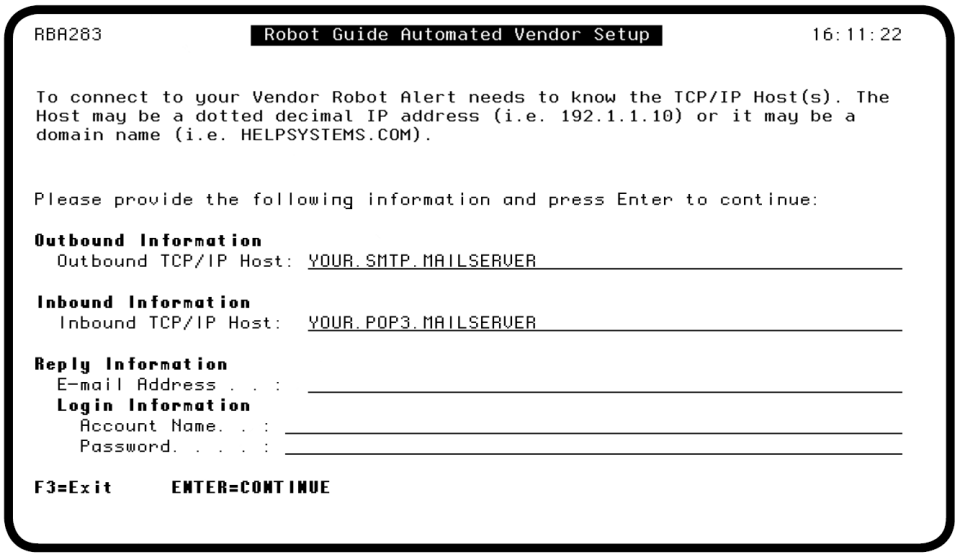
   Select a protocol by entering a **1** next to it and pressing Enter.
   - If you specified two-way SMTPPOP3, go to Step 11.
   - If you specified one-way SMTPPOP3, go to Step 12.

- If you specified SNPP, go to Step 13.



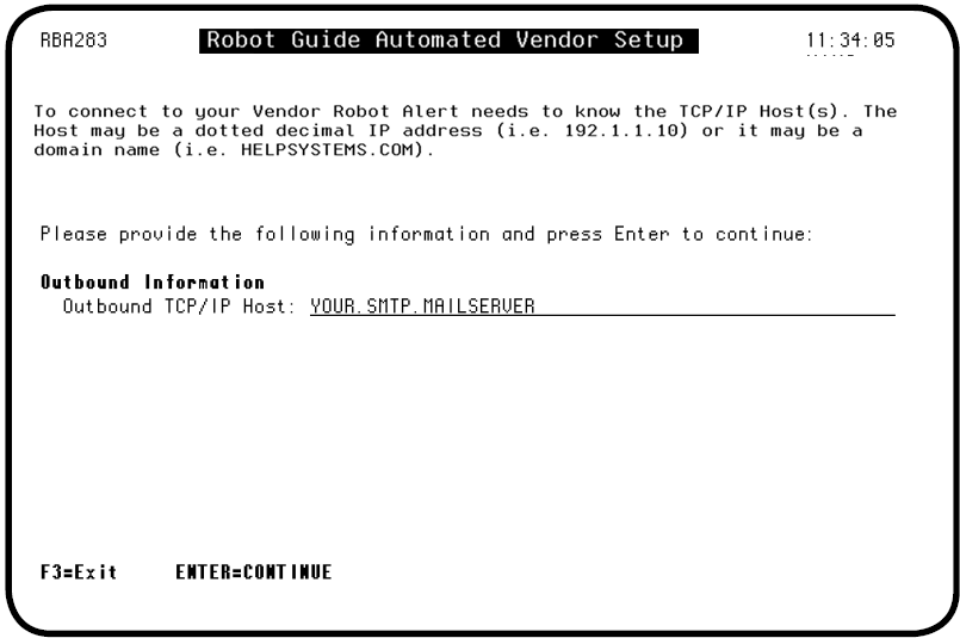
2. Replace the outbound Host name with either the IP address or the domain name of your email server. Replace the inbound Host name with the IP address or the domain name of your TCP/IP Host. Enter the email address, account name, and password for the mailbox on the inbound Host that will be receiving the replies.

   Press Enter and go to Step 14.



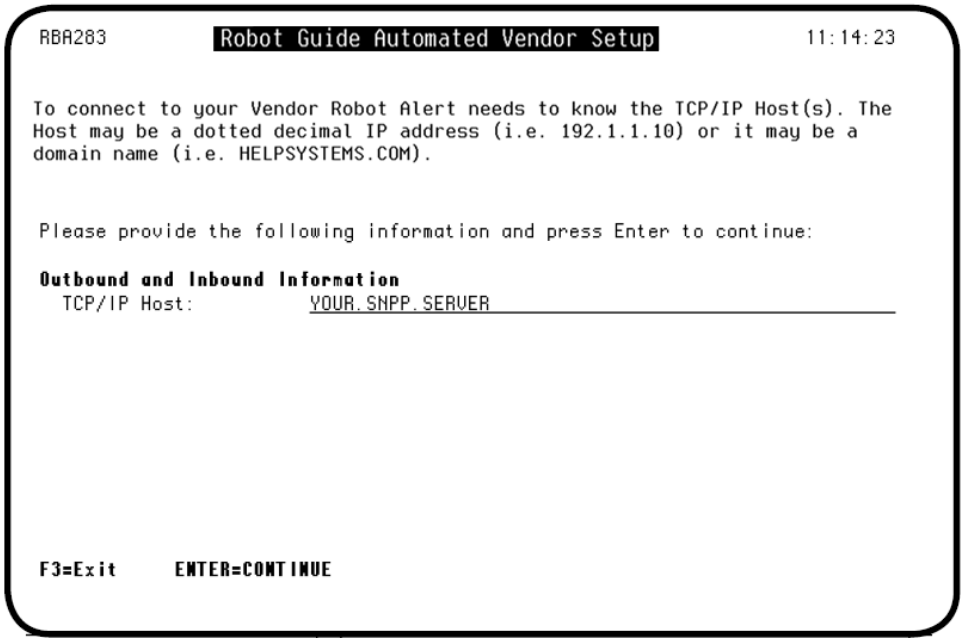
3. Replace the Outbound TCP/IP Host with the outbound Host address (the Host to which you're sending the message).

   Press Enter and go to Step 14.



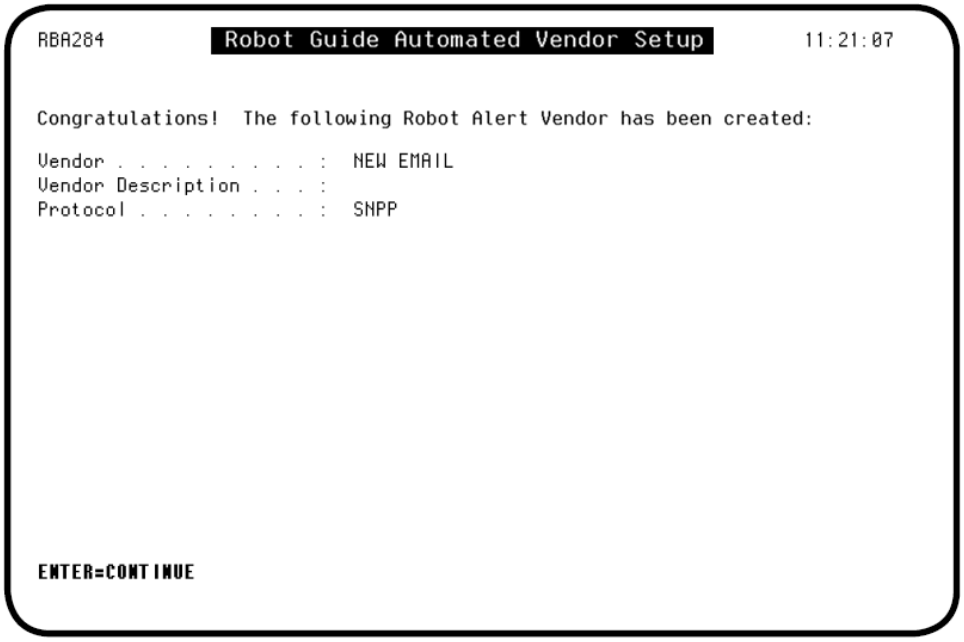
4. Replace the TCP/IP Host with the IP address or domain name of your vendor's TCP/IP Host.

   Press Enter.

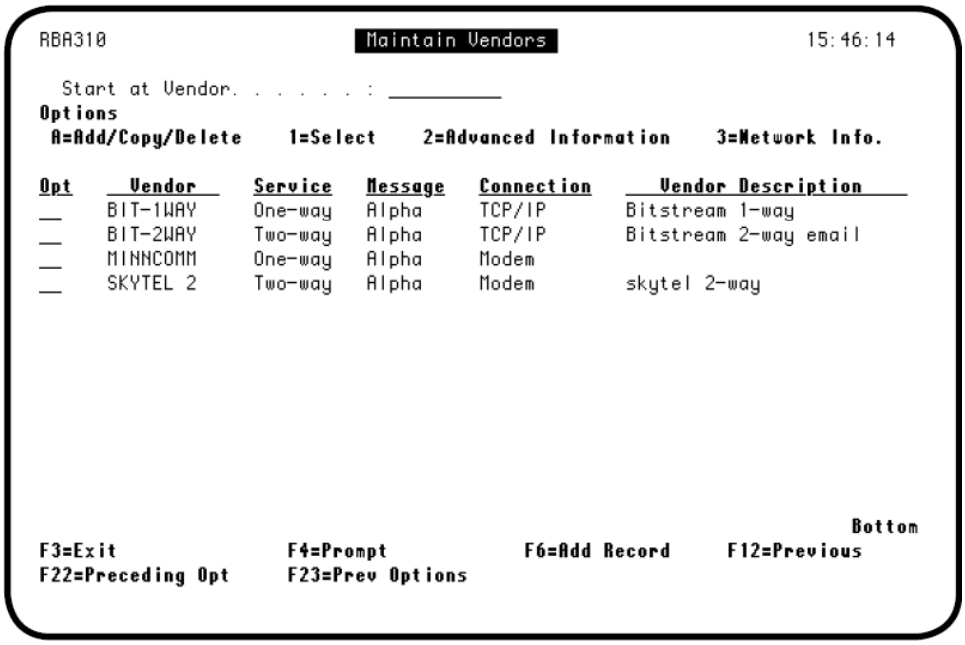


5. The Robot Guide Automated Vendor Setup panel redisplays with your new vendor.

   Press Enter to return to the Maintain Vendors panel.



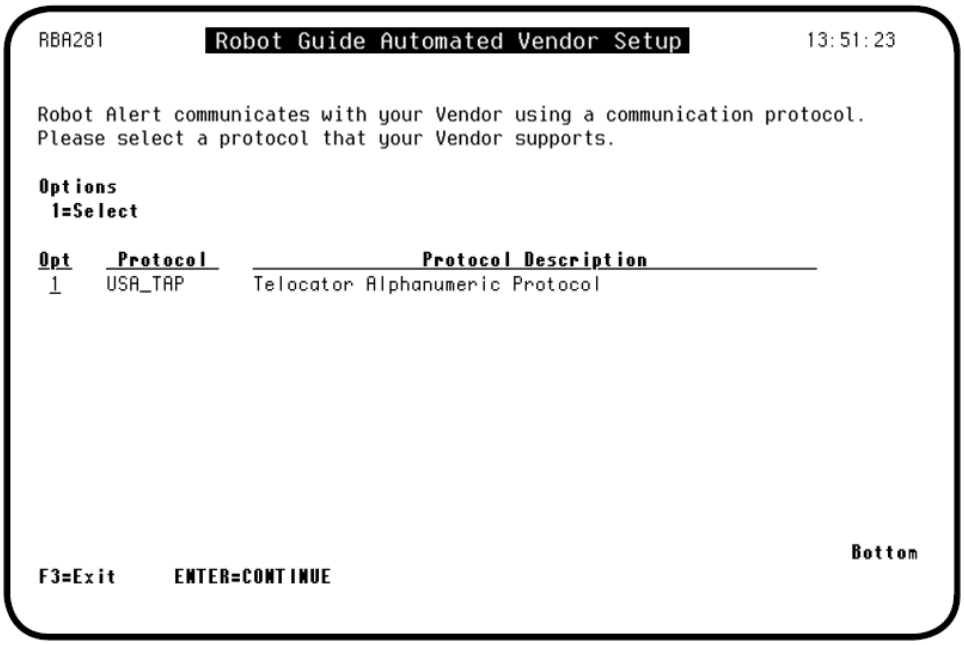
6. From the Maintain Vendors panel you can create another vendor by pressing **F6**. Or, press **F3** to create a device and go to Step 19.



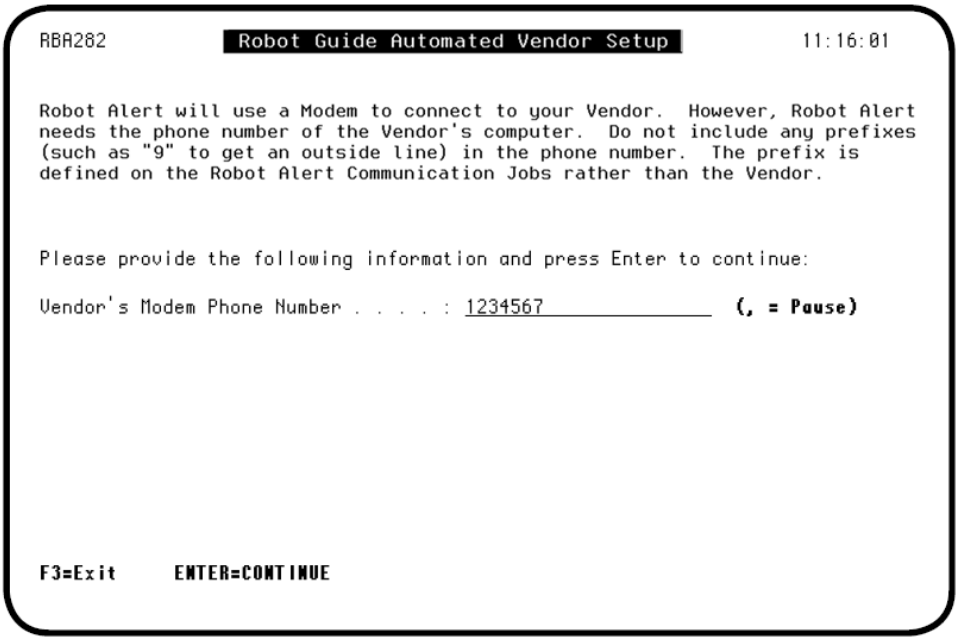
Quick Tour 3: Using Robot Guide to Set Up Vendors (modem)

1. The Robot Guide Automated Setup panel displays with the option for you to select a protocol.

- If you specified one-way service in Step 8, the option shown at the left, USA_TAP, appears.
- If you specified two-way service in Step 8, your options are BELLSOUTH2, SKYTEL_2W, or RPA_2W.
- Select a protocol by entering a **1** next to it and pressing Enter.

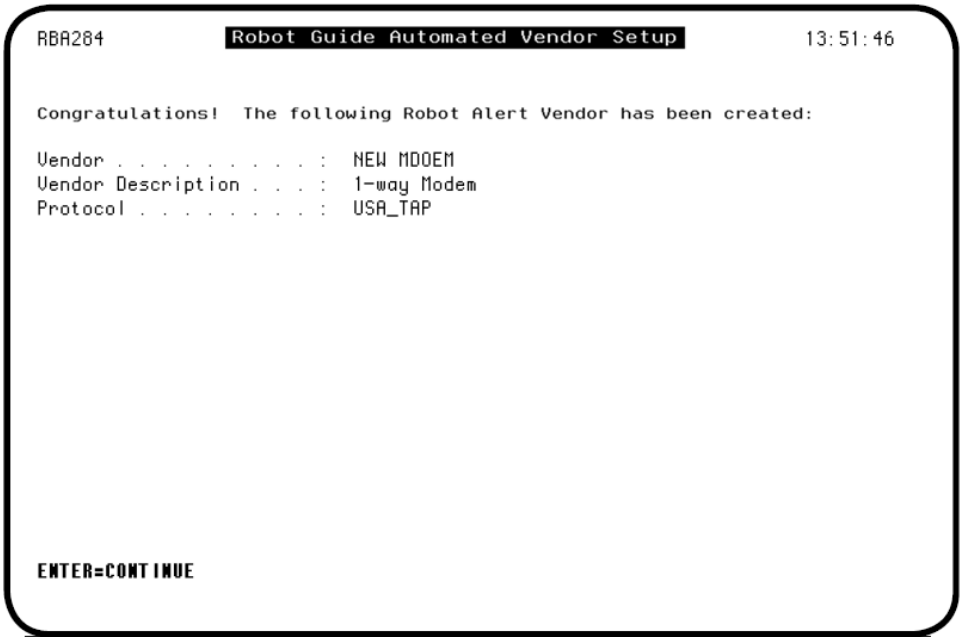


2. The Robot Guide Automated Vendor Setup panel redisplays. Enter the phone number to be used to contact the vendor. Use a comma (,) to indicate a pause. Each comma pauses for approximately 1 second. Press Enter to continue.



3. The Robot Guide Automated Vendor Setup panel displays with your new vendor. Press Enter to return to the Maintain Vendors panel.

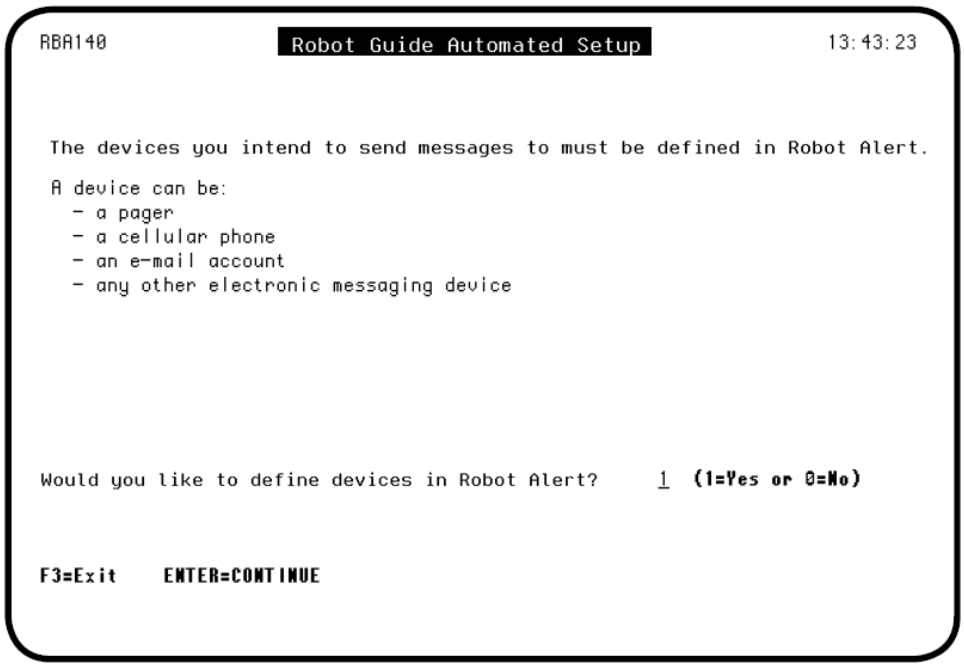
   From the Maintain Vendors panel you can create another vendor by pressing **F6**. Or, press **F3** to create a device and go to Step 19.



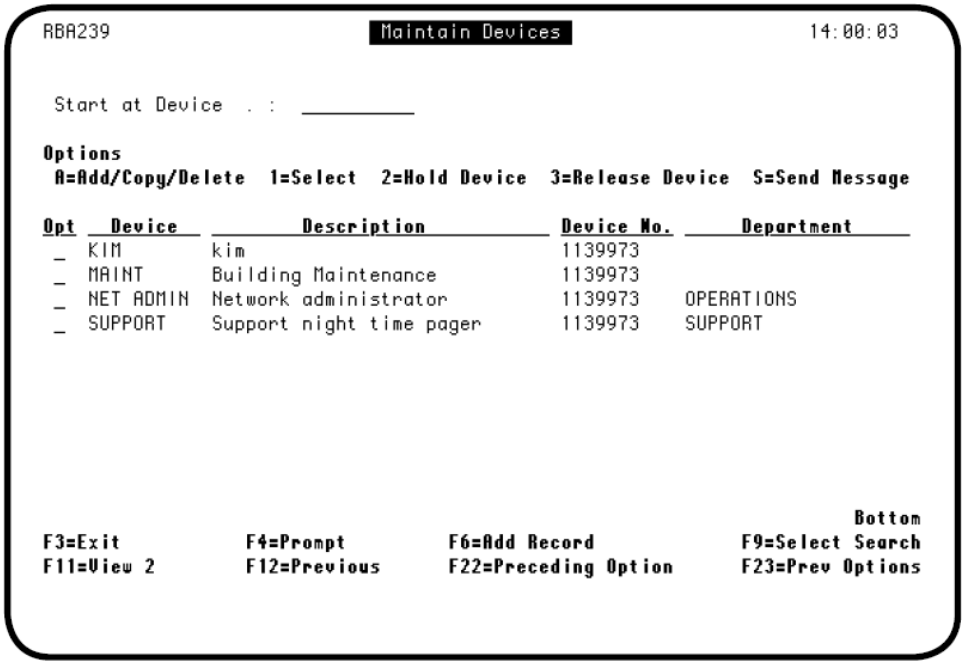
Quick Tour 4: Using Robot Guide to Set Up Devices

1. The Robot Guide Automated Setup panel displays with options for you to define devices.

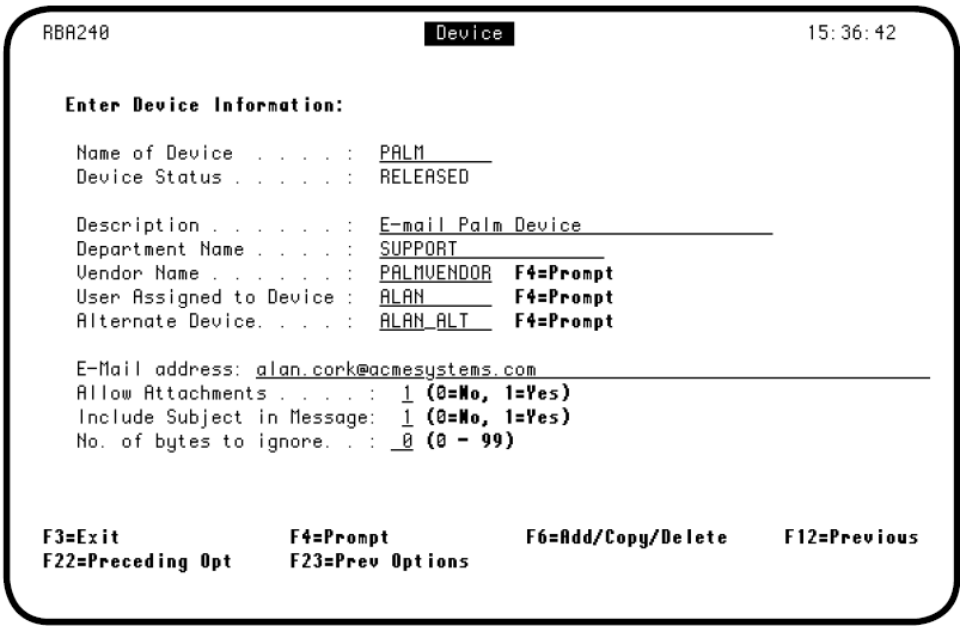
- If you specified Yes (**1**), the panels shown below appear.
- If you specified No (**0**), go to Step 22.



2. The Maintain Devices panel appears. From this panel, press **F6** to define a device.

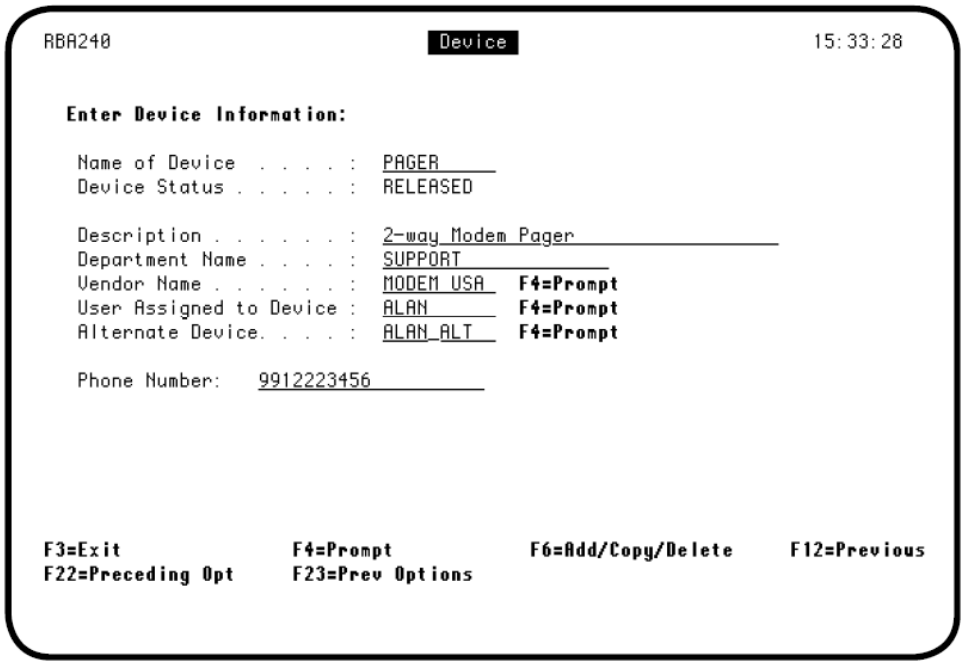


3. The Device panel displays with options for you to describe the device.
    - If you specified an email device, you must supply a device name, user assigned to the device, and the device's email address. The other fields, description, department name, and alternate device, are optional.



- If you specified a modem device, you must supply a device name, user assigned to the device, and the device's phone number. The other fields, description, department name, and alternate device, are optional.

When you're finished, press Enter. After the device is created (a message appears), you can press **F3** to return to the Device Maintenance panel. There you can define another device by pressing **F6**. Or, you can press **F3** again and go to Step 22.



4. The Robot Guide Automated Setup panel displays describing some the Robot Alert commands.

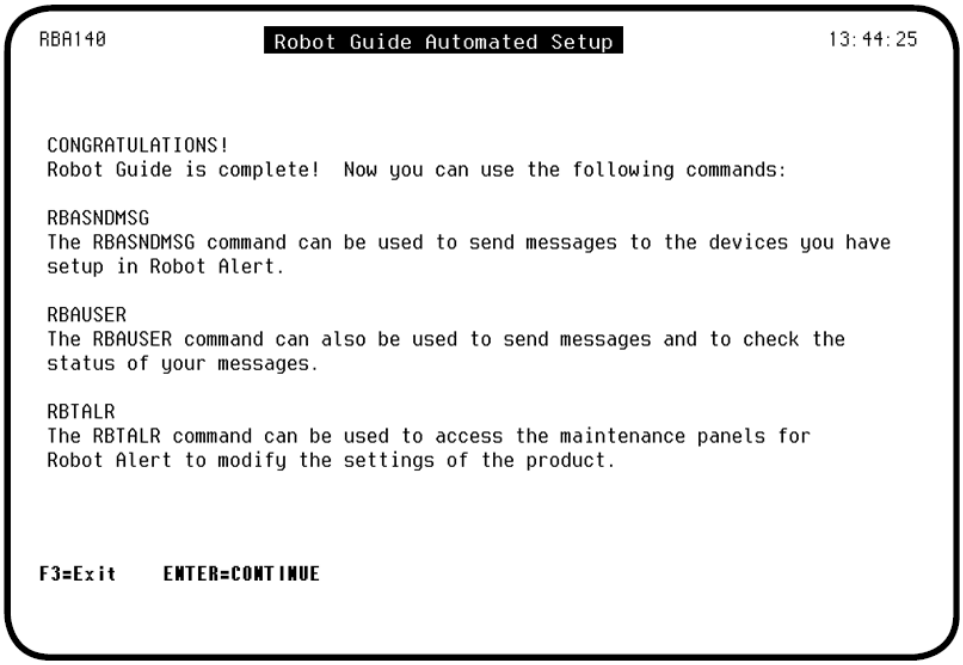
   Press Enter to return to the IBM i main menu.

5. Setup is complete.

   Sign on as security officer and execute the menu command:

   RBTALRLIB/RBTALR

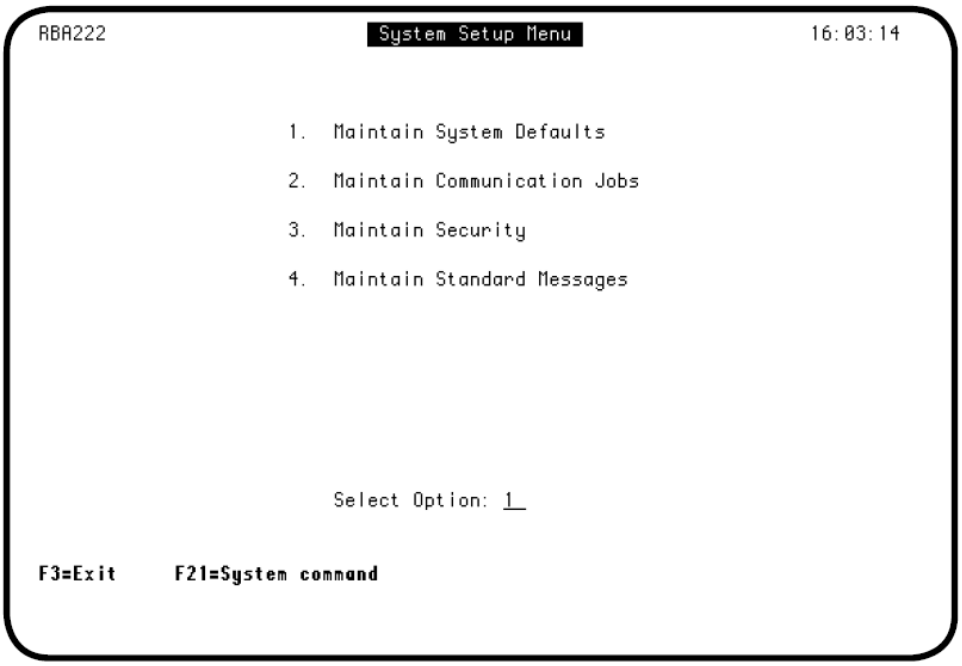
   The Robot Alert Administration Menu will appear. Use the options on this menu to check your Robot Alert system defaults



Quick Tour 5: Setting Robot Alert Default Values

1. On the Robot Alert Administration Menu, select option **6**, System Setup Menu, to enter the required information for Robot Alert setup.
2. On the System Setup Menu, select option **1**, Maintain System Defaults. The System Defaults panel displays.

   You may want to refer to the System Setup section of this User Guide as you go through this Quick Tour.

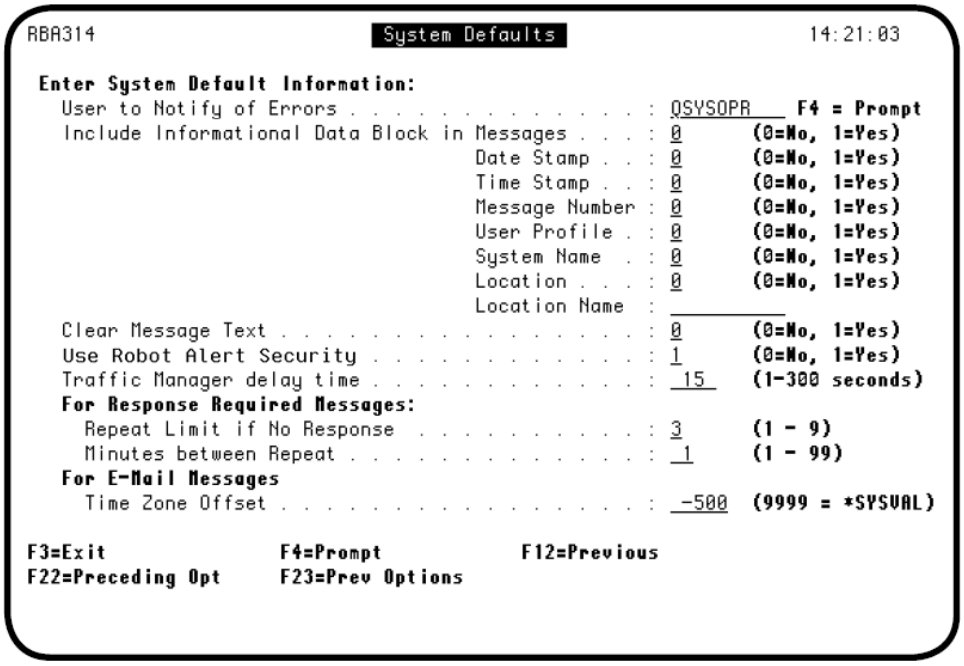


3. On the System Defaults panel, you can change the default information for Robot Alert.

   Robot Alert works with the default values as shipped. However, if you're planning to send emails to an area in a different time zone, you should check the Time Zone Offset. For more information, see the topic, Setting Up System Defaults, in the System Setup section of this User Guide.

4. When you're finished, press Enter and then **F3** to return to the System Setup Menu.

   If you're planning to use a modem with Robot Alert, be sure it is set up for asynchronous operation.



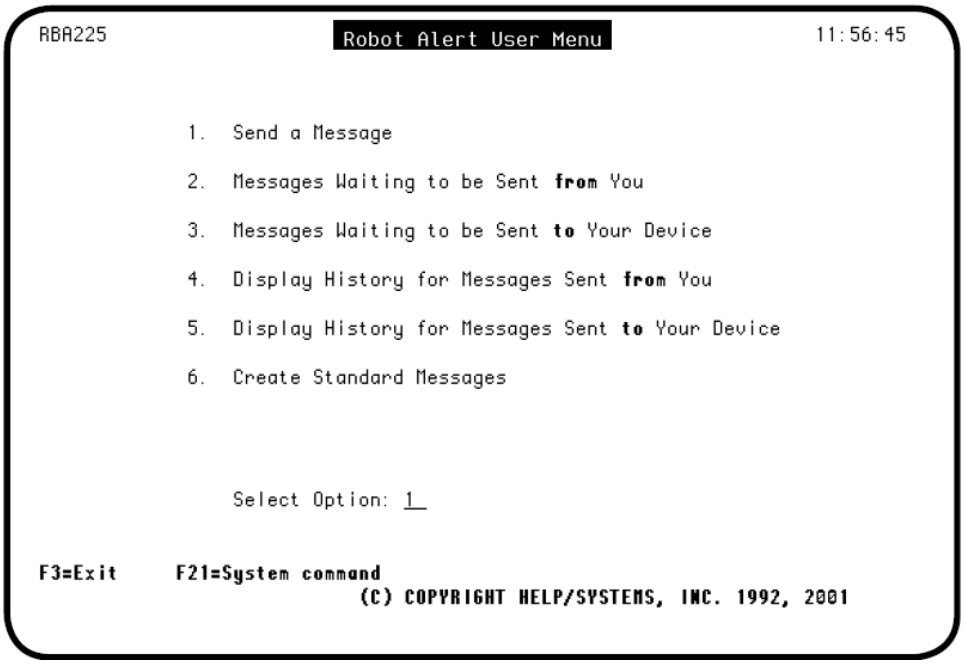
Quick Tour 6: Sending Messages

1. When you're ready to send a message, exit the Robot Alert Administration Menu and enter the following command to display the Robot Alert User Menu:

   RBTALRLIB/RBAUSER

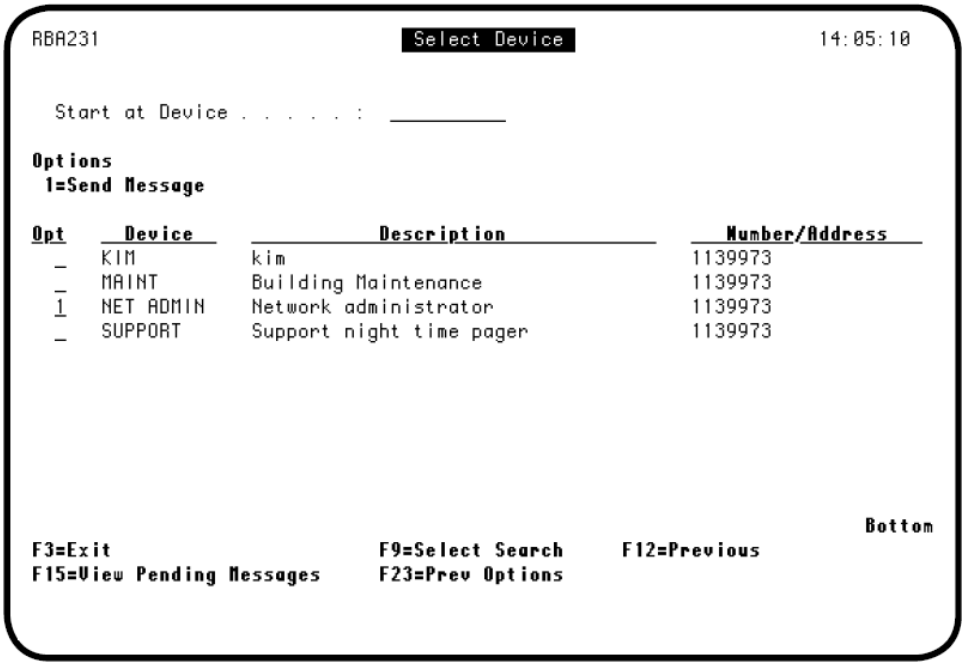
   This quick tour describes how to send an alphanumeric device message.
2. On the Robot Alert User Menu, select option **1**, Send a Message

   The Select Device panel displays.



3. On the Select Device panel, enter **1** in the opt column next to the device you want to send the message to.

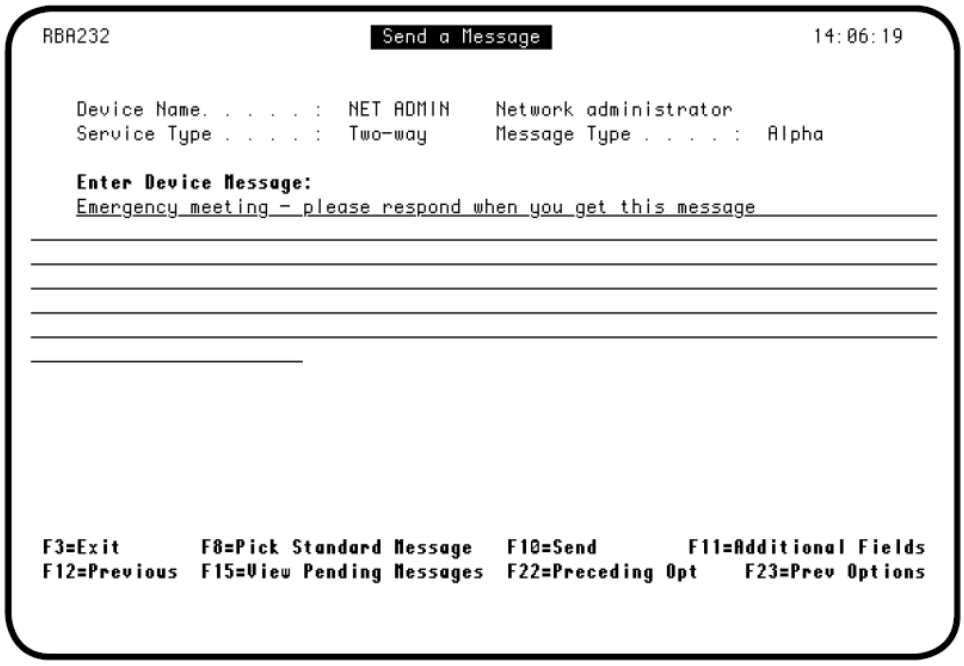
   The Send a Message panel displays.



4. On the Send a Message panel, enter the text of the message you want to send.

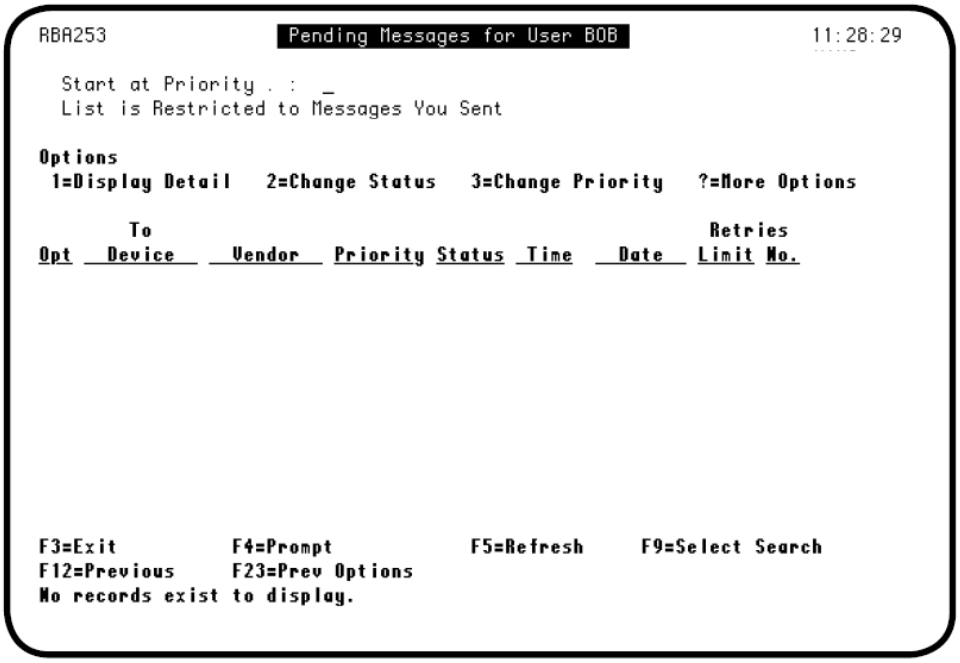
   If you're sending to a numeric device, enter the numeric string. If you're sending to a tone-only device, press **F10**.

   Once you have entered the message, press **F10**.

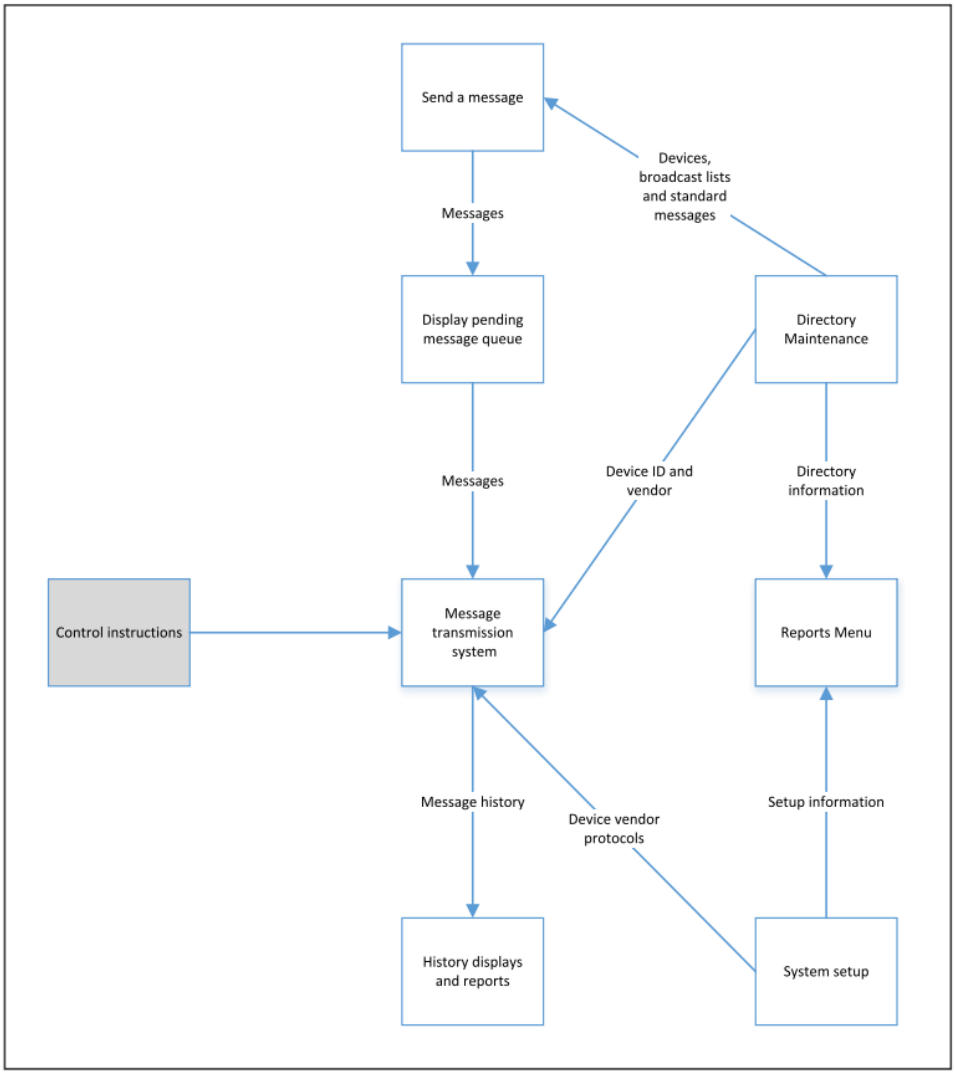


5. After a message is created and sent, it waits in the pending message queue until the message transmission program sends it.

   To see the pending message queue for the messages you have sent, press **F15** from the Select Device panel. The Pending Messages for User (Profile) panel displays. You can use this panel to see the messages on the queue, change a message's status or priority, or delete a message.

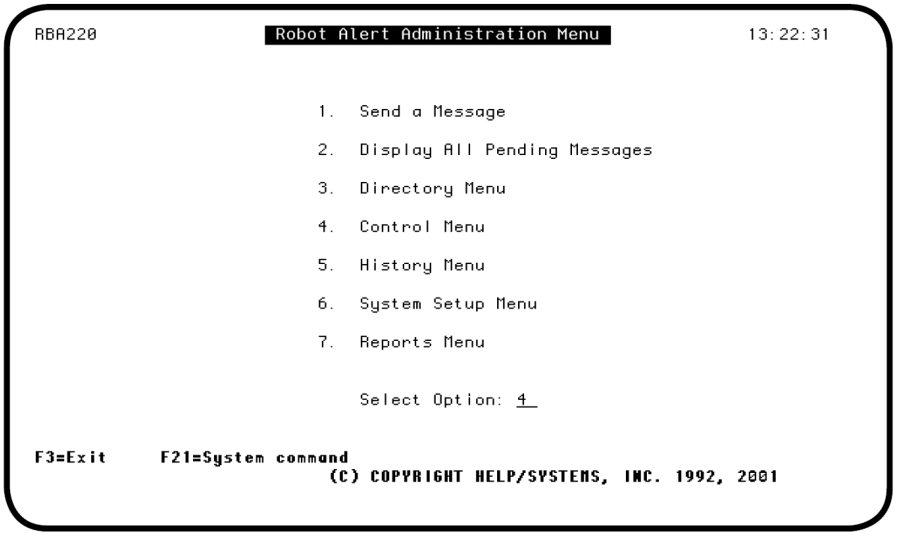


Control

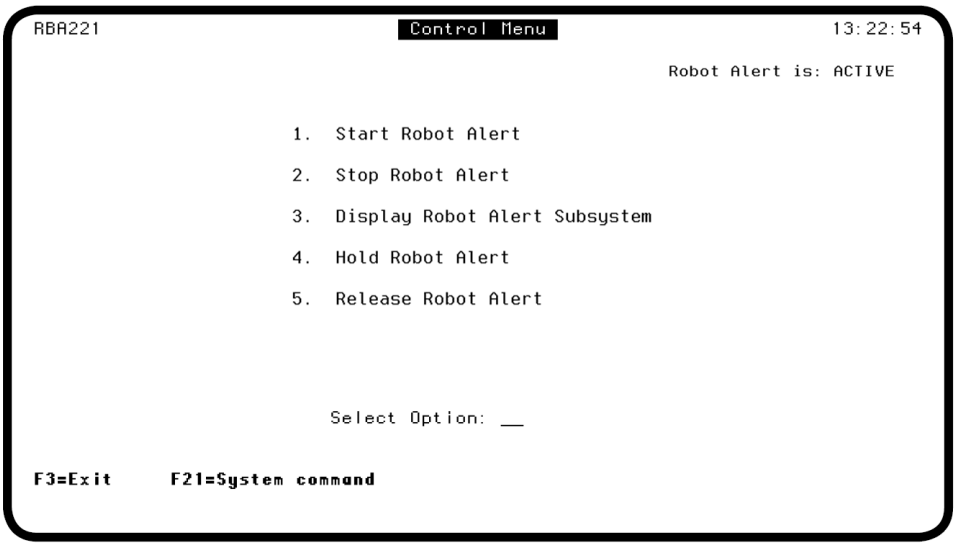


The Robot Alert Control Menu

Robot Alert's Control Menu provides options that let you start, stop, hold, release, or display the Robot Alert subsystem. To access the Control Menu, select option 4 from the Robot Alert Administration Menu.



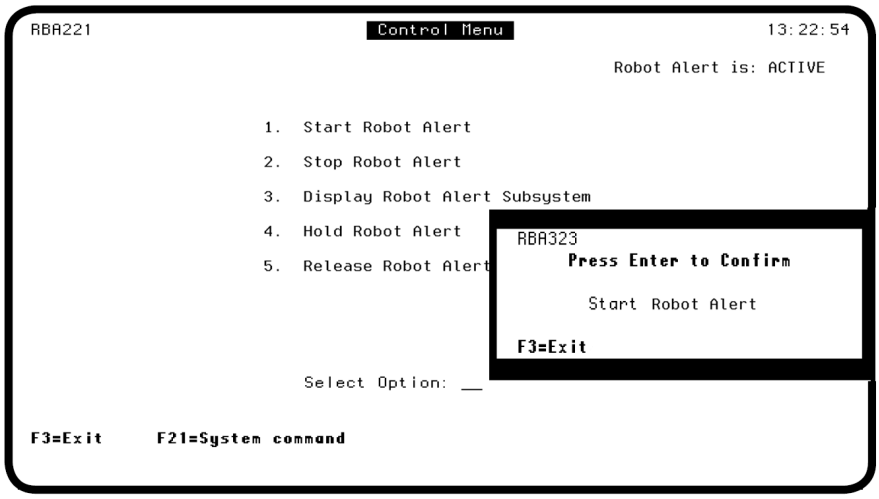
To access the Control Menu, enter option **4** on the Robot Alert Administration Menu.



Starting and Stopping Robot Alert

To have Robot Alert start transmitting messages, select option **1** from the Control Menu, or enter the command RBASTR. To start Robot Alert and the other Fortra products that run in the RBTSLEEPER subsystem automatically when you IPL your IBM i machine, insert the following command in your IPL procedures: **STRSBS SBSD(RBTSYSLIB/RBTSLEEPER)**

To stop Robot Alert, select option **2** from the Control Menu, or enter the command **RBAEND**. To have Robot Alert shut down automatically when you power down your IBM i machine, insert the RBAEND command in your powerdown procedures.



When you select option **1** or **2**, you're prompted with a confirmation panel to verify that you want to proceed.

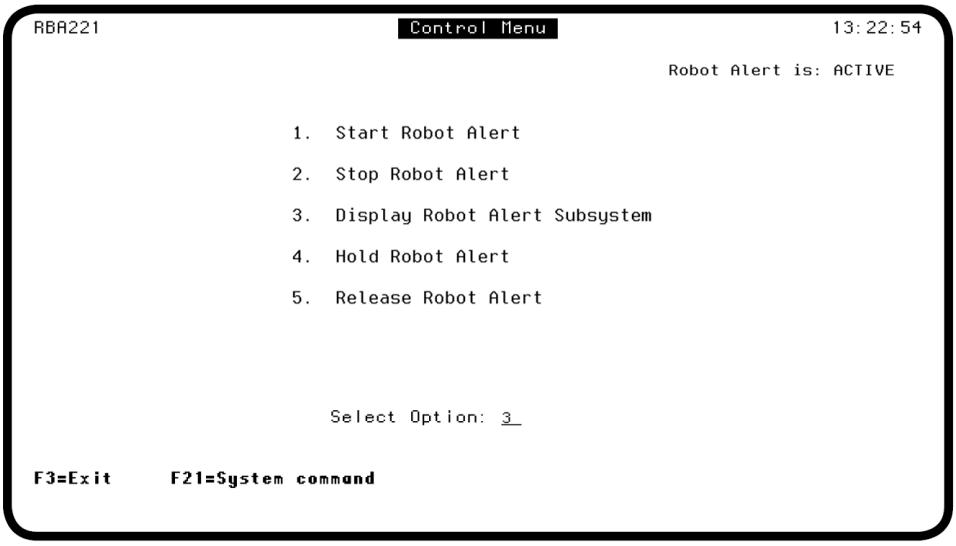
Robot Alert is:

Shows the status of Robot Alert and the RBTSLEEPER subsystem:

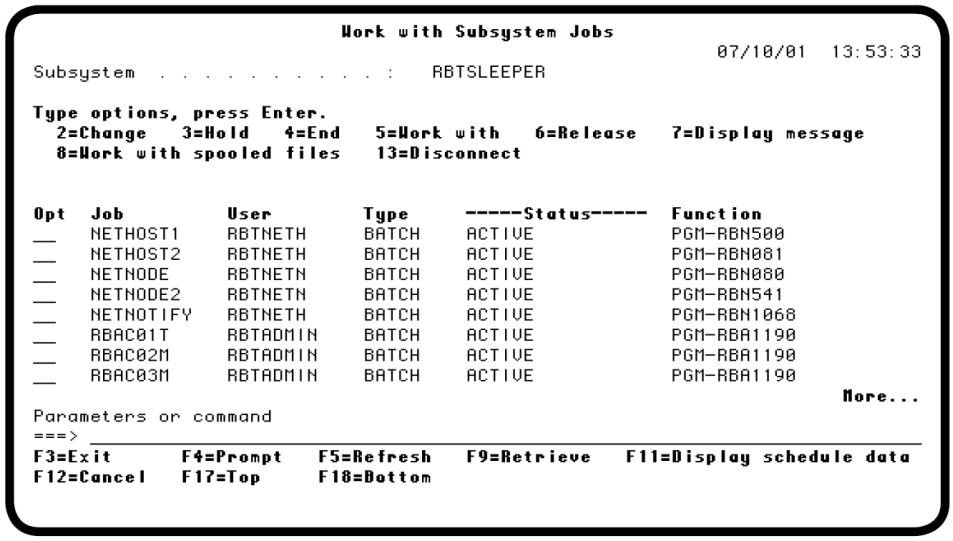
Status	Description
ACTIVE	The transmission jobs (Traffic Manager and communication jobs) are active and messages can be received and sent.
INACTIVE	The transmission jobs are currently inactive. If a message is received, the status will switch to ACTIVE automatically and the message will be processed.
HELD	The transmission jobs are inactive, and messages received are queued (held)—none are sent.

Displaying the RBTSLEEPER Subsystem Jobs for Robot Alert

To display the jobs that are currently active for Robot Alert in the RBTSLEEPER subsystem, select option **3** from the Control Menu.



Option 3 displays the jobs in the RBTSLEEPER subsystem. When Robot Alert is active, the transmission jobs are active in the subsystem. From the panel that appears you can hold or release these jobs, end them, and perform other job maintenance.



Communication jobs' names start with the prefix, RBA.

Holding and Releasing Robot Alert

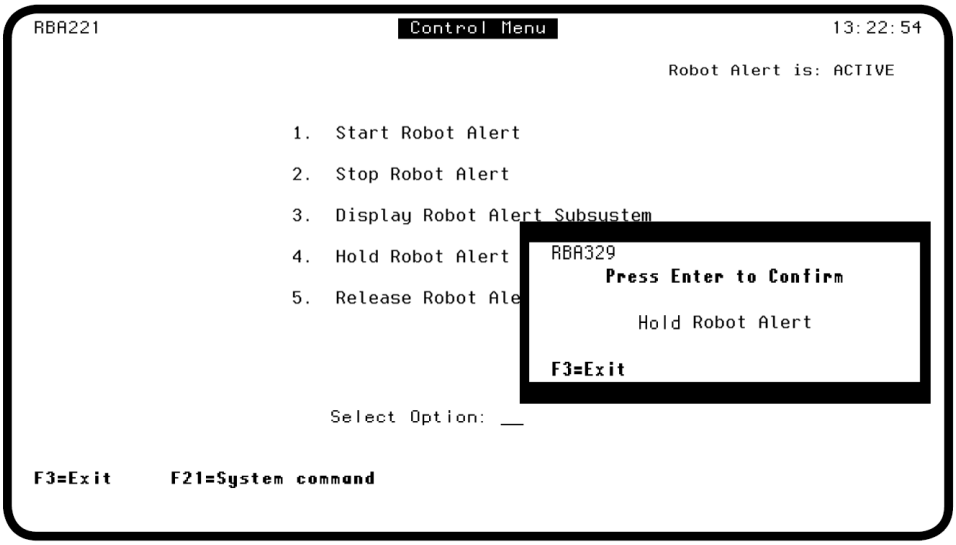
You can use the Control Menu to hold and release Robot Alert. When Robot Alert is on hold, all batch processing (communication jobs and traffic manager jobs) stops. Robot Alert continues to receive messages and queues them based on priority, but no messages are

sent until Robot Alert is released. When you release Robot Alert, normal message processing resumes.

This process is not the same as holding and releasing a specific communication job. See the topic, Maintaining Communication Jobs.

To hold Robot Alert, select option **4** from the Control Menu; to release Robot Alert, select option **5** from the Control Menu. You can also hold and release Robot Alert by entering the command **RBAHLDALR** and selecting the appropriate option.

We recommend that you put Robot Alert on hold anytime you're upgrading a Fortra product. Holding Robot Alert prevents the RBTSLEEPER subsystem from starting at an inappropriate time and helps the update process proceed smoothly.



Hold Robot Alert (Opt 4)

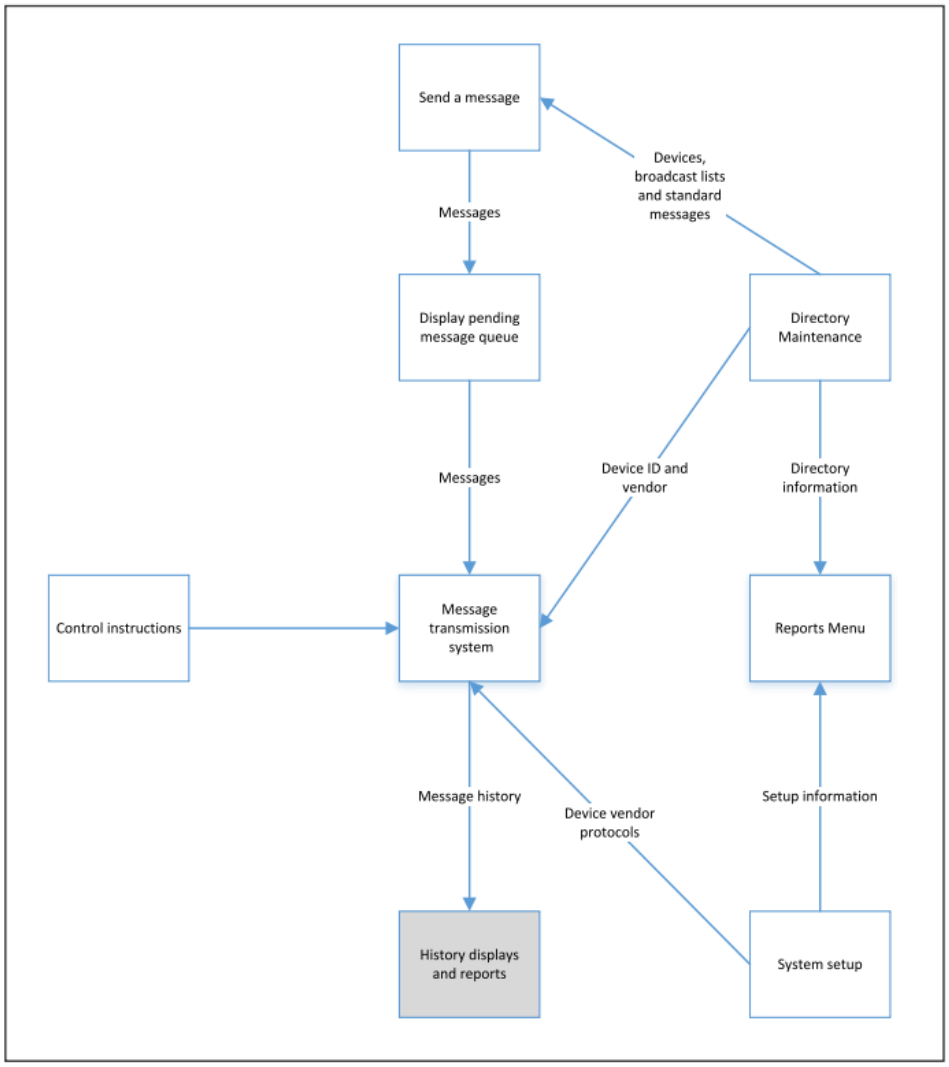
Holds all Robot Alert batch processing

Release Robot Alert (Opt 5)

Releases Robot Alert to resume batch processing.

When you select option **4** or **5**, you're prompted with a confirmation panel to verify that you want to proceed.

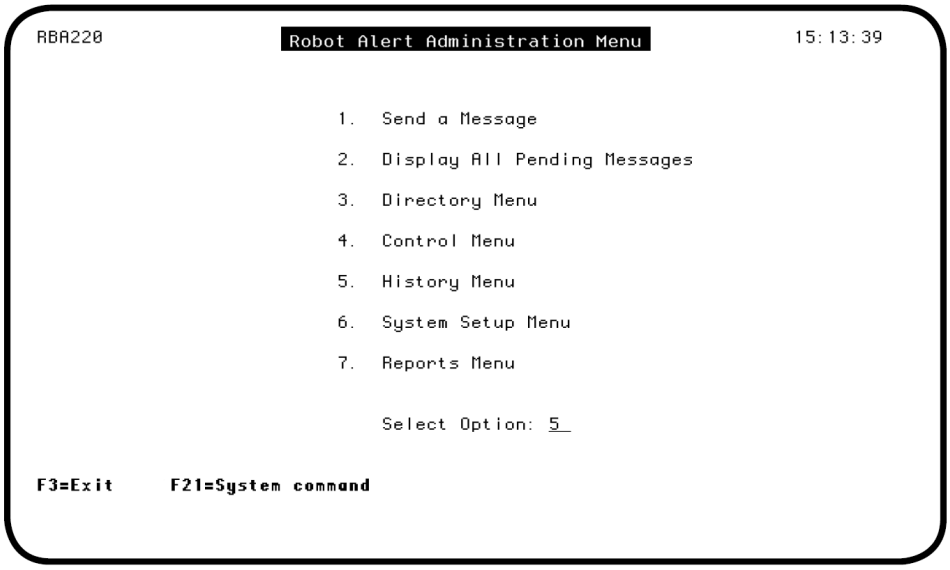
History

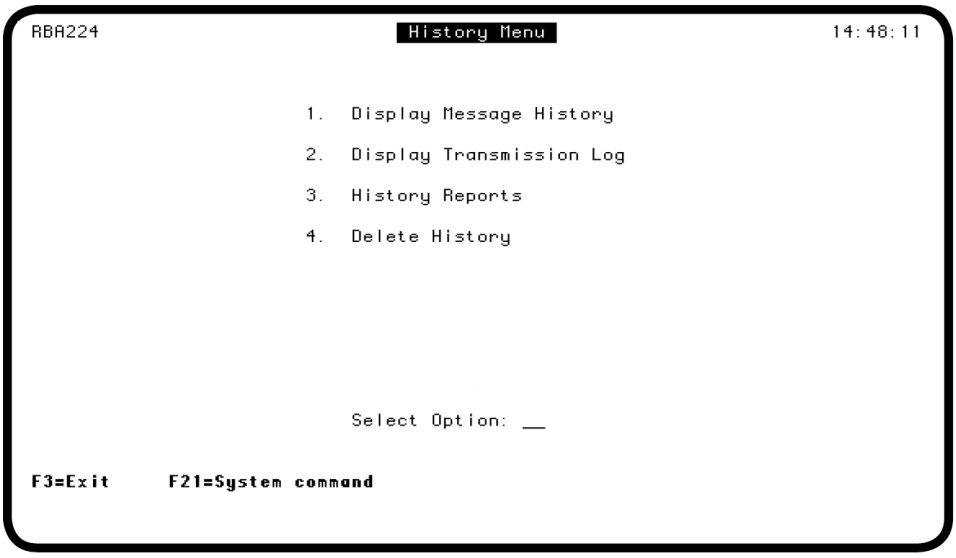


Robot Alert History Menu

The History Menu offers four options you can use to view or delete Robot Alert history: you can display message history, the transmission log, a history reports menu, or delete the Robot Alert history.

To access the History Menu, select option **5** from the Robot Alert Administration Menu.





Field Descriptions

Display Message History

Displays the history of all messages that have been sent.

Display Transmission Log

Displays the Robot Alert Transmission Log, which shows a history of message transmission activity.

History Reports

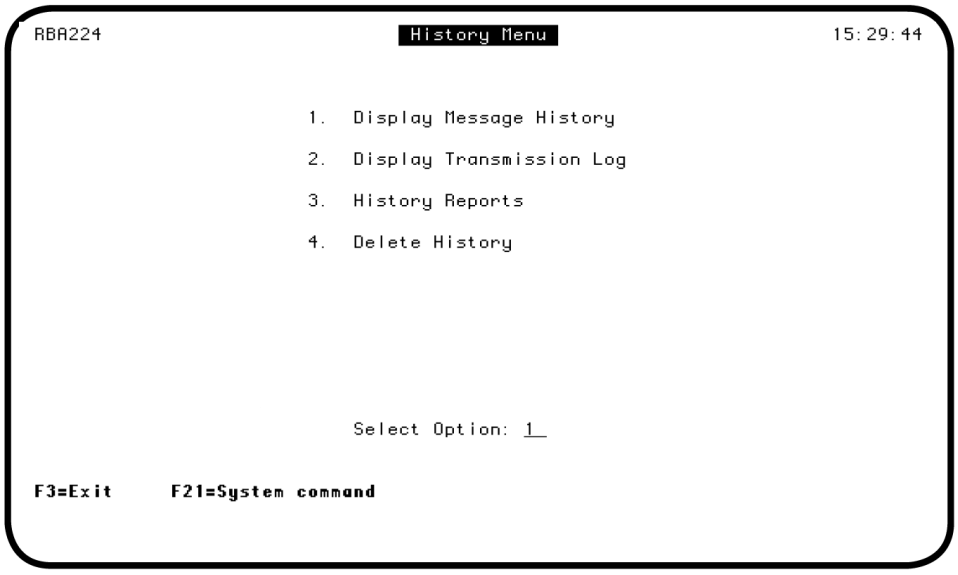
Displays the History Reports panel, which allows you to submit the Transmission Log report and the Message History report.

Delete History

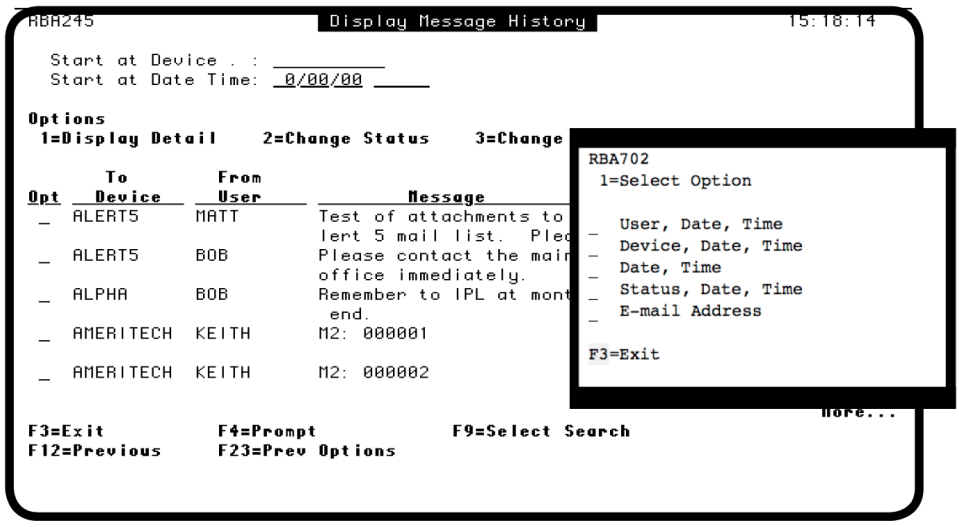
Displays the Delete History panel, which allows you to delete history from the Transmission Log and delete the message history.

Displaying Message History

Robot Alert keeps a history of all messages sent or received. From the Robot Alert History Menu, you can display the history of all messages by selecting option **1**, Display Message History. For more information, refer to the Viewing Message History topic in the Using Robot Alert section of this user guide.



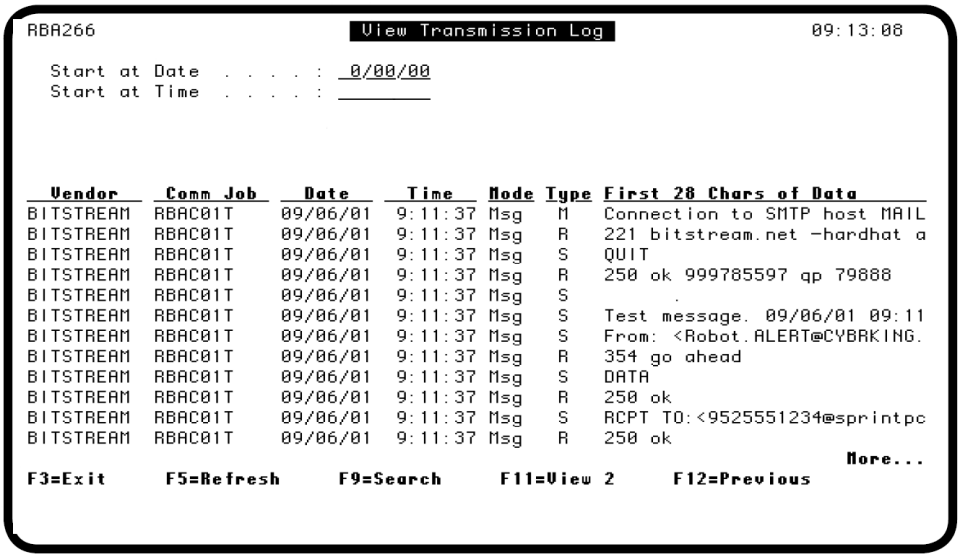
Enter option **1** to display the Display Message History panel.



Press **F9** to display the history information in different ways. A window displays allowing you to search using five options. Once you have selected a search option, the history re-displays, showing only the messages that met your search criteria.

Viewing the Transmission Log—View 1

The View Transmission Log panel displays each line of the dialogue between Robot Alert and the vendor computer. Use this display only when you're troubleshooting communications problems or vendor dialogue problems. To see the transmission log for the entire system, use option **2** on the History menu. To view the log for an individual message, enter **5** next to the message on the Display Message History panel.



Field Descriptions

Vendor

Shows the name of the vendor used to send the message.

Comm Job

Shows the name of communication job that handled the communication.

Date and Time

Shows the date and time of the transmission.

Mode

Shows whether Robot Alert sent a message (Msg) or made a request for a response (Rsp) from a two-way pager.

Type

Shows the type of dialogue text each line represents:

M Message

R Receive

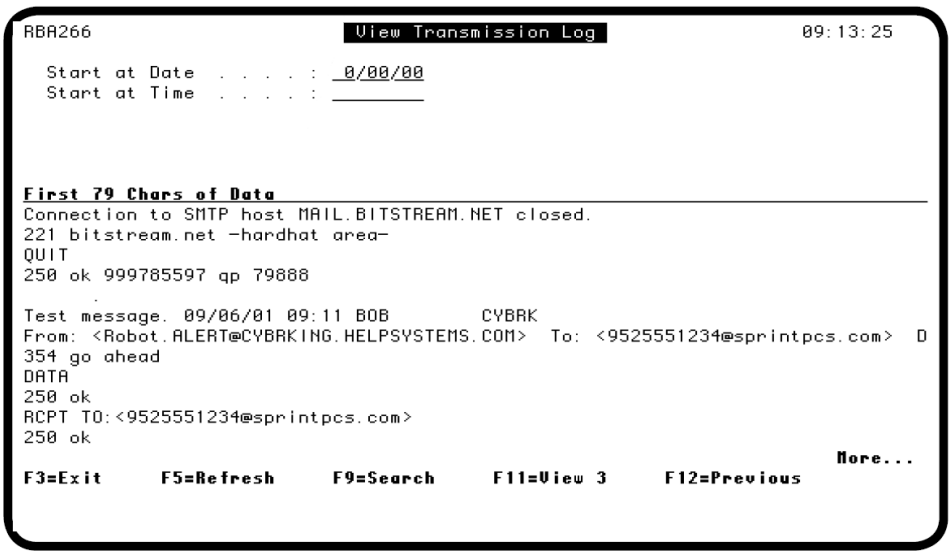
S Send

First 28 Chars of Data

Shows the first 28 characters of the data sent or received.

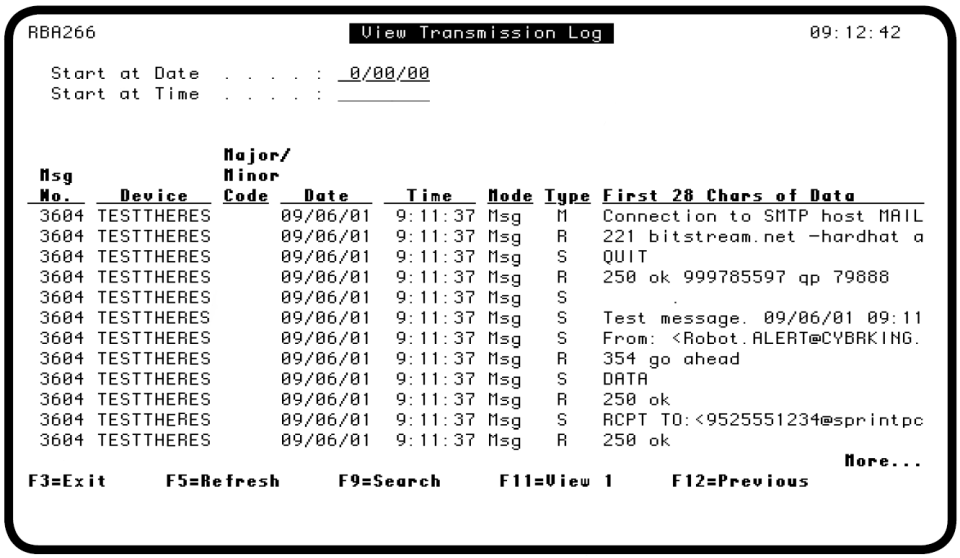
Viewing the Transmission Log—View 2

View 2 of the View Transmission Log panel displays the first 79 characters of data rather than the first 28 characters that views 1 and 3 display.



Viewing the Transmission Log—View 3

View 3 of the View Transmission Log panel displays the message number, device, and IBM-generated return code (does not apply to TCP/IP communication) for each communication.



Field Descriptions

Msg No.

Shows the message number associated with the message.

Device

Shows the name of the device to which the message was sent.

Major/Minor Code

Shows the IBM-generated return code from the send or receive operation. This code does not appear for TCP/IP communication. Refer to your IBM user documentation for code definitions.

Date and Time

Shows the date and time of the transmission.

Mode

Shows whether Robot Alert sent a message (Msg) or made a request for a response (Rsp) from a two-way pager.

Type

Shows the type of dialogue text each line represents:

M Message

R Receive

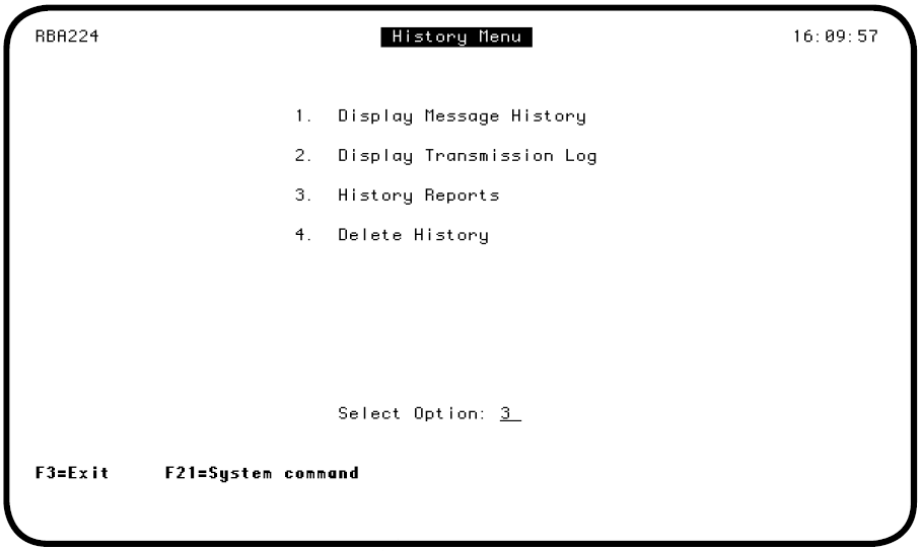
S Send

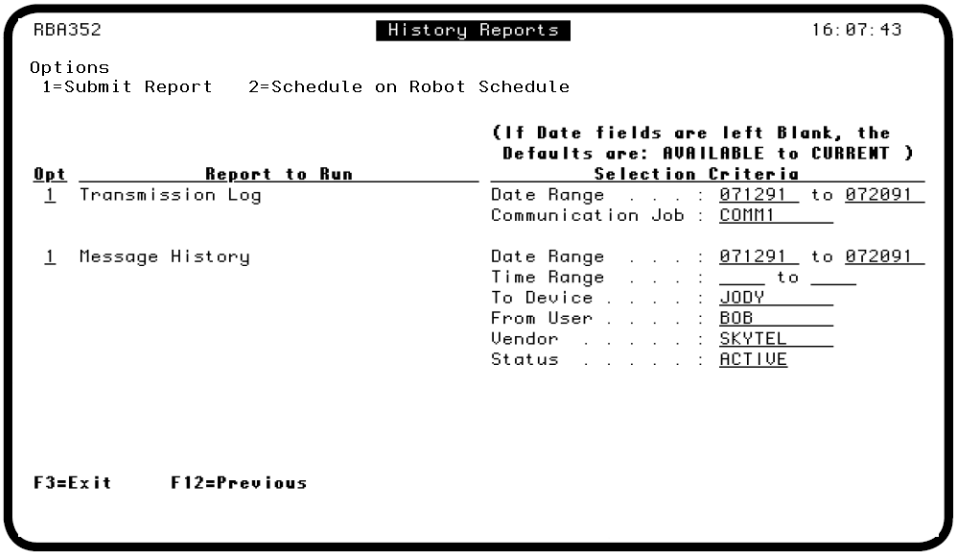
First 28 Char of Data

Shows the first 28 characters of the data sent or received.

Printing a History Report

Robot Alert provides two reports on the History Reports panel that can be submitted immediately for printing by entering option **1**. Or, if you have Robot Schedule, you can schedule a Robot Schedule job to print the reports at a specific time by entering option **2**. To access the History Reports panel, enter option **3** on the History Menu.





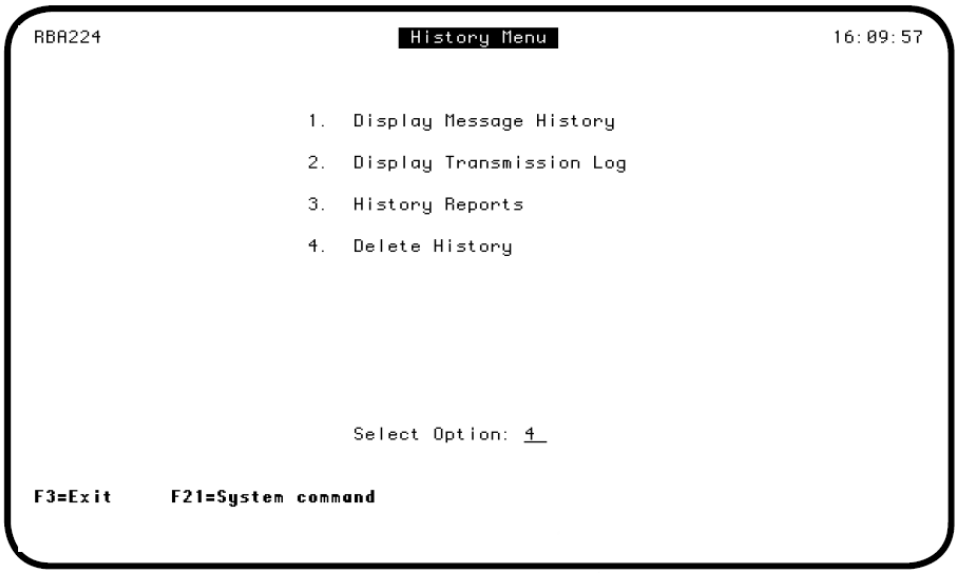
Use option **1** to submit the report immediately. If you have Robot Schedule installed, you can use option **2** to schedule a Robot Schedule job to print the report.

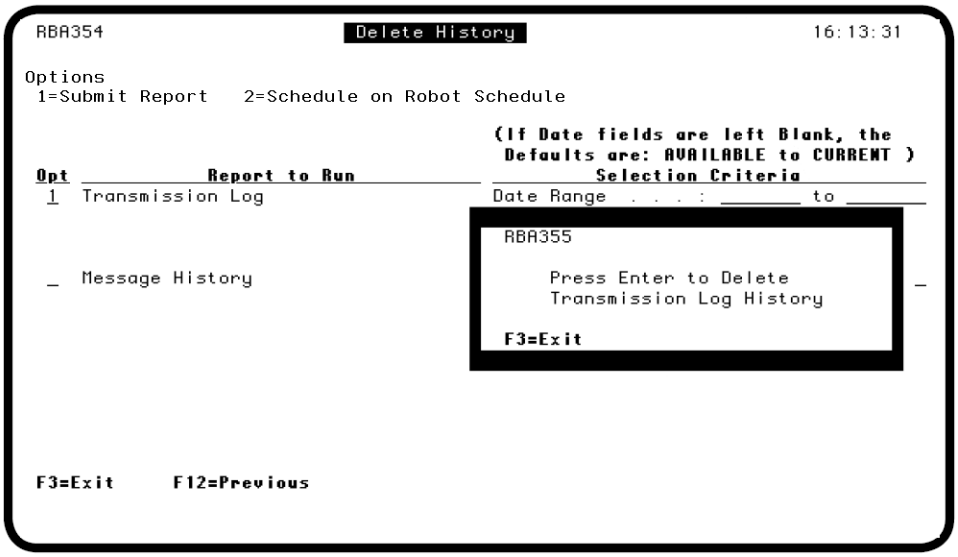
Select the Transmission Log to print information on Robot Alert's message transmission activity. Select Message History to print a report of all the history maintained on messages.

You can tailor the information to be included on the report by entering selection criteria such as date and time ranges, vendors, devices, who sent and received messages, and statuses.

Deleting Robot Alert History

To delete Robot Alert history, select option **4** on the History Menu. You can delete message history and/or history kept in the Transmission Log. You can delete the history immediately (option **1**), or schedule the deletion using Robot Schedule (option **2**).



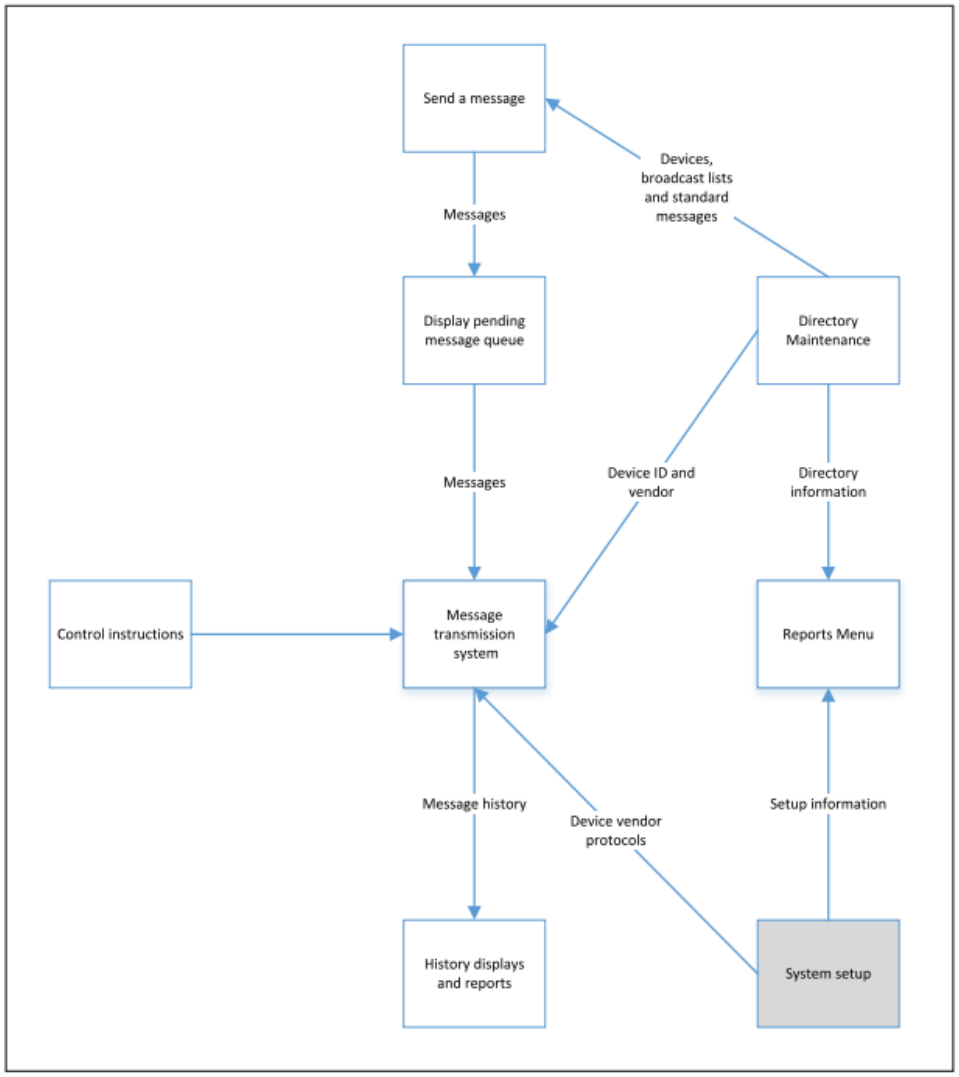


You can delete message history and/or history kept in the Transmission Log. Under opt, enter **1** to delete the history now. If you have Robot Schedule installed, you can enter **2** to schedule a Robot Schedule job to delete the history.

Enter a date and time range for which you want the history deleted. If you do not specify a range, Robot Alert deletes all available history.

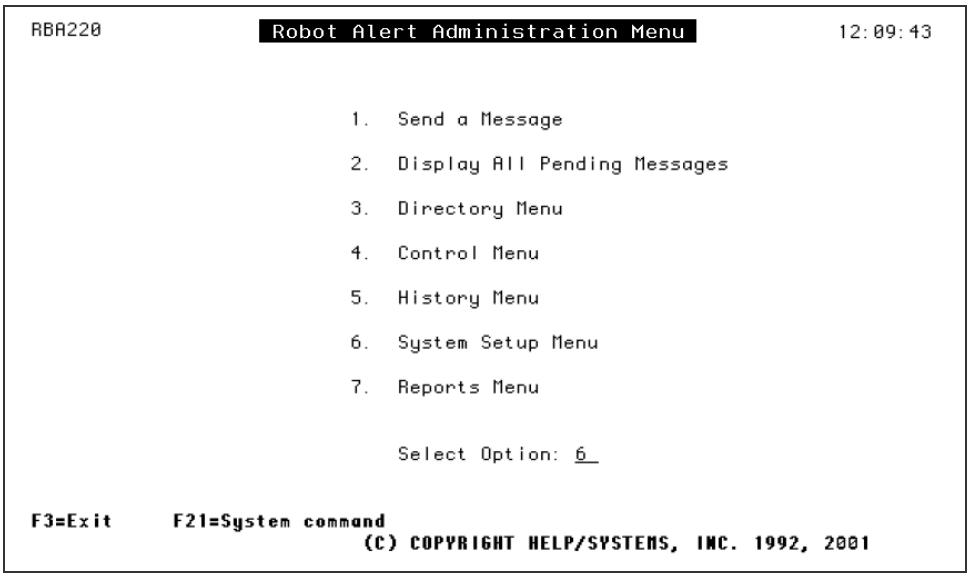
Press Enter to confirm the deletion, or **F3** to cancel it.

System Setup

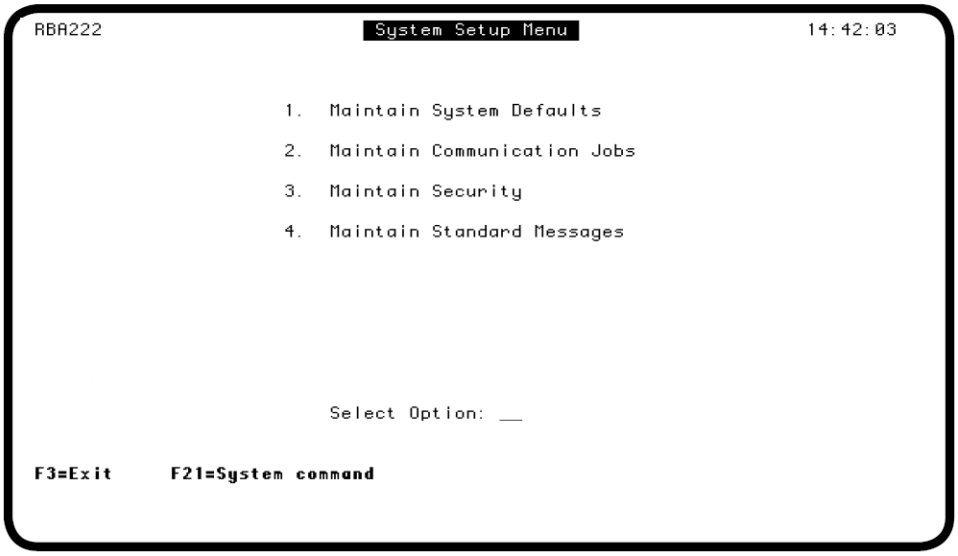


Robot Alert System Setup Menu

To install Robot Alert, read and follow the instructions included with the software. To set up Robot Alert on your system, select option **6** from the Robot Alert Administration Menu. The System Setup Menu lists options for defining system defaults, communication jobs, security, and standard message sets.



Select option **6** from the Robot Alert Administration Main Menu to access the System Setup Menu.



Select option **1** to set up Robot Alert system defaults.

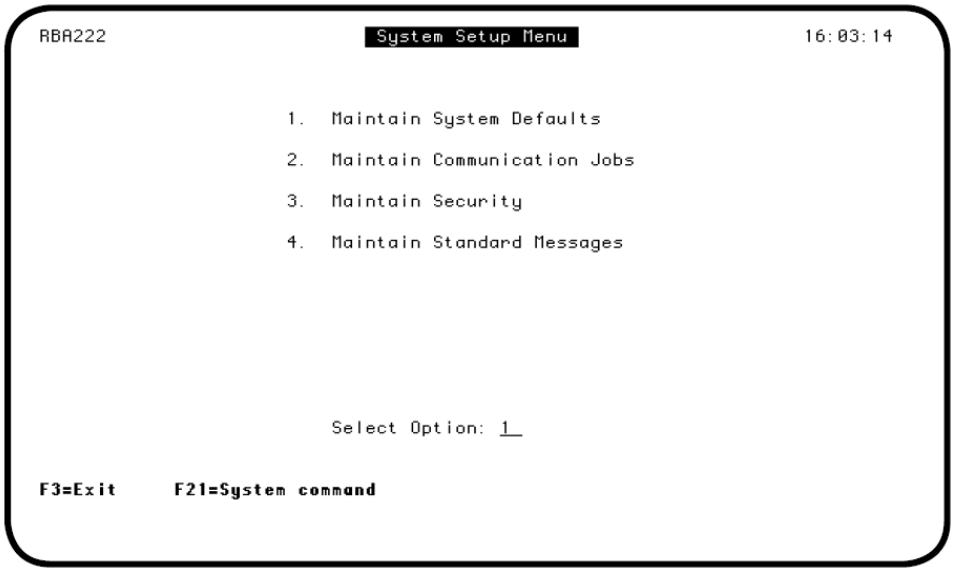
Select option **2** to access the communication jobs that are set up in Robot Alert.

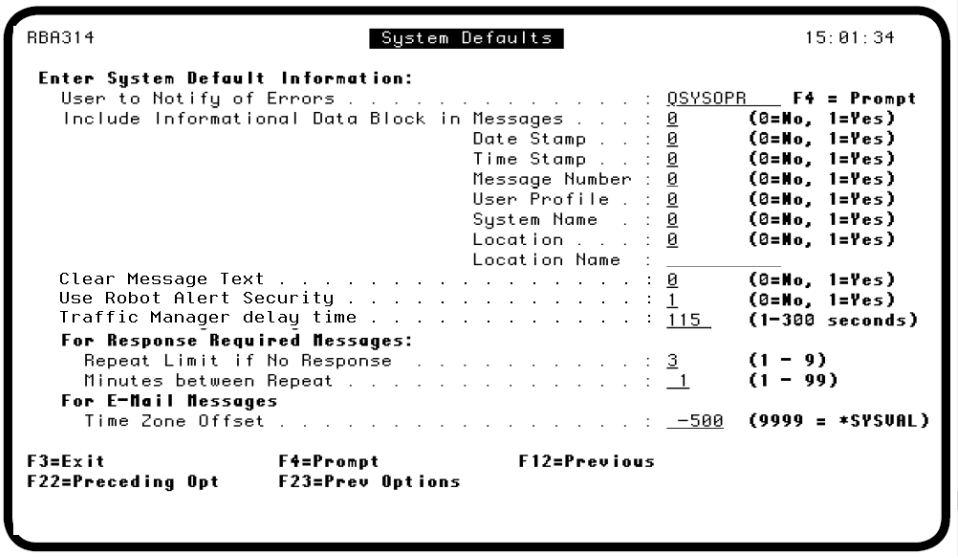
Select option **3** to set up Robot Alert security (optional).

Select option **4** to access the Robot Alert standard messages. These are messages that you use frequently.

Setting Up System Defaults

The System Defaults panel lets you specify the user to notify in case of errors, specify whether to include an informational block at the end of messages, clear message text after the message is sent, and use Robot Alert security. You can also set default repeat limits and times, and an offset value for sending messages to email address in different time zones. To access the System Defaults panel, select option **1** from the System Setup Menu.





Field Descriptions

User to Notify of Errors

The Robot Alert monitor job notifies this user, who should be the administrator who can fix the problem, when a transmission error occurs. Robot Alert sends a message to this user's message queue whenever the administrator should take corrective action. For a list of valid user profile names, press **F4**.

Include Informational Data Block in Messages

To include an informational data block at the end of your alphanumeric messages, enter 1 here and next to each of the items that you want included in the data block, and enter a location name (optional):

- Date and time sent
- Message number
- User who sent the message
- Name and location of the system where the message originated

Clear Message Text

Enter a **1** to clear device message text after it is sent; enter a **0** (zero) to keep the text.

Use Robot Alert Security

Enter **1** to use Robot Alert security (see Setting Up Robot Alert Security, later in this section).

Traffic Manager Delay Time

The amount of time, in seconds, that the Traffic Manager should wait before grouping the next set of messages into a communication request. This setting is designed to improve the efficiency of the way in which messages are grouped and handled.

For Response Required Messages

For response-required messages, enter both the default number of times a message will be repeated if there is no response, and the number of minutes Robot Alert should wait between repeats.

Time Zone Offset

The Time Zone Offset field is used for email pages and defaults to your IBM i system value (*SYSVAL) for QUTCOFFSET, which indicates the time offset between your system's time and Greenwich Mean Time (GMT). If the QUTCOFFSET value is incorrect, enter a value in

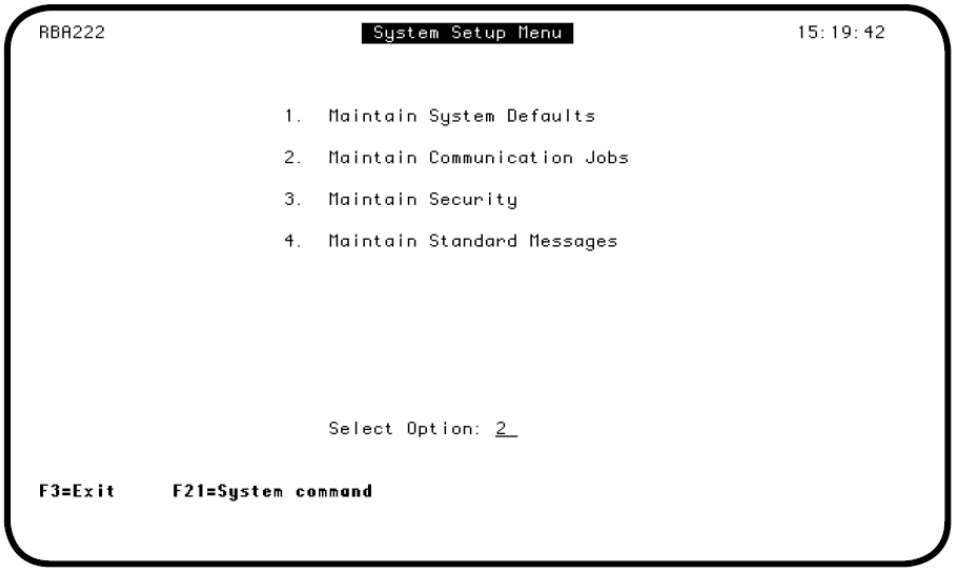
this field in +/- hhmm format to tell Robot Alert the correct amount of time to offset email pages from GMT.

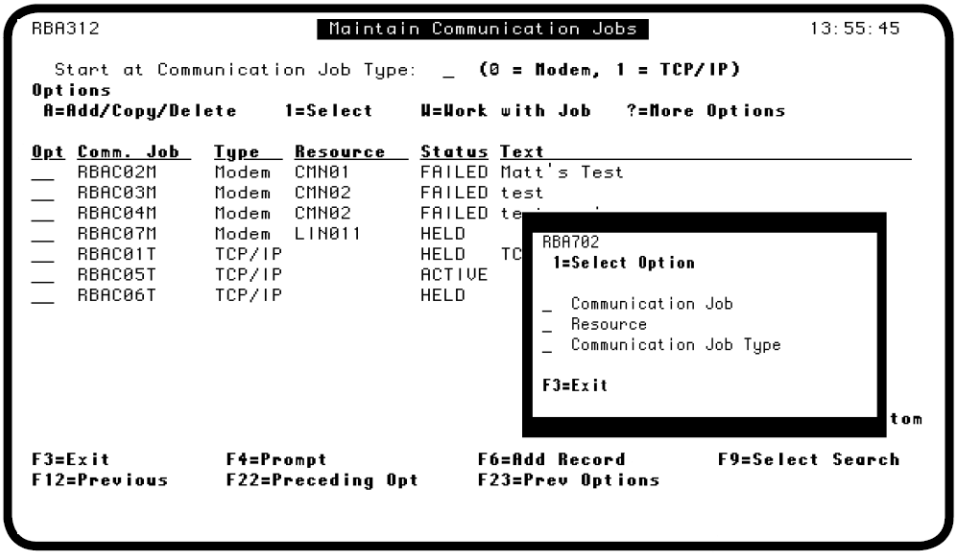
Example

The offset for Central Standard Time (CST) is -0600 (6 hours west of Greenwich Mean Time [GMT]). When Daylight Savings Time starts, you would specify -0500 to change the offset to 5 hours (shown here) When Daylight Savings Time ends, you would specify -0600 to return to the 6-hour offset.

Maintaining Communication Jobs

The Maintain Communication Jobs panel lets you display all of the communication jobs set up in Robot Alert. From this panel, you can add, copy, or delete communication jobs, and view details about existing jobs. To access the panel, enter option **2** on the System Setup Menu.



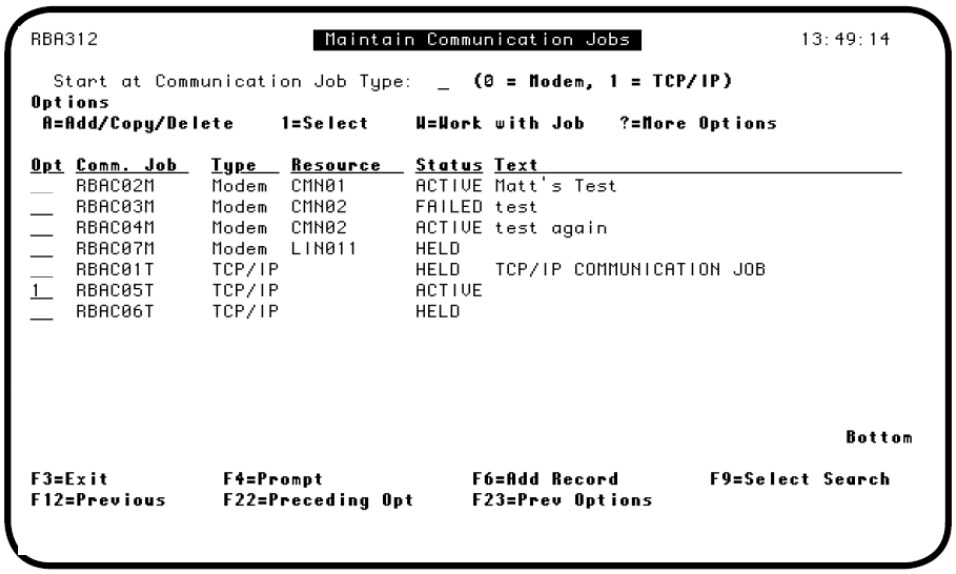


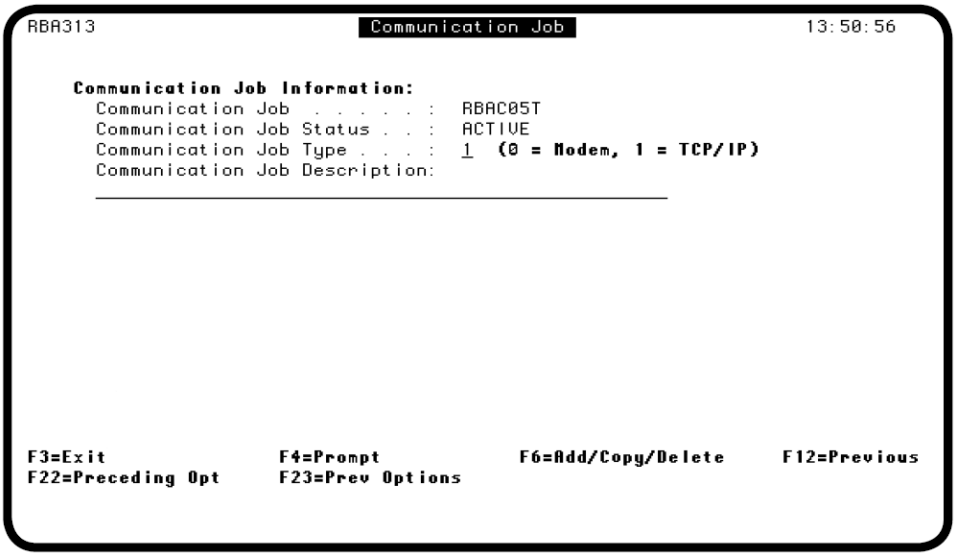
You can specify whether you want to list modem-type jobs (0) first, or TCP/IP-type jobs (1) first. The default is modem-type jobs.

Press **F9** and select an option to display the panel information by communication job, resource, or communication job type.

Displaying and Changing Information for TCP/IP Communication Jobs

On the Communication Job panel, you can enter specific information for a particular communication job to be used by Robot Alert. To access the Communication Job panel, enter **1** on the Maintain Communication Jobs panel next to a particular communication job, or press **F6** or enter **A** in the Opt column to add a communication job. According to the type of communication job you select, different options are displayed.



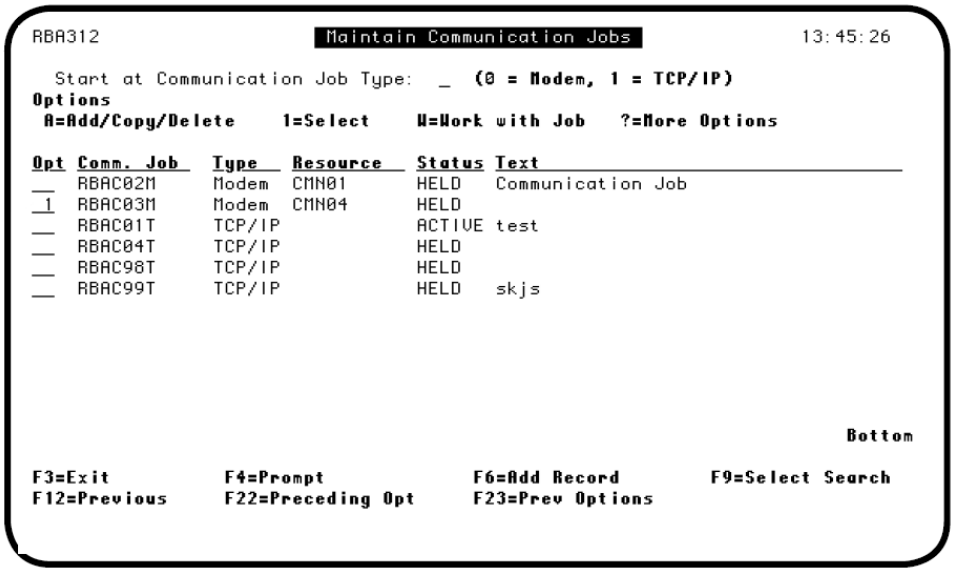


The job type from modem (0) to TCP/IP (1). If you specify modem, additional options for a modem-type job are displayed.

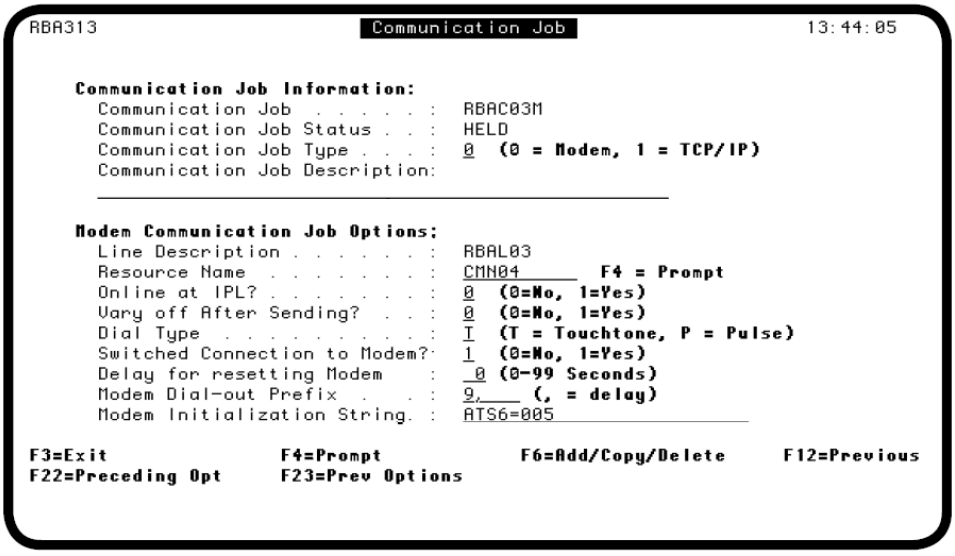
On the communication job description line you can enter a description of the communication job. This description is limited to 50 characters.

Displaying and Changing Information for Modem Communication Jobs

You must have a modem communication job for each modem in your modem pool. If you create a new modem-type job, the IBM i line, controller, and device descriptions will be created by Robot Alert.



If you're maintaining a modem communication job, the Communication Job panel displays with options for a modem job. These are the same options if you change a communication job's type from TCP/IP to modem.



Field Descriptions

Communication Job Information

Robot Alert checks the available Communication Jobs and assigns the next Communication Job in sequence.

The Communication Job Status will be one of the following: ACTIVE, INACTIVE, FAILED, HELD, or RELEASED. The Traffic Manager software checks for failed communication jobs every ten minutes and tries to restart them.

Line Description

The name of the actual IBM i line description object. The line description is associated with the communication job and relates to the communication job name.

Resource Name

This value determines whether your communication line will remain varied on.

- Enter **0** (no) if you have a dedicated line, or are using the line solely for Robot Alert. The line remains varied on.
- Enter **1** (yes) if you want to use the communication line for other purposes. The line will be varied off after messages are sent.

The Resource Name value is validated against the hardware resources on the system. Press **F4** for a list of options.

Dial Type

This value determines the autodial command that Robot Alert sends when it dials out. Enter **T** if your phone service supports touch-tone; enter **P** if you have a rotary-style line.

Switched Connection to Modem?

1 IBM modems

0 Hayes and non-IBM modems

Delay for resetting Modem

The delay, in seconds, Robot Alert should wait before resetting the modem after a failed communication attempt.

Modem Initialization String

The Modem Initialization String defines a modem command that Robot Alert will send to initialize the modem before it dials the vendor's modem number.

This string should always contain AT as the first two characters.

The Modem Dial-out Prefix is prefixed to the vendor phone numbers when the communication job attempts to connect to a vendor with a modem. Use this option to enter a prefix to the main number.

Your phone system may require a prefix to the data phone number to dial out. Use a comma (,) as a signal for the computer to pause to wait for a dial tone.

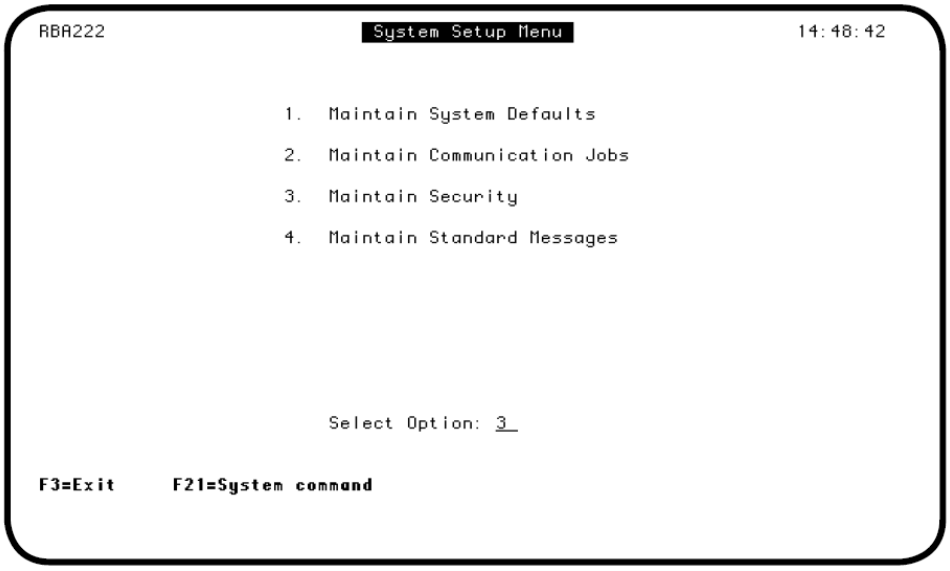
Example

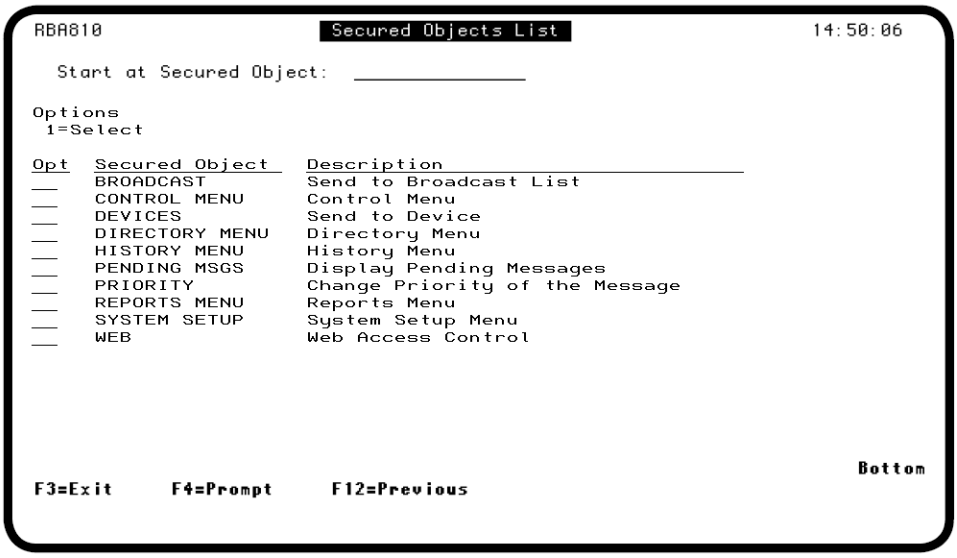
If you need to dial a 9 on your phone system to get an outside line, you would enter **9**, (nine followed by a comma).

Setting Up Robot Alert Security

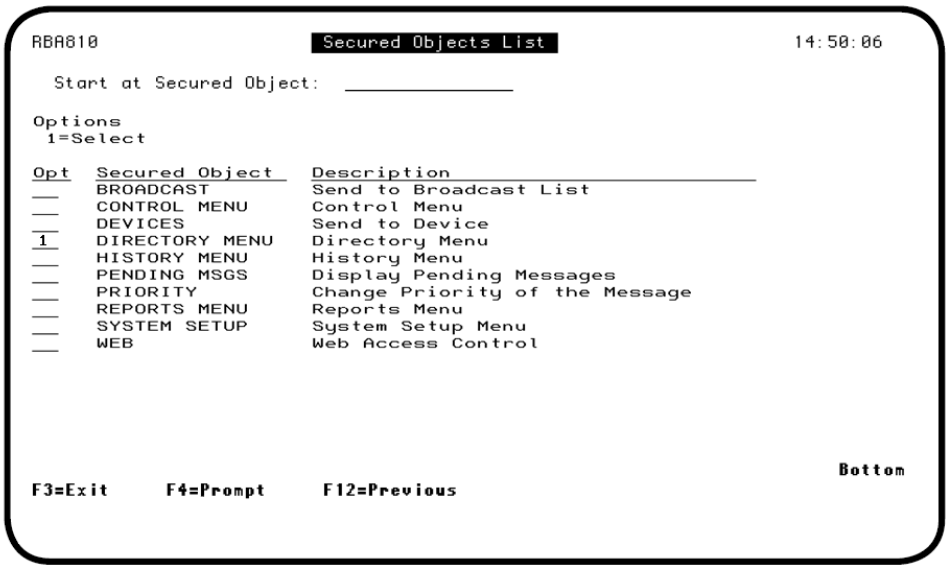
The Secured Objects List panel shows the functions you can restrict to specific users. You can define separate security restrictions for each Robot Alert object, broadcast list, and device.

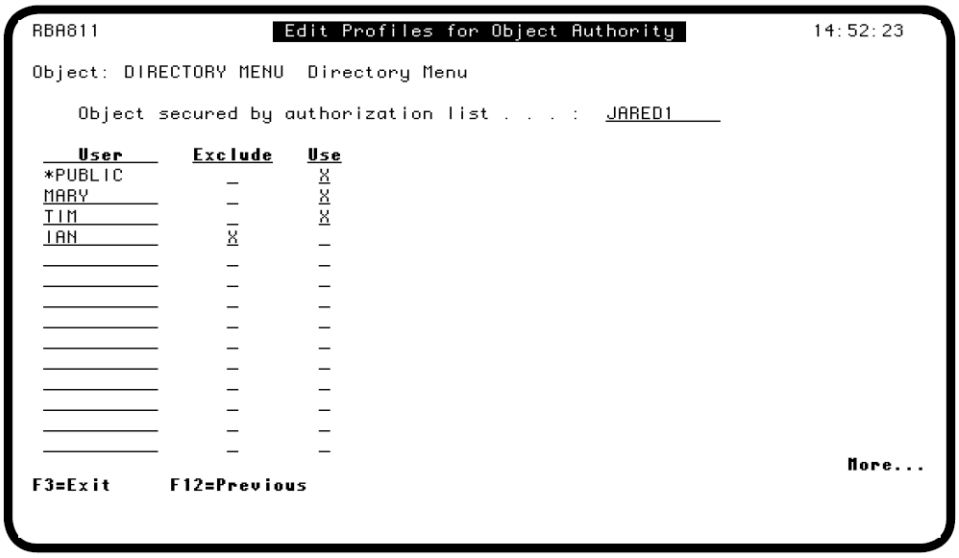
To display the Secured Objects List panel, enter option **3** on the System Setup Menu.





In the Edit Profiles for Object Authority panel, you can set up security on Robot Alert objects, except for broadcast lists and devices. The security options include excluding users or giving users the ability to use, add, change, and delete objects. To display the Edit Profiles for Object Authority panel, enter option **1** next to an object in the list.





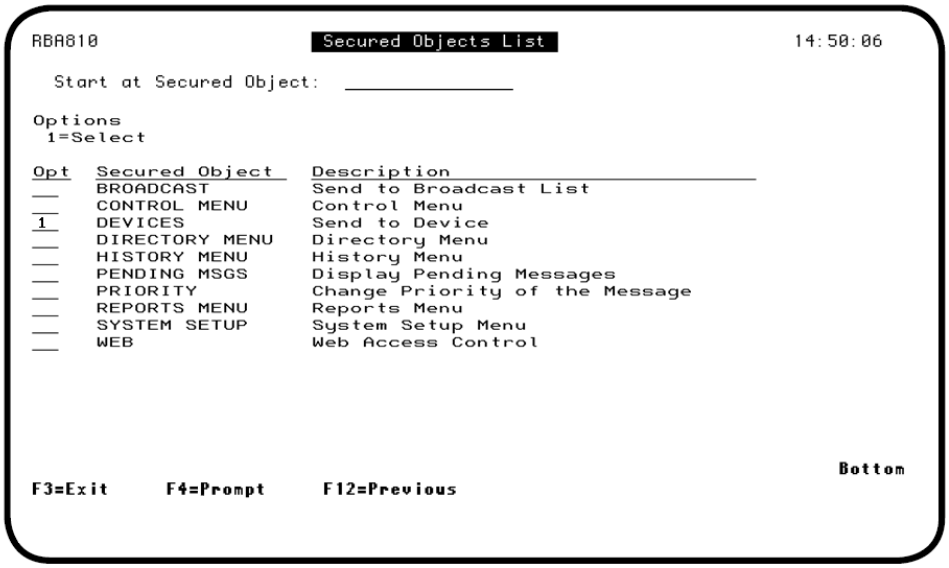
Enter the user profiles to which you want to assign security options.

Enter **X** in this column to deny the user profile access.

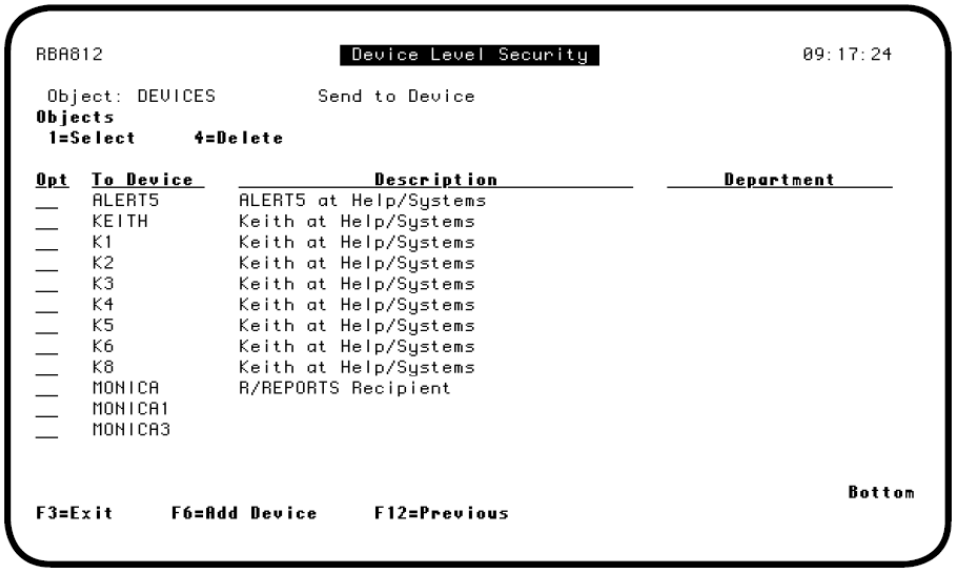
Enter **X** in this column to grant the user profile access.

Setting Up Broadcast List and Device Security

You can secure a device or broadcast list so that only a select group can send messages to it. However, if a person is authorized to use a broadcast list, but not authorized to every device on the list, those devices will not receive the message. The example shown is for devices, but broadcast lists are secured the same way.

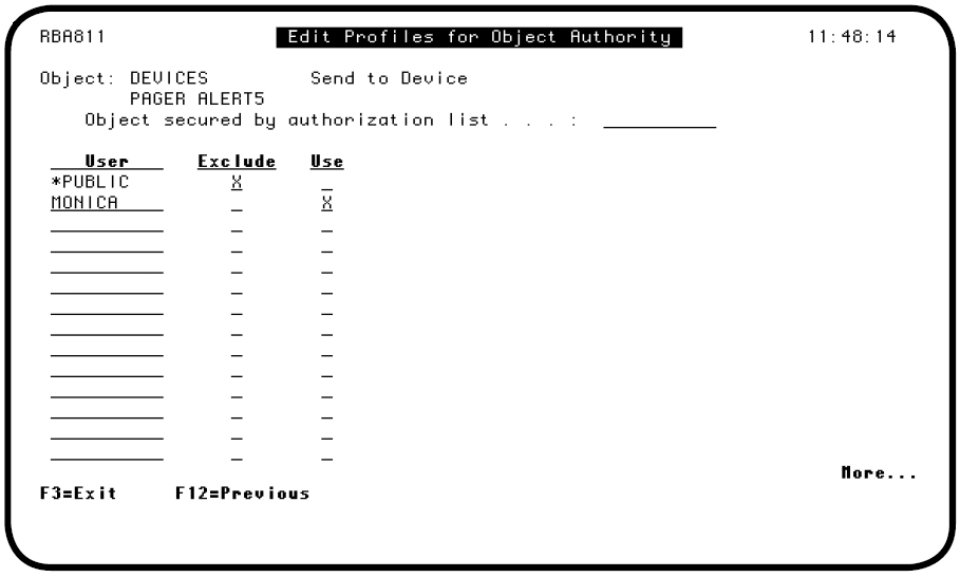


Select DEVICES from the list by entering **1** in the Opt column. The Device Level Security panel displays.



Enter a **1** next to the device to which you want to assign security. Select one device at a time. The Edit Profiles for Object Authority panel displays.

If the device you need is not on the list, you can press **F6** to display a list of system devices and add a device to the list.

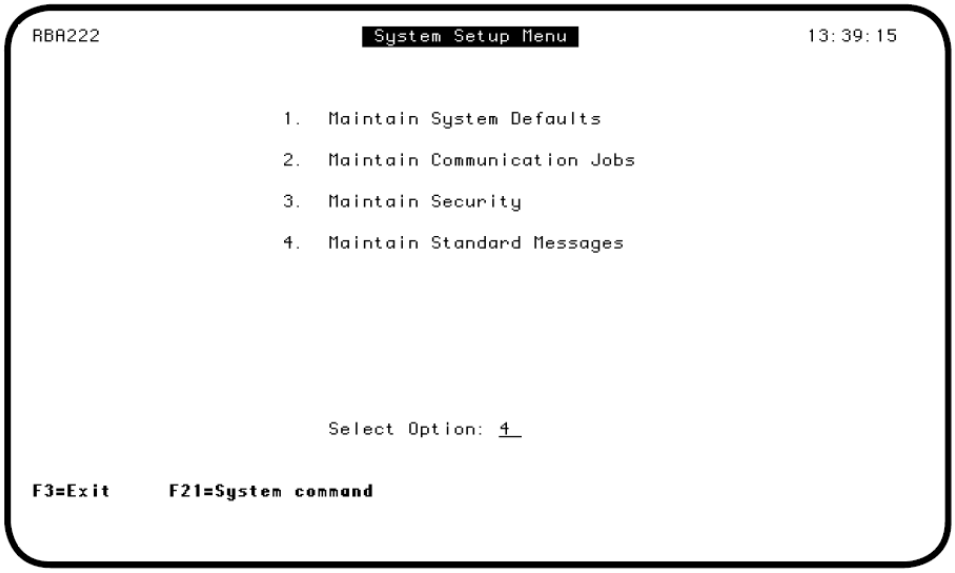


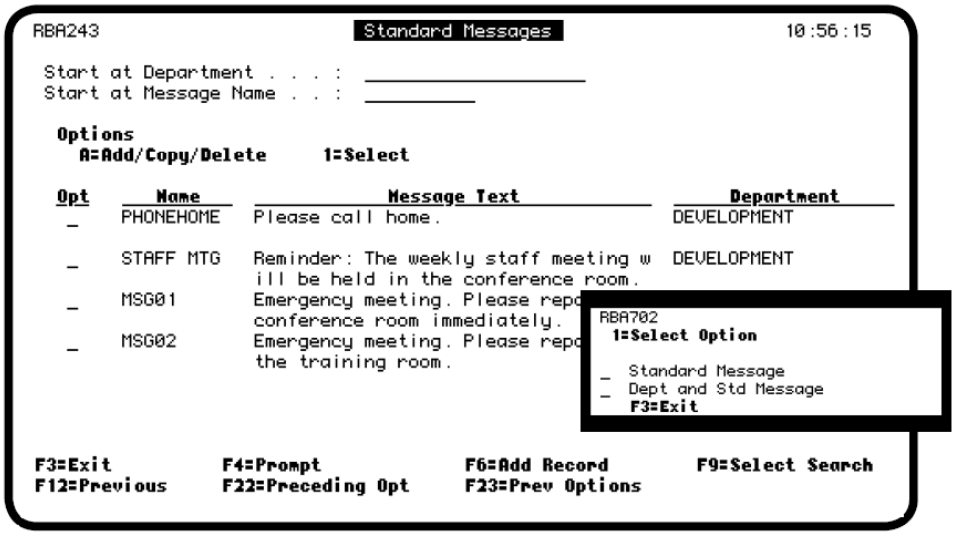
Specify whether users will be able to send messages to this device.

- Enter **X** in the Exclude field to prohibit the user from sending messages to the device.
- Enter **X** in the Use field to allow the user to send messages to the device.

Creating and Maintaining Standard Messages

Standard messages are messages that you send frequently. By setting up standard messages, you avoid having to re-key the message. To maintain standard messages, select option **4**, Maintain Standard Messages, from the Robot Alert System Setup Menu. The Standard Messages panel displays with a list of standard messages that have been created.



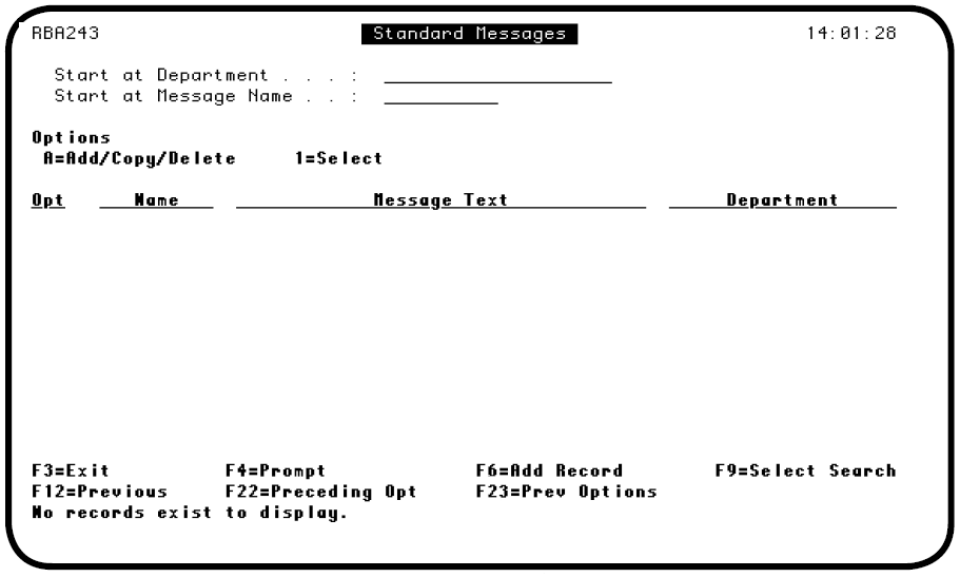


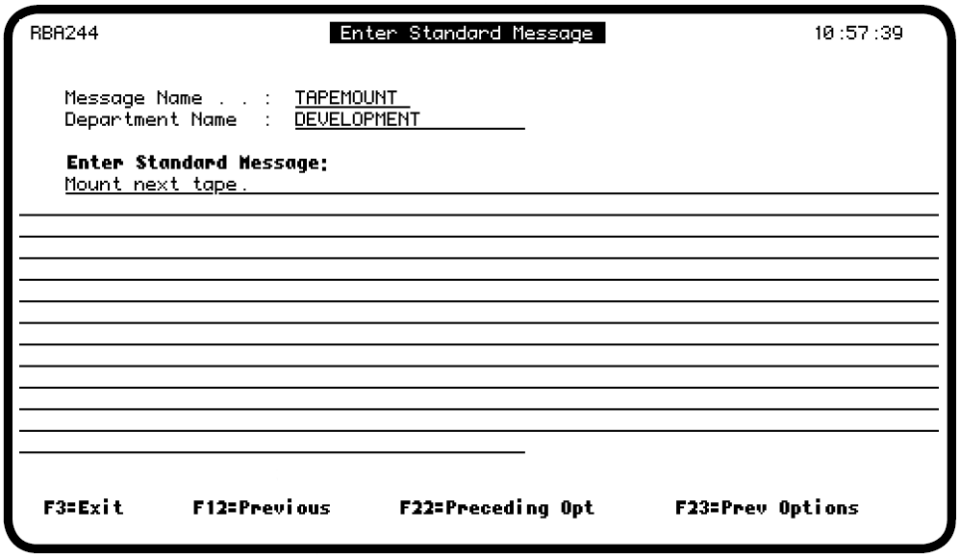
You can add, copy, or delete a message by entering the appropriate option letter next to the message and pressing Enter.

You can search by standard message, or by department and standard message.

Creating Standard Messages

You create standard messages using the Enter Standard Message panel. To display the panel, press **F6** on the Standard Messages panel.



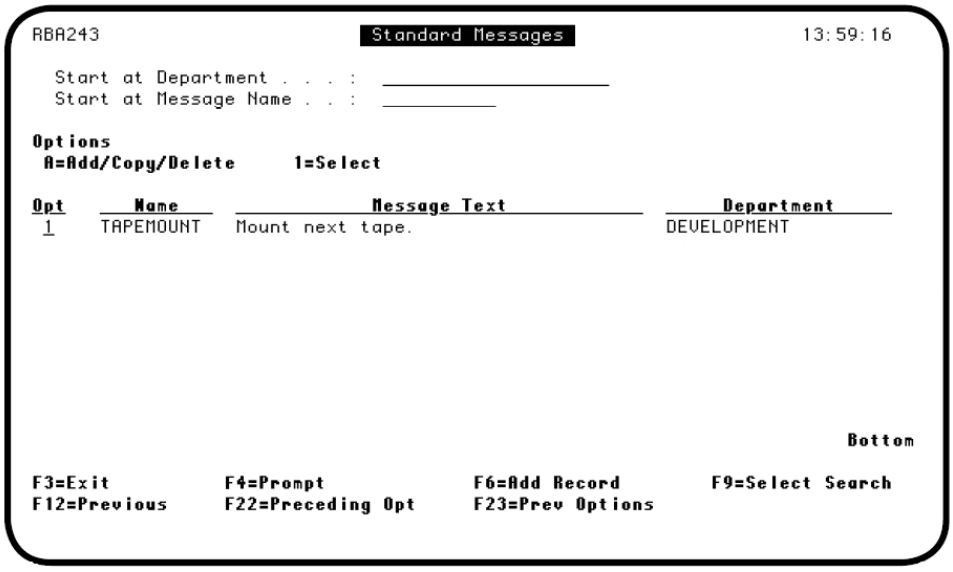


Enter the name of the standard message you're creating. If this message is being created for a specific department, enter the department name. Otherwise, leave the Department Name field blank.

Enter the standard message text. When finished, press Enter and **F3** to return to the Standard Messages panel.

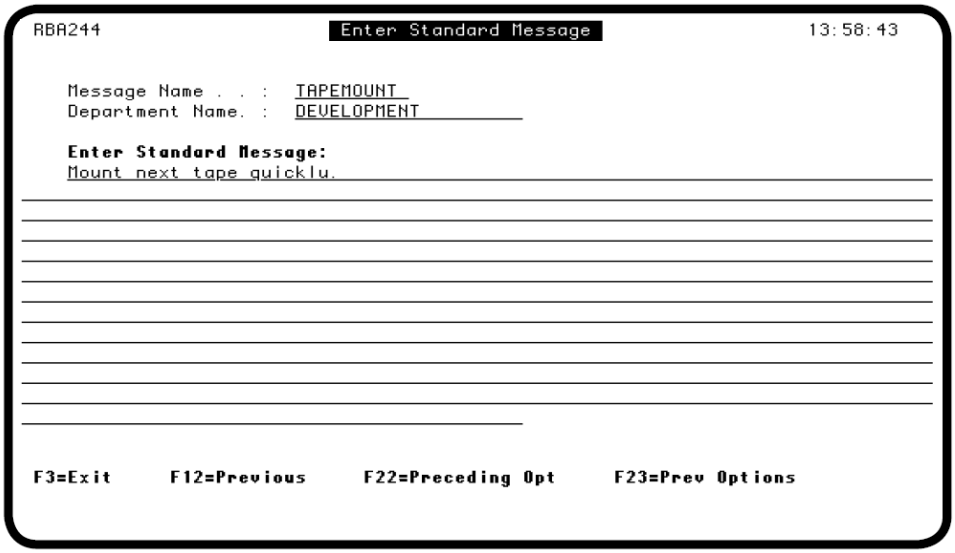
Maintaining Standard Messages

You maintain standard messages using the Enter Standard Message panel. To display the panel with the message you want to maintain, enter a **1** next to the message and press Enter on the Standard Messages panel.

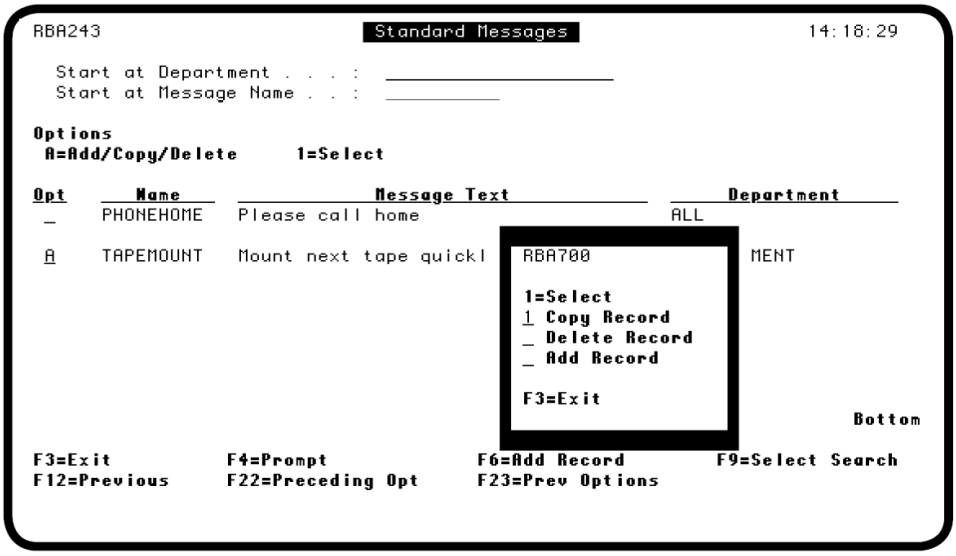


You can add, copy, or delete a message by entering the appropriate option letter next to the message and pressing Enter.

Enter a **1** next to a message and press Enter to select the message. The Enter Standard Message panel displays the message.

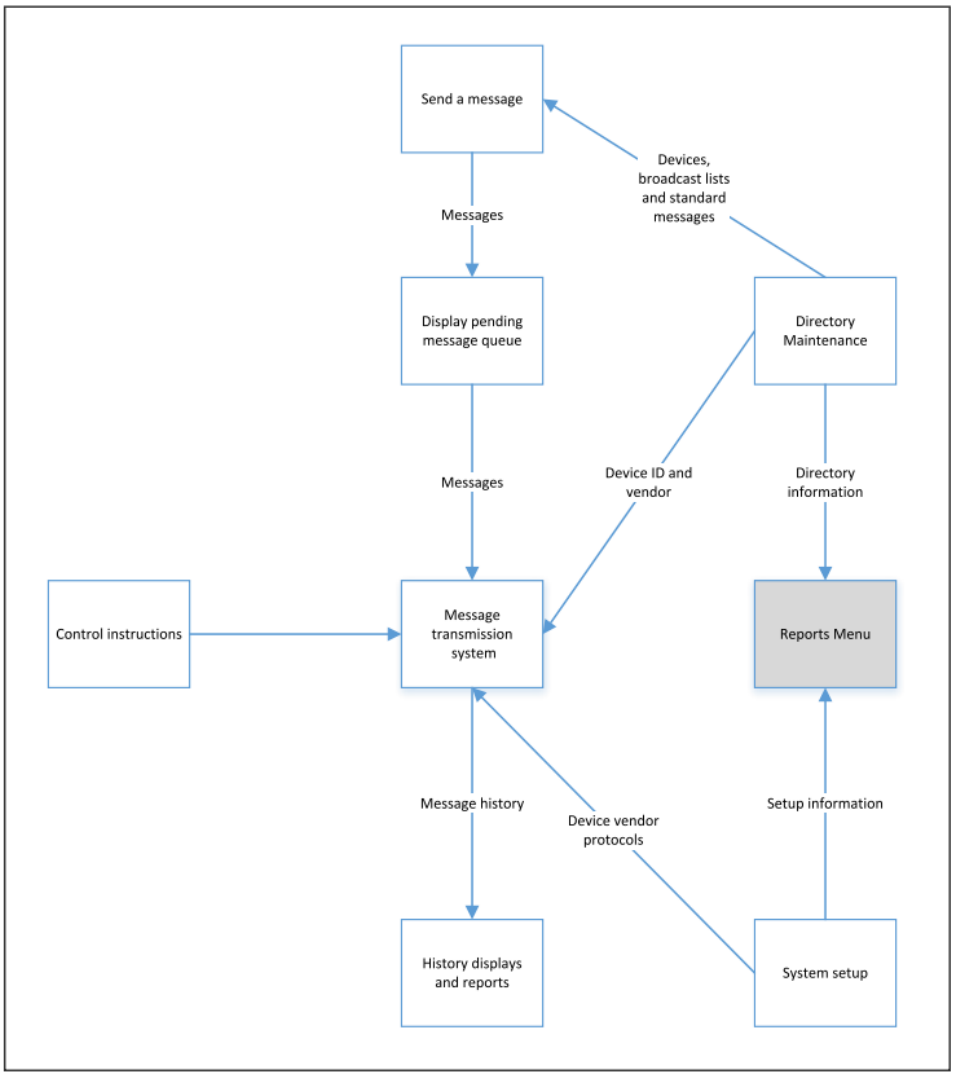


Edit the standard message text. When finished, press Enter. Press **F3** to return to the Standard Messages panel when you're finished editing the standard message.



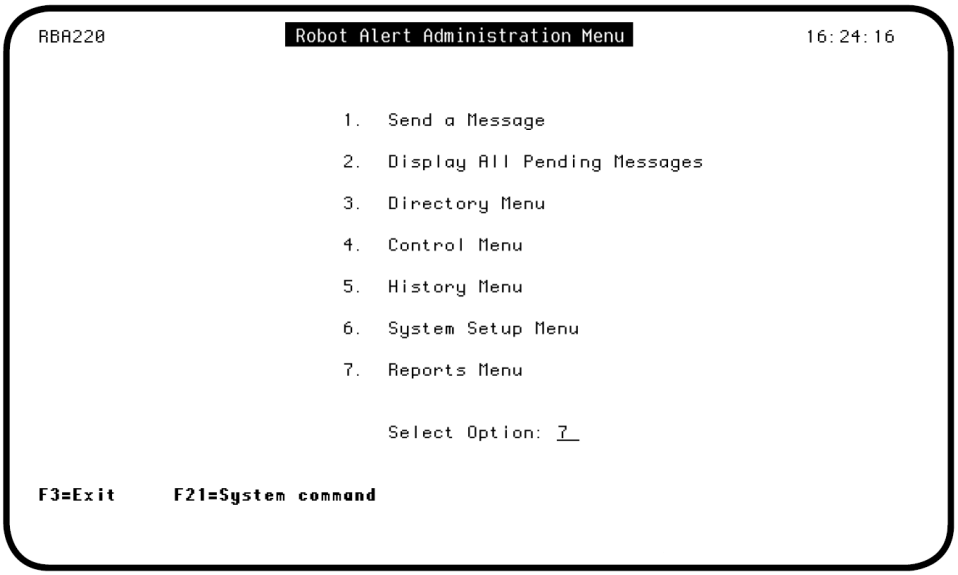
You can add, copy, or delete a message by entering the appropriate option letter next to the message and pressing Enter. When the option window displays, enter a **1** next to the option you want to perform.

Reports

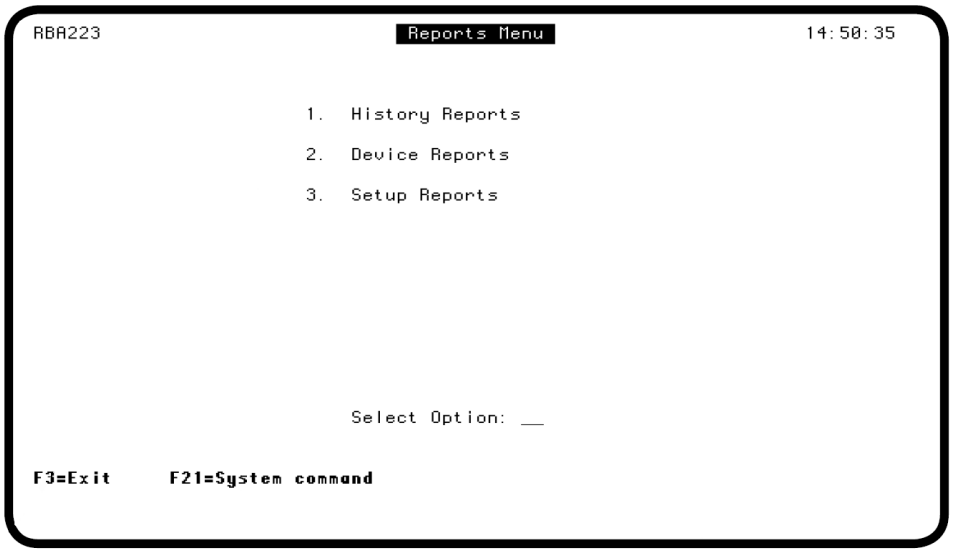


Robot Alert Reports Menu

Robot Alert offers a variety of history reports, device reports, and setup reports.



Select option **7** on the Robot Alert Administration Menu to access the Reports Menu.



Field Descriptions

History Reports

Prints the Transmission Log or the Message History report.

Device Reports

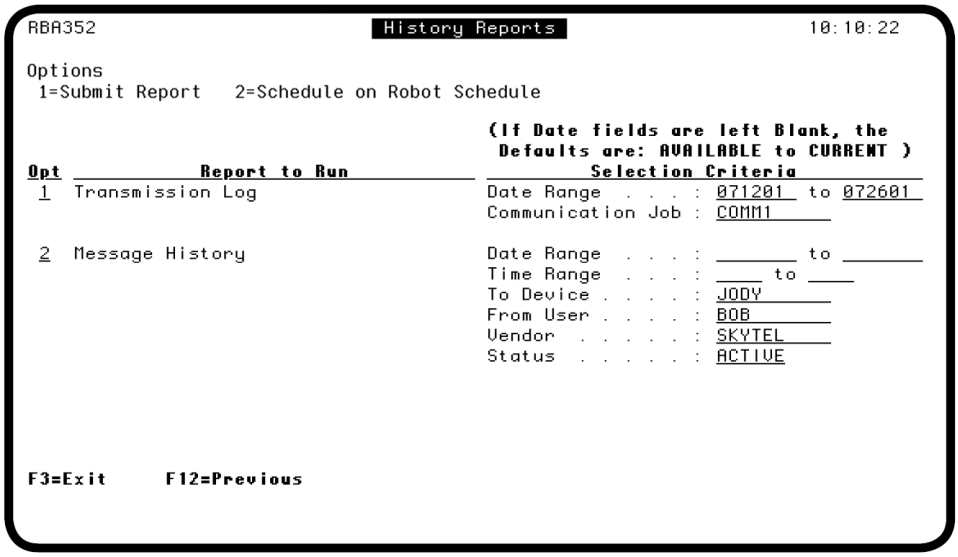
Prints the Device Directory (in selected order) or the Broadcast List Directory (in selected order).

Setup Reports

Prints various Robot Alert setup reports. Setup information includes communication jobs, vendors, and standard messages.

Printing a Report

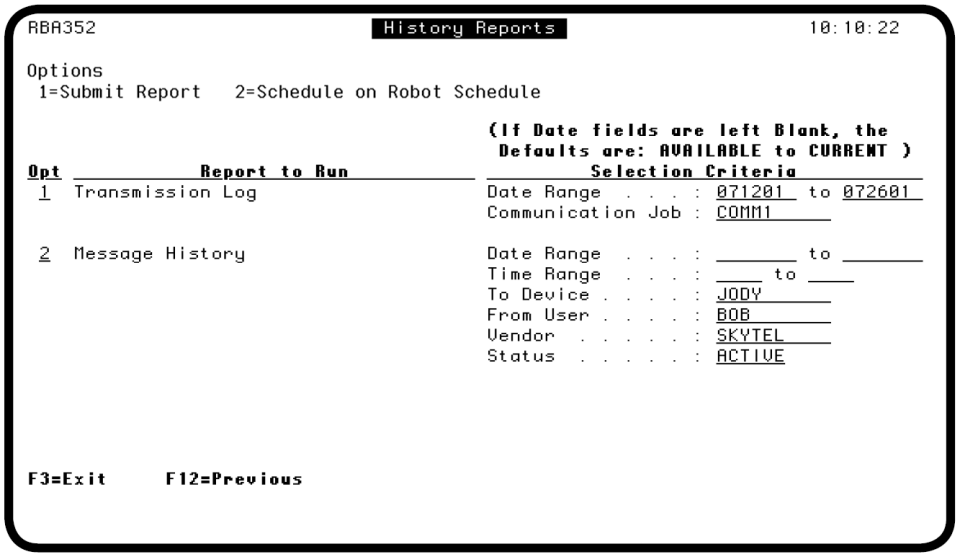
To submit a job immediately to print a report, enter **1** in the Opt column next to the report. If you have Robot Schedule installed, you can enter option **2** to schedule a Robot Schedule job to print the report.



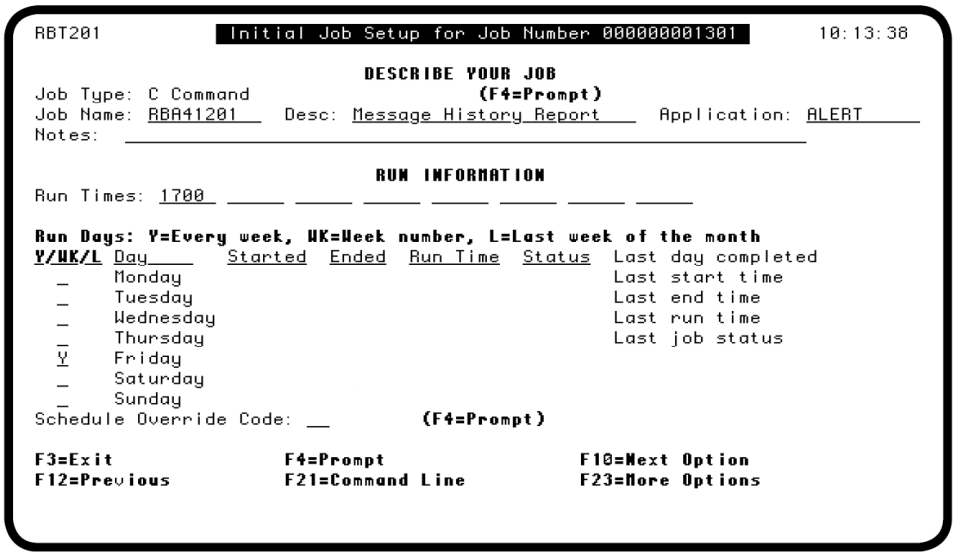
You can indicate the information to be included on Robot Alert reports by entering report selection criteria. Selection criteria includes date and time ranges, vendors, users who sent and received messages, and statuses.

Scheduling the Report on Robot Schedule

To schedule a Robot Schedule job to print a report, Robot Alert displays the Robot Schedule Initial Job Setup panel. It has already filled in the job description information and the commands to run the report; all you need to do is enter when you want the job to run.



Enter option **2** to schedule a Robot Schedule job to print the report.



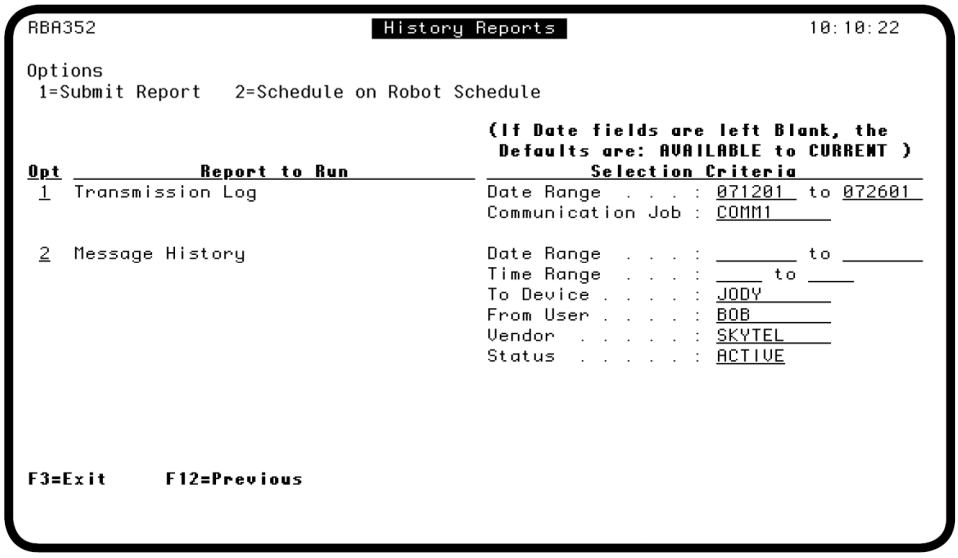
Enter **Y** next to the days you want the report to run. A check mark indicates the report will run.

Enter the time you want the report to run.

For more scheduling options, press **F10** to display the Advanced Scheduling panel.

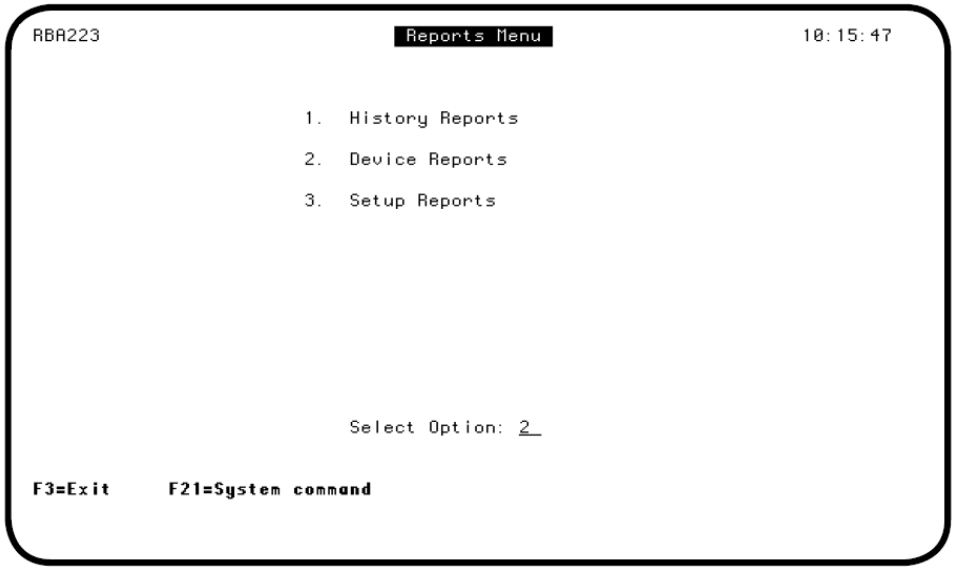
History Reports

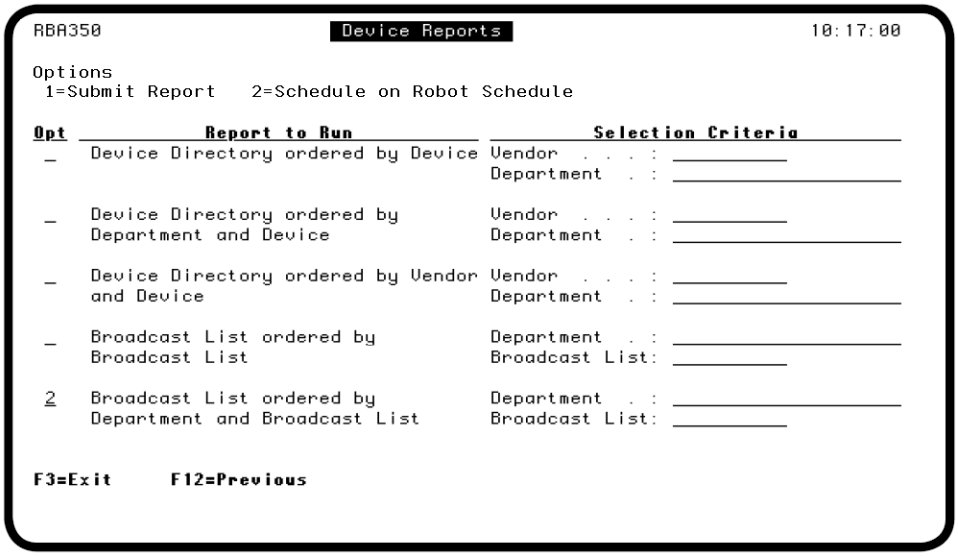
From the History Reports panel, you can print reports that list Robot Alert Transmission Log or Message History. History Reports can be accessed from the Reports Menu or from the History Menu. From the Reports Menu, select option **1** or from the History menu, select option **3** to display the History Reports panel. For more information on History reports, see Printing History Reports.



Device Reports

From the Device Reports panel, you can print reports that list the devices and broadcast lists that you have set up in Robot Alert. These reports provide an important record of your devices and broadcast lists in case your system fails and you lose this information. To display the Device Reports panel, enter option **2** on the Reports Menu.



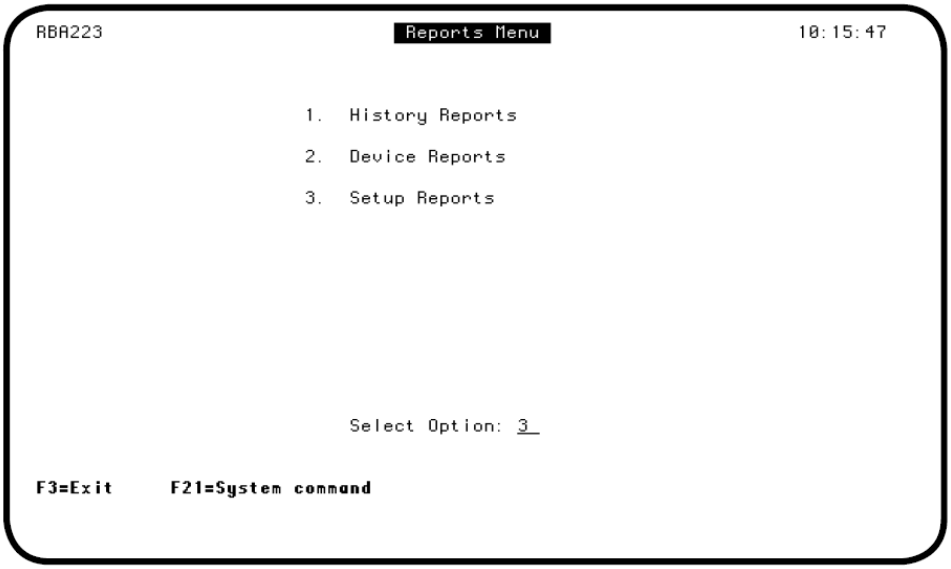


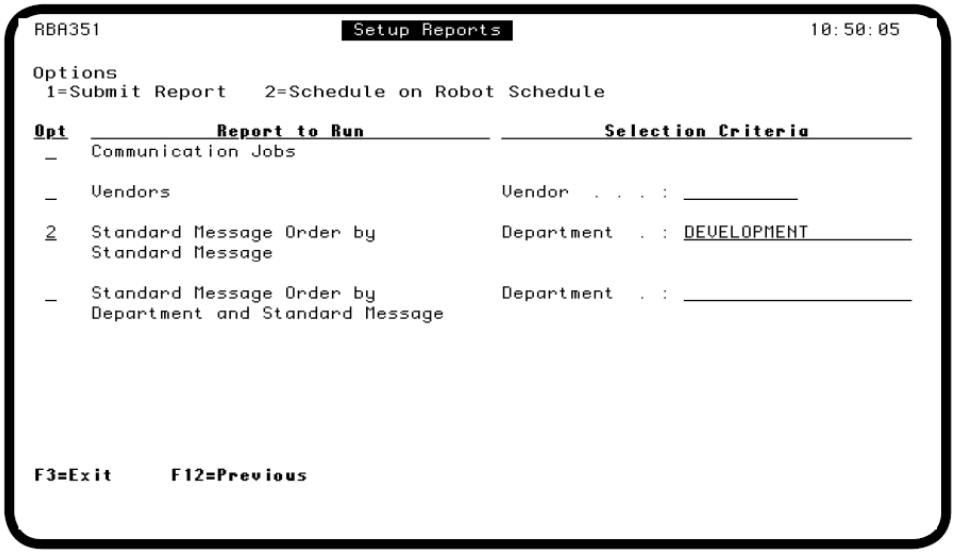
Use these reports for a current record of your devices and broadcast lists.

- The Device Directory report lists all of the devices defined to Robot Alert. You can print this report by device, by department and device, or by vendor and device.
- The Broadcast List report lists all of the broadcast lists set up in Robot Alert and shows the devices defined to each list. You can print this report by broadcast list, or by department and broadcast list.

Setup Reports

From the Setup Reports panel, you can print reports that list the setup information for your communication jobs, vendors, and standard messages. These reports provide an important record of your setup information in case your system fails and you lose this information. To display the Setup Reports panel, enter option **3** on the Reports Menu.





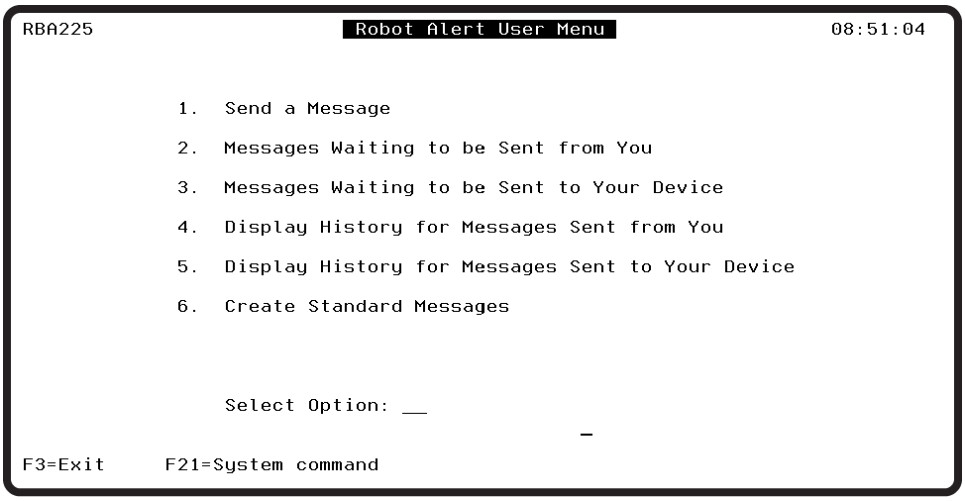
Use these reports for a current record of the setup information for your communications jobs, vendors, and standard messages.

- The Communication Jobs report displays the setup information for the communication jobs defined to Robot Alert.
- The Vendors report displays the setup information for each vendor defined to Robot Alert.
- The Standard Messages report shows the standard messages you have set up, by standard message, or by department and standard message.

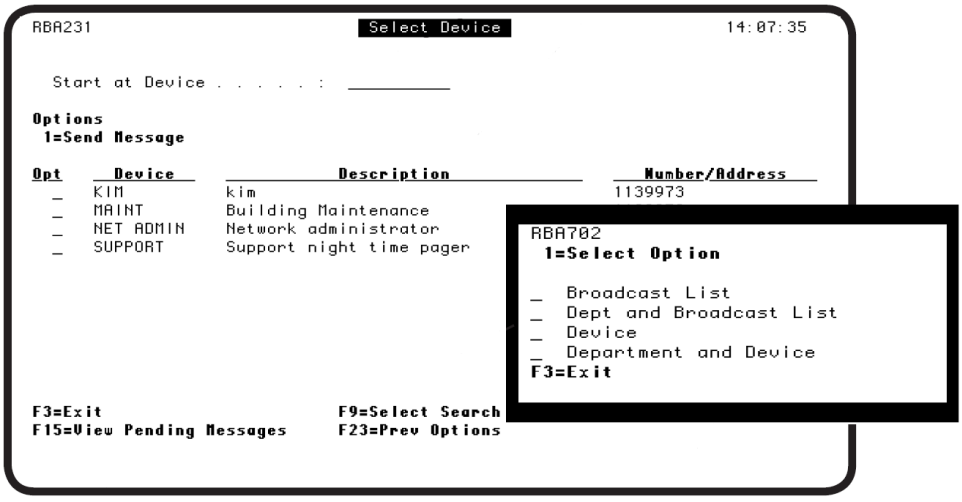
Using Robot Alert

Sending a Robot Alert Message to a Device

From your workstation, you can send a message through Robot Alert to any of the devices listed in your device directory. To access the Robot Alert User Menu, enter this command: RBTALRLIB/RBAUSER.



Select option **1**, Send a Message, on the Robot Alert User Menu.



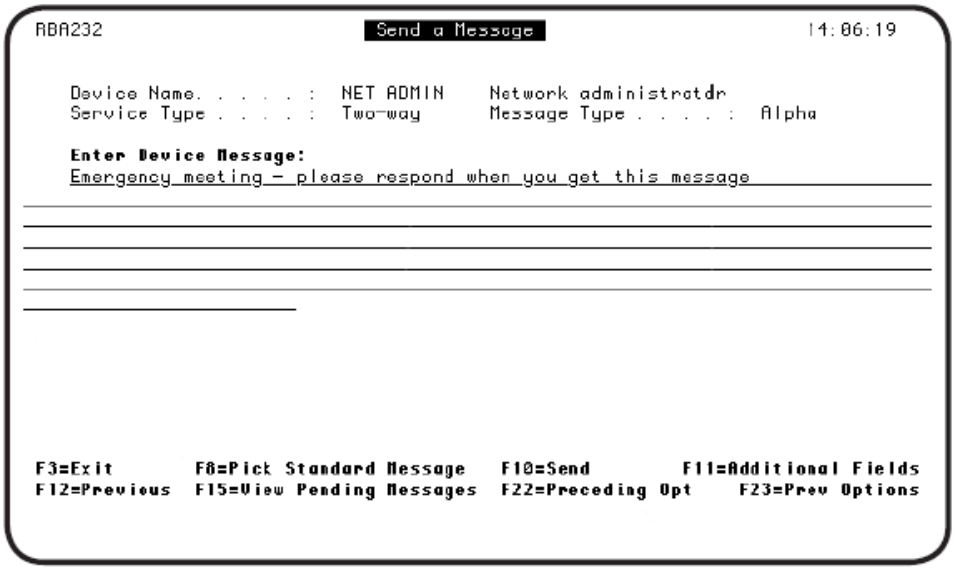
- The Select Device panel shows the list of devices defined to Robot Alert, and includes each device's description. To send a message, you must first select the device or broadcast list to which you're sending the message.

- Press **F15**, View Pending Messages, to display the Pending Messages for User (Profile) panel. This panel shows all messages you have created that have not been transmitted yet. For more information, refer to the Viewing Pending Message Queues topic found later in this section.
- Press **F9**, Select Search, to view the options for displaying the Select Device panel. For example, if you want to send your message to a broadcast list, enter 1 next to Broadcast List. For information on the Broadcast List option, refer to Sending a Message to a Broadcast List found later in this section.

The Send a Message Panel

Once you have selected a device on the Select Device panel, the Send a Message panel displays. On the Send a Message panel, you enter the message you want to send. To access this panel, enter 1 in the Opt column of the Select Device panel next to the device to which you want to send a message and press Enter.

Although the vendor's computer will receive the message from Robot Alert, the device must be turned "ON" to receive the message when the vendor transmits it.



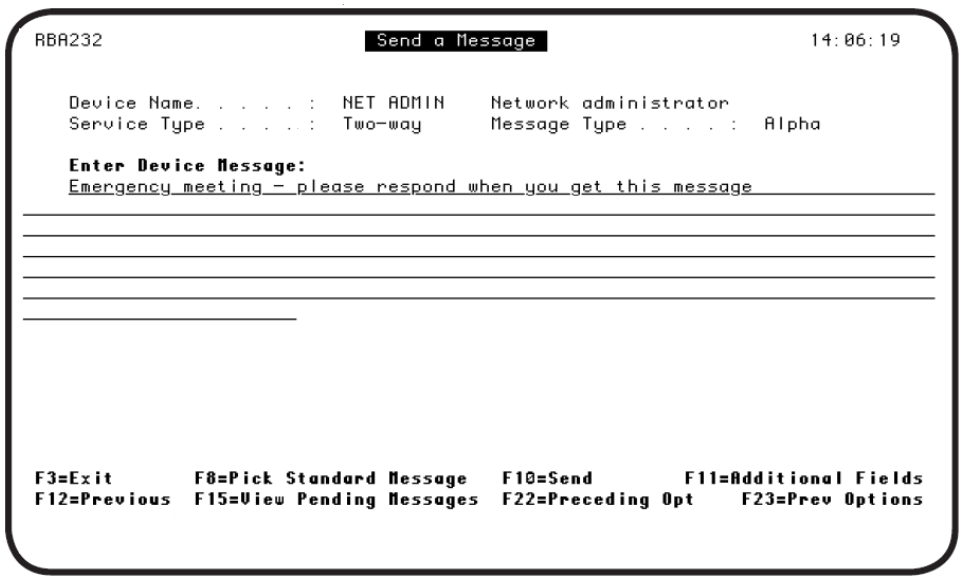
- The name of the device you selected from the list appears here, along with the service type (such as one-way), and message type.
- Press **F11** to view a window of options for sending response-required messages and two-way messages, which are covered later in this section.
- You can select from a list of standard messages you have set up previously by pressing F8.

- Enter the text of the message you want to send. If you're sending to a numeric device, enter the numeric string; if you're sending to a tone-only device, press F10. The limit for the number of characters you can send depends on the device vendor's limitations. You can enter only the number of characters in your message that the device vendor supports.
- Once you have entered the message, press F10 to send it. The Select Device panel displays, stating that the message was sent.

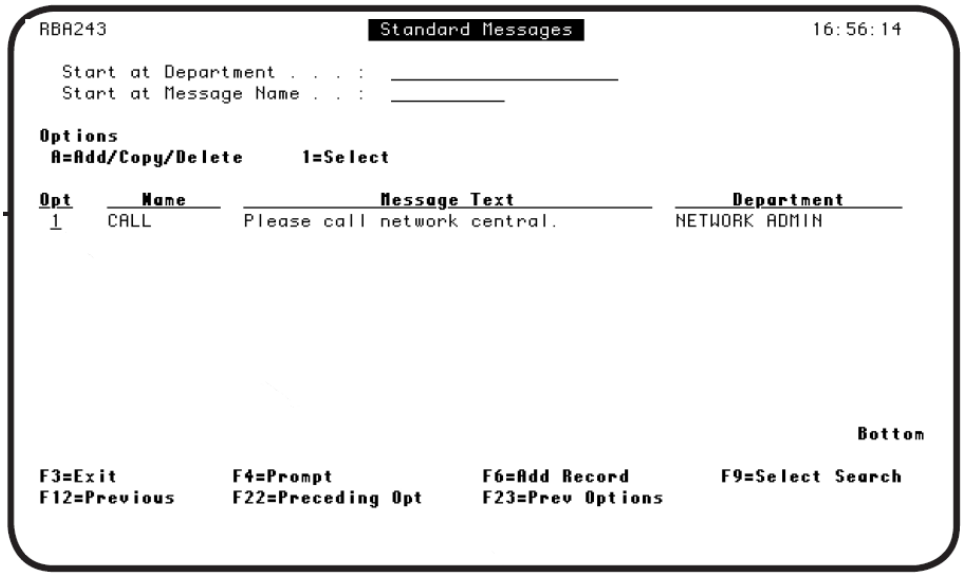
Sending a Standard Message

Standard messages are messages that you send frequently. Robot Alert allows you to save and reuse these messages.

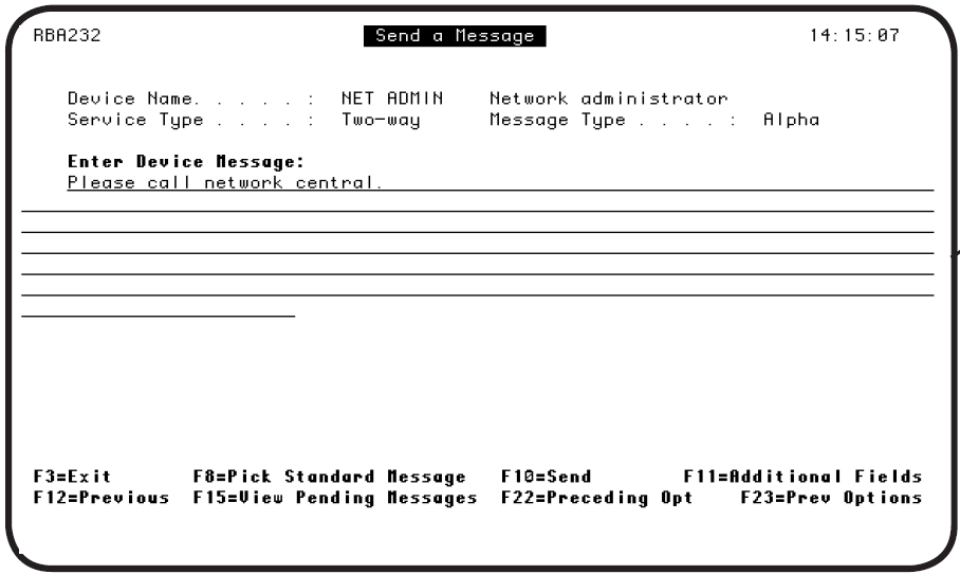
1. Press **F8** on the Send a Message panel to display a list of the standard messages that have been created. Then, select the message you want to send. The message displays in the Send a Message panel.
2. Press **F8** to select from a list of previously defined standard messages.



3. Enter **1** next to the standard message you want to send. The Send a Message panel displays with the standard message displayed. You can revise or add to the message in this panel.



4. Press **F10** to send the standard message.

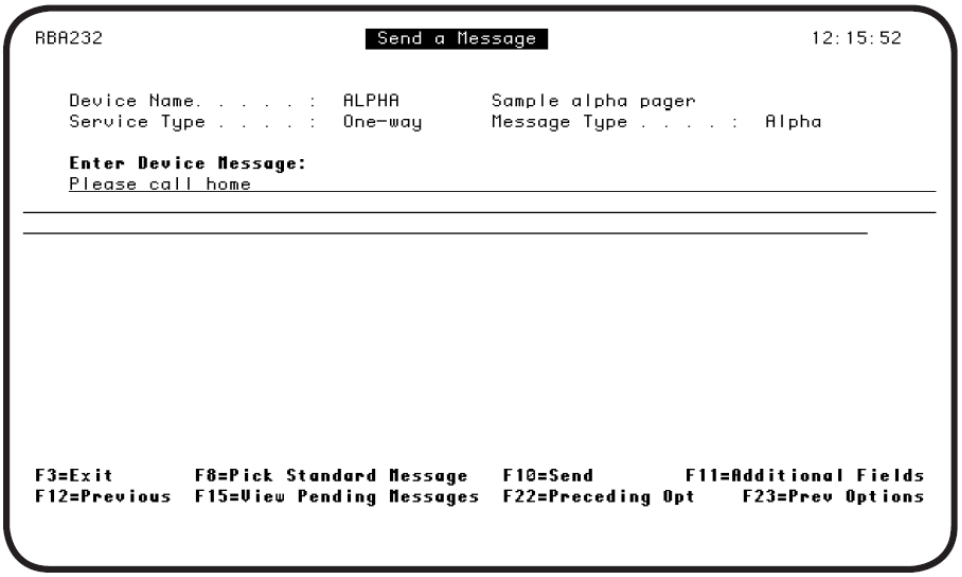


Sending a Response-Required Message

Use a response-required message whenever it is important you have confirmation that the device message was received and noted. For example, a person traveling during a page could be temporarily in a location where the device cannot pick up the transmission. Robot Alert will resend a message the number of tries specified, or until the person does one of the following:

- Answers with a two-way device
- Acknowledges on the pending message queue that the message was received

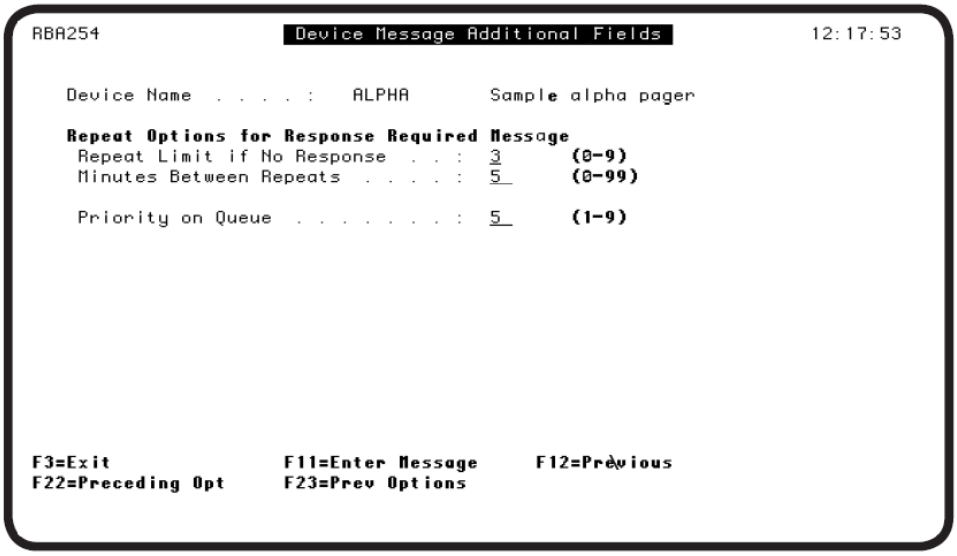
1. Press **F11** to display additional options for sending messages.



2. If a response is required for the message, you can indicate the number of times (up to 9) you want Robot Alert to send the message if no response is received, and the number of minutes (up to 99) to wait between repeats.

   Setting these values to zero (0) indicates a one-way message.

   Assign the priority level the message is to have on the device queue: 1 is the highest priority; 9 is the lowest.

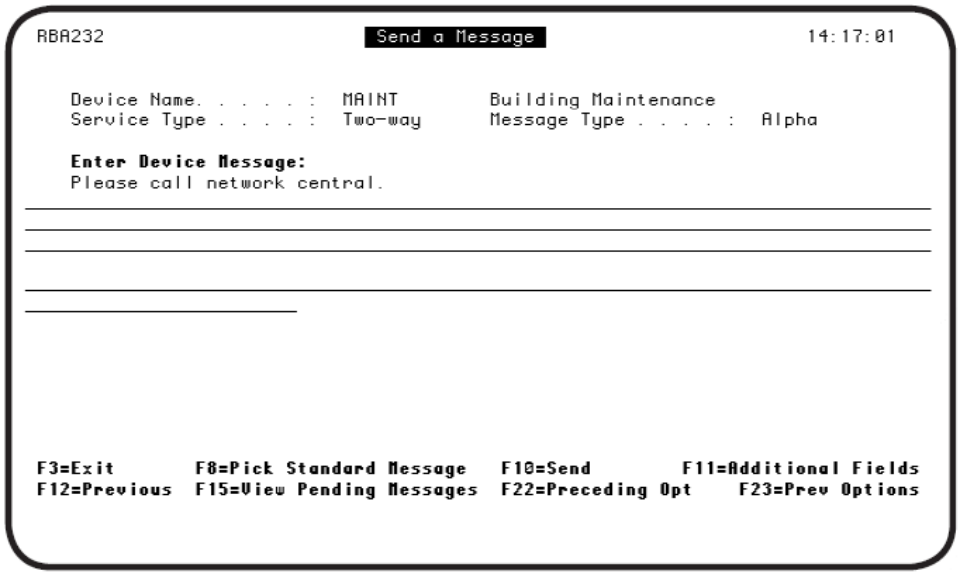


Sending a Two-Way Message

If your devices have a two-way messaging vendor, Robot Alert can send a message and a list of responses for the device. The number of choices you can send is determined by your

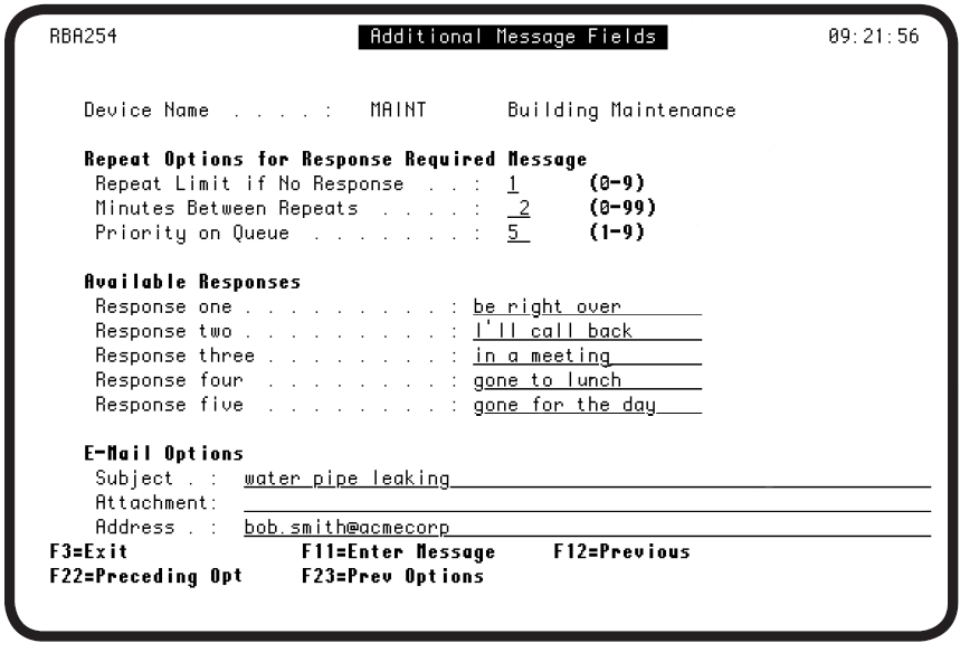
messaging vendor. The device can respond to the message using these responses. You can view the response in the Message Status panel. For a two-way message, Robot Alert contacts the messaging vendor once to send the message and again to receive a response. If it does not receive a response in the specified time limit, Robot Alert continues sending the message until it reaches the repeat limit (if the repeat limit is greater than zero).

1. Select a device that has a two-way paging vendor, enter your message, and press **F11** to display the Available Responses fields on the Additional Message Fields panel.



2. Enter the responses the device can choose from. The number of responses you can enter is determined by your paging vendor. Do not use hyphens (-). Hyphens are reserved to indicate a numeric range of acceptable responses, such as 1-99. The device cannot use a hyphen in the response.
3. Enter text here for the subject line of an email.
4. The Attachment field appears if the device you selected is an email device that allows attachments. It appears for both response-required messages and one-way messages. Use it to specify an email attachment as part of the message. The attachment must be an IFS file with its full path name specified.
5. The Address field displays when you're sending a message to an email device (the field does not display when you send to a broadcast list). You can use this field to specify a temporary email address that is different than the email address assigned to the device. This temporary address is used just once, for the current message

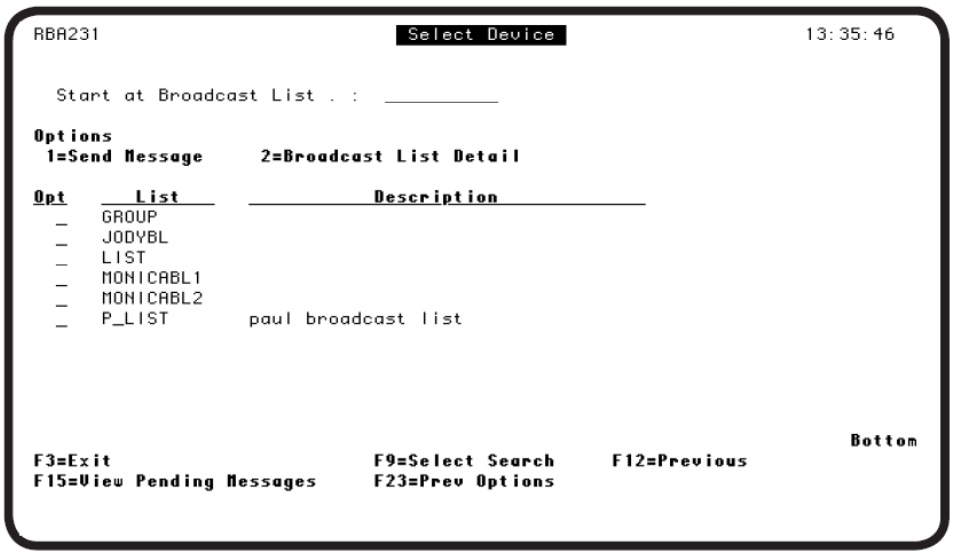
only.



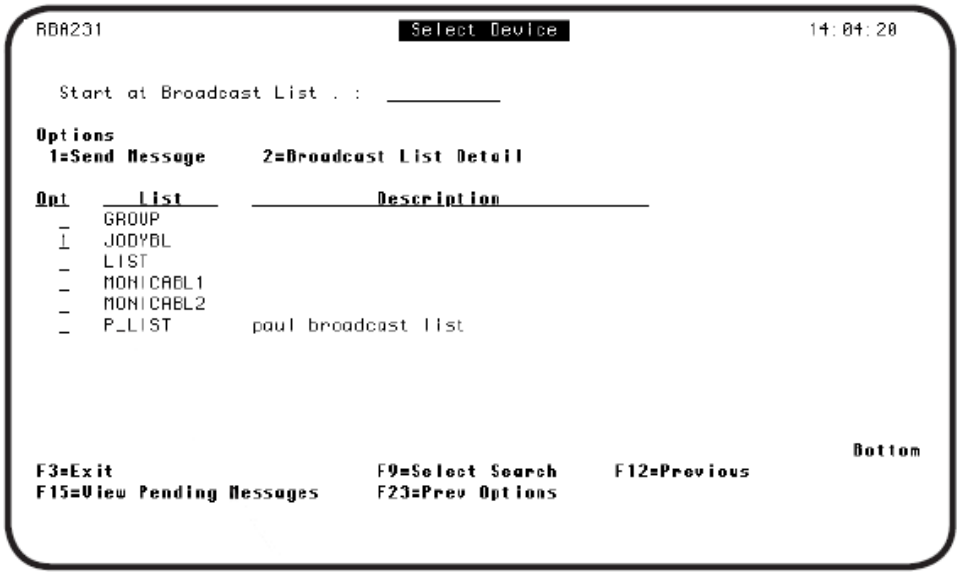
Sending a Message to a Broadcast List

Robot Alert lets you send a message to multiple devices at the same time through its broadcast list feature. Once you have defined a broadcast list to Robot Alert (see Robot Alert Administration), you can select it the same way you select a device. You avoid having to re-key and send the same message to several devices. You can also use a broadcast list for automatic problem escalation.

To display the broadcast lists defined to Robot Alert, press **F9** and select Broadcast List from the options window. The Select Device panel displays with the list of broadcast lists that have been set up.

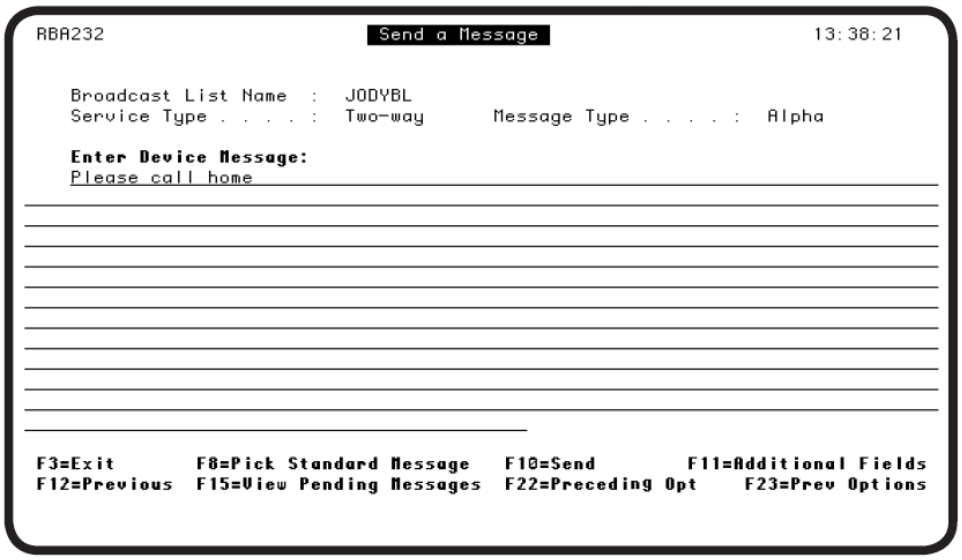


1. Enter **1** next to the broadcast list you want to send a message to. The Send a Message panel displays.



2. Enter the message and press **F10** to send it. A device message will be created for each device in the broadcast list and sent to the pending message queue for

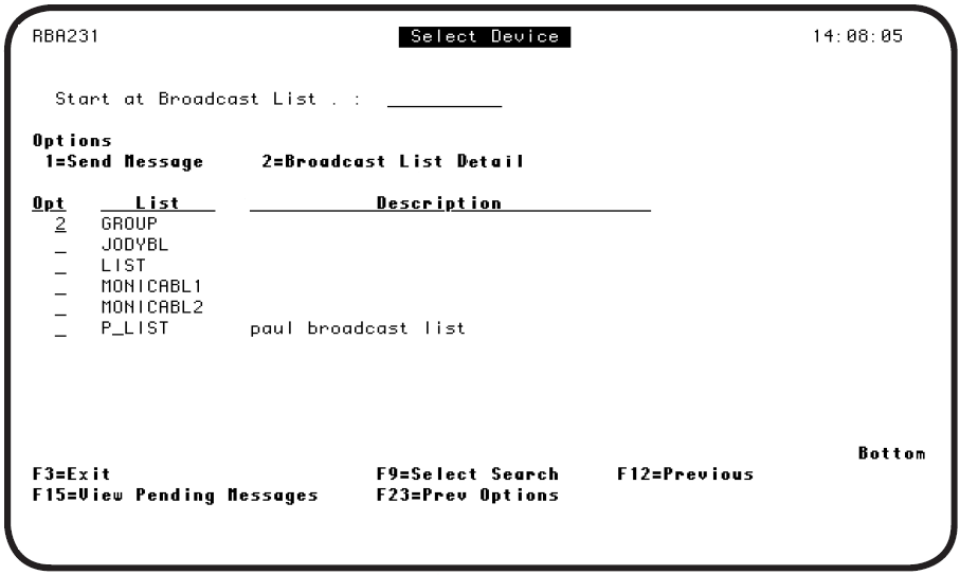
transmission.



Viewing Broadcast List Detail

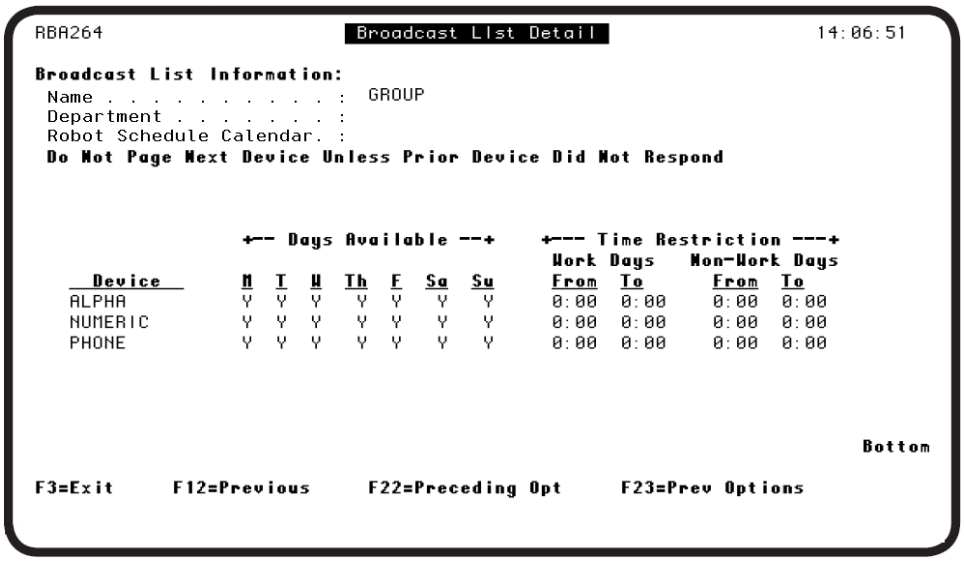
To see who is on a broadcast list and the response required option, enter option **2** next to a broadcast list. The Broadcast List Detail panel displays. If you're using Robot Schedule calendaring, the work and non-work times available for each device are displayed. If you do not have Robot Schedule, the work and non-work times do not appear.

Select option **2** on the Select Device panel to view detailed information for a broadcast list.



The broadcast list information that appears at the top of the Broadcast List Detail panel includes the name of the list, the department assigned to the list (optional), and the Robot

Schedule calendar name (optional). It also indicates whether a response is required for messages sent to the list.



Field Descriptions

Days Available

Y Indicates the days Robot Alert will send a message to that device.

N Indicates no device message will be sent on that day.

Work Days

The times during a workday (based on the selected Robot Schedule calendar) that Robot Alert will not send a message to the device.

Non-Work Days

The times during a non-workday (based on the selected Robot Schedule calendar) that Robot Alert will not send a message to that device.

Viewing Pending Message Queues

A pending message queue is like a printer queue. When a message is created and sent it goes to the end of the queue (unless it has a higher priority) and waits until the message transmission program sends it. If the message cannot be sent, or is waiting for a response,

it remains on the queue. Also, the status of unacknowledged response-required messages and two-way messages is set to LIMIT and they remain in the queue. From a pending message queue, you can display additional information about a message, or change its status.

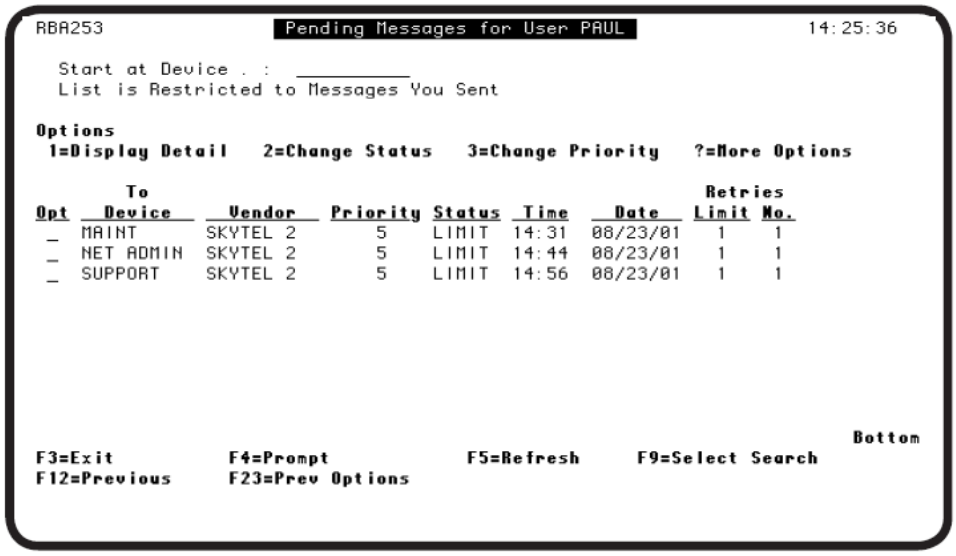
You can display pending message queues using options **2** and **3** from the Robot Alert User Menu. You can also display these queues by pressing **F15**, View Pending Messages, from various Robot Alert panels.



- Option **2** displays a list of device messages you have sent that are waiting to be transmitted.
- Option **3** displays a list of device messages sent to you that are waiting to be transmitted.
- Both options, **2** and **3**, display the following types of messages:
  - Messages sent but not acknowledged
  - Messages waiting in line on a message queue to be sent
  - Messages that could not be sent due to an error

  The following example of the Pending Messages for User (Profile) panel shows

option **2**, Messages Waiting to be Sent from You.



Field Descriptions

Opt

Enter ? to display the list of options you can use for the message:

1 Displays additional message status detail.

2 Lets you change the message status.

3 Lets you change the message priority.

4 Deletes the message.

5 Displays the transmission log.

To Device

The name of the device receiving the message.

Vendor

The vendor to which the device is assigned.

Priority

The priority level assigned to the device message, from 1-9, with 1 the highest priority and 9 the lowest.

Status

The status of the device message. The possible statuses are:

ACK Response required message has been acknowledged.

ACTIVE Message is being sent.

FAIL-V Didn't connect with vendor, or connected with vendor and failed.

FAIL-P Device ID rejected by vendor.

FAIL-R Two-way message failed trying to get a response.

HOLD Message is on hold. Robot Alert will not send the message nor look for a response.

HOLD-D Message was sent to a held device.

LIMIT Repeat limit reached with no response.

READY Message is ready and waiting for transmission.

REPEAT Message not responded to; waiting to repeat send.

SENT One-way message completed.

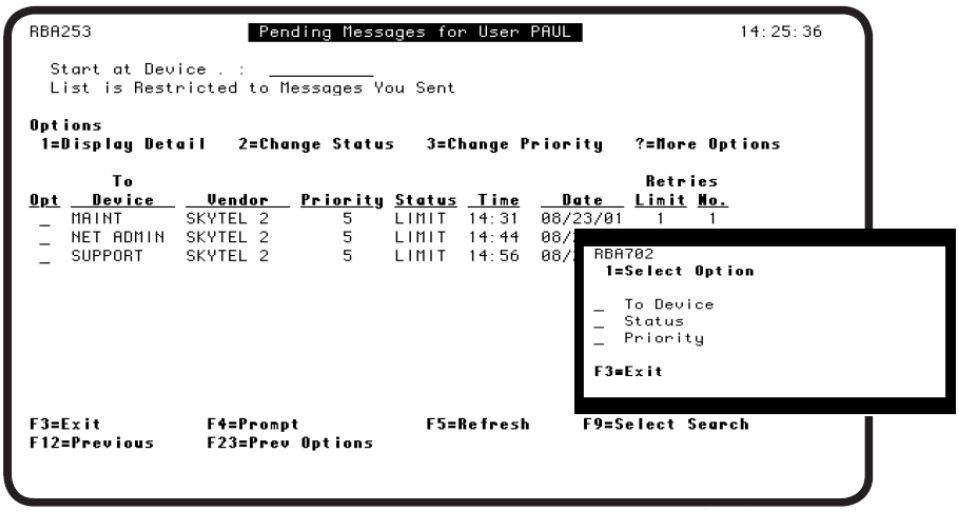
SENT-R Two-way message sent; waiting for response

Time and date

The time and date the status occurred. If you press F5, the time and date changes if the status has changed.

Retries Limit/No.

The limit set for the number of retries for this message, and the current retry attempt.



Pressing **F9** lets you select the order in which the information displays in this window.

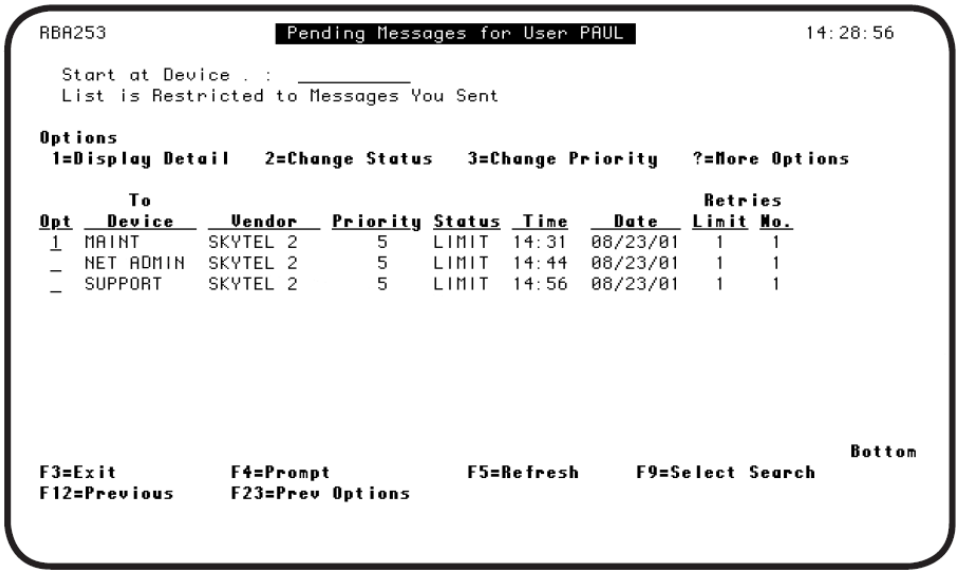
To Device sorts messages by device.

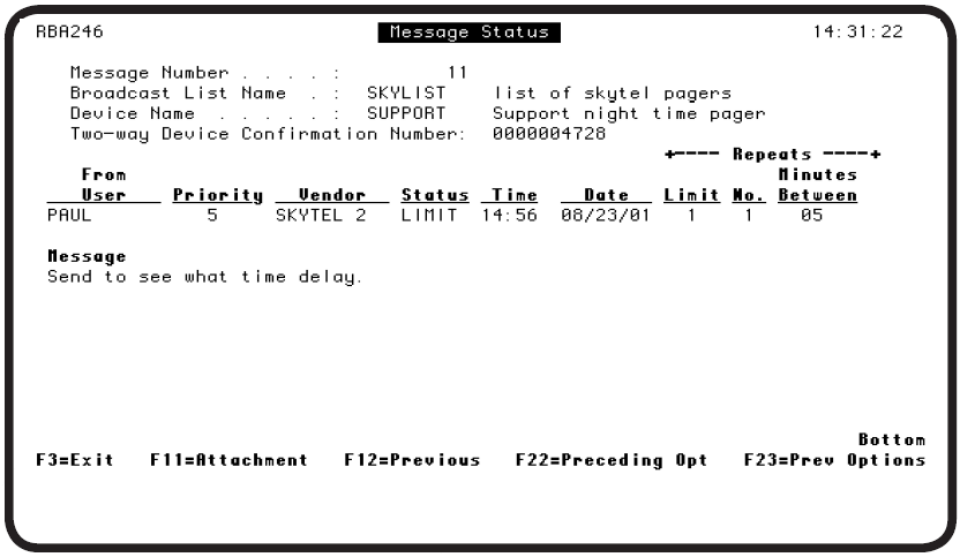
Status sorts messages alphabetically, by status.

Priority sorts messages in order of priority, 1-9 (priority 1 messages appear first).

Viewing Pending Message Queue Detail

You can view additional information about a message by selecting it with option **1** from the Pending Messages for User (Profile) panel.





Field Descriptions

Limit and No.

The limit of retries assigned to the message and the number of times Robot Alert has tried to send the message.

Between

The number of minutes Robot Alert waits before repeating the message.

Message

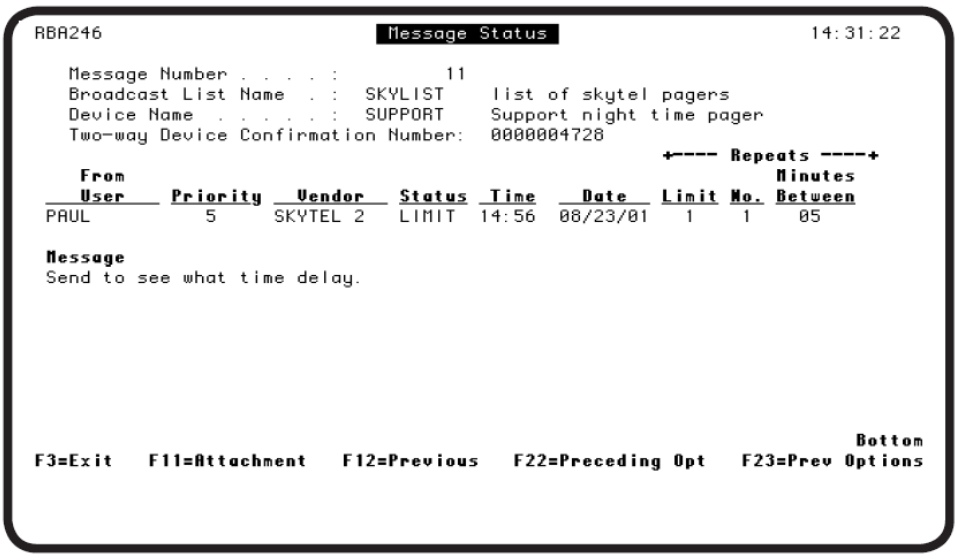
The text of the message being sent.

Error Messages

Any error messages resulting from sending the message appear at the bottom of the screen.

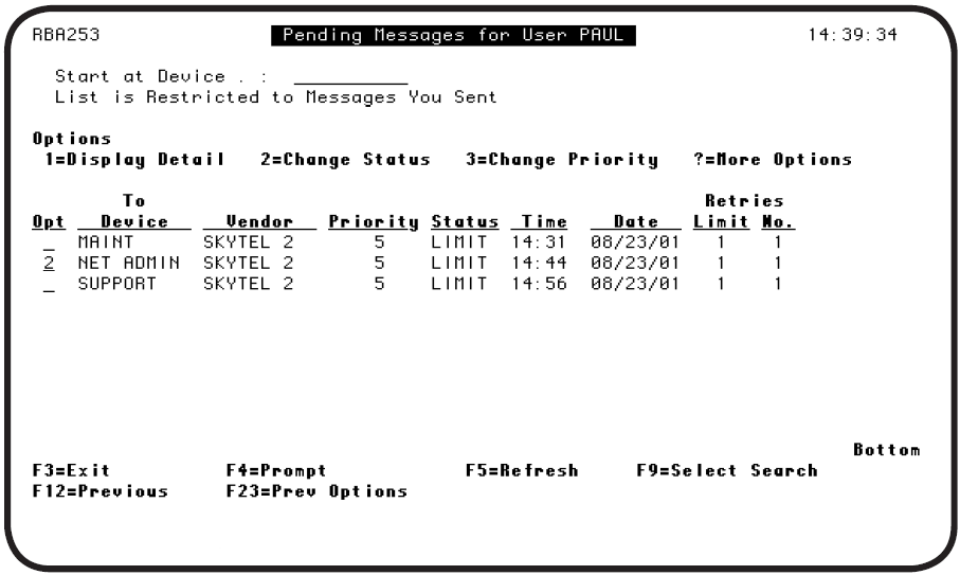
Attachments

Press **F11** to display a list of the attachments for the message.



Changing Message Status

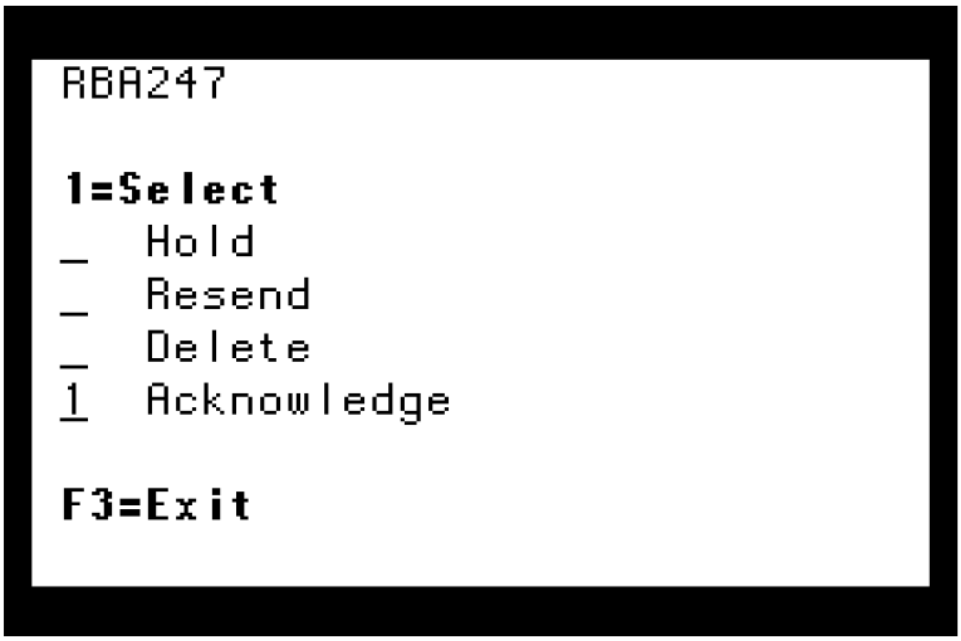
While a message is in the pending message queue, you can change its status. To hold, resend, delete, or acknowledge a message, enter option **2**, Change Status, next to the message and press Enter.

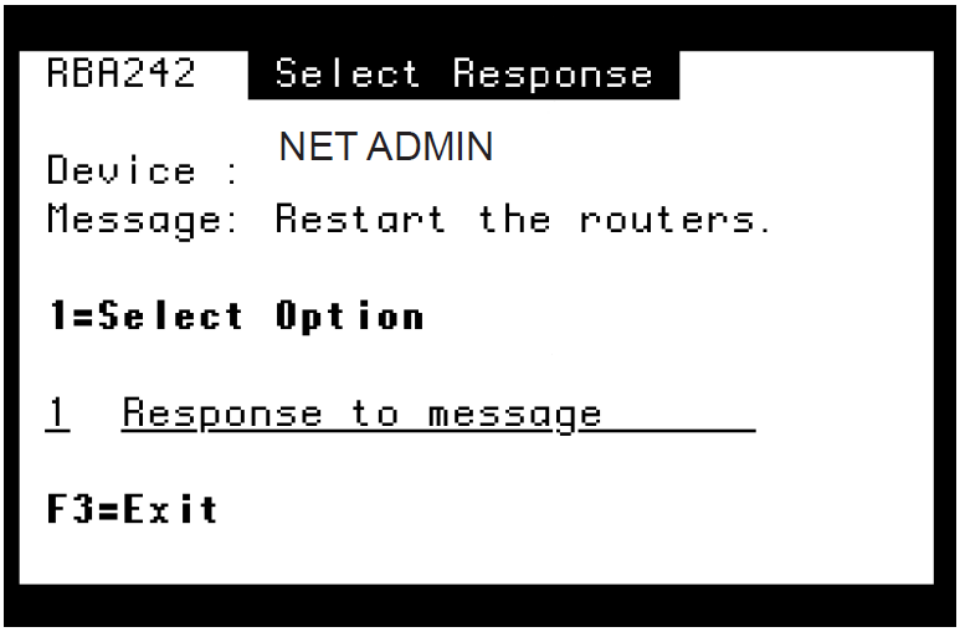


Enter **2** to change the message status.

Status	Description
Hold	Places the message on hold. If a message has a failure status, place the message on hold and have the administrator fix the problem. When the problem is fixed, use the RESEND option to retry sending the message.

Resend	Resends the message. If the message was on hold, the message is taken out of hold status and resent.
Delete	Deletes the message.
Acknowledge	Acknowledges the message so that Robot Alert will stop sending it. Available only for an unanswered response-required message. If you select Acknowledge, a panel appears offering more options (see images below).



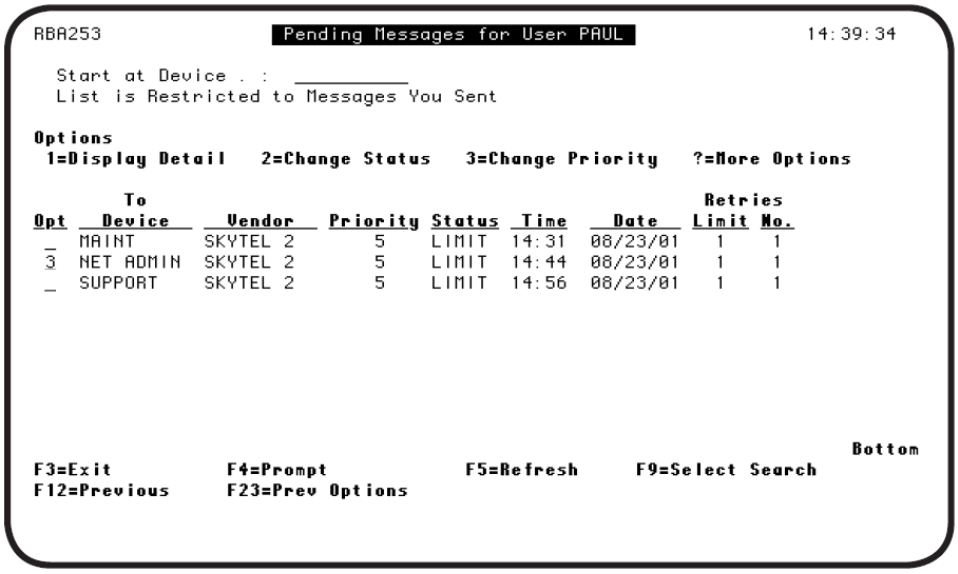


If you select Acknowledge, a panel appears allowing you to select a valid response.

- If you have restricted responses, you can select a valid response from your options by entering a 1 next to your choice and pressing Enter.
- If you defined a range for your responses (such as 1-99), you can select a response by entering a 1, overwriting the range with any valid number within the range, and pressing Enter.
- If you neither restricted responses nor entered a range, you can respond to the message with any response by entering a 1, typing your response on the line next to it, and pressing Enter (shown below).

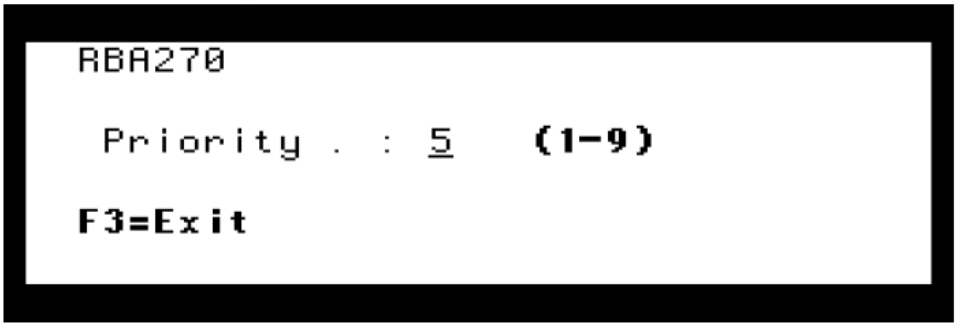
Changing Message Priority

While a message is in the pending message queue, you can change its priority. To change the message's priority, enter option **3**, Change Priority, next to the message and press Enter.



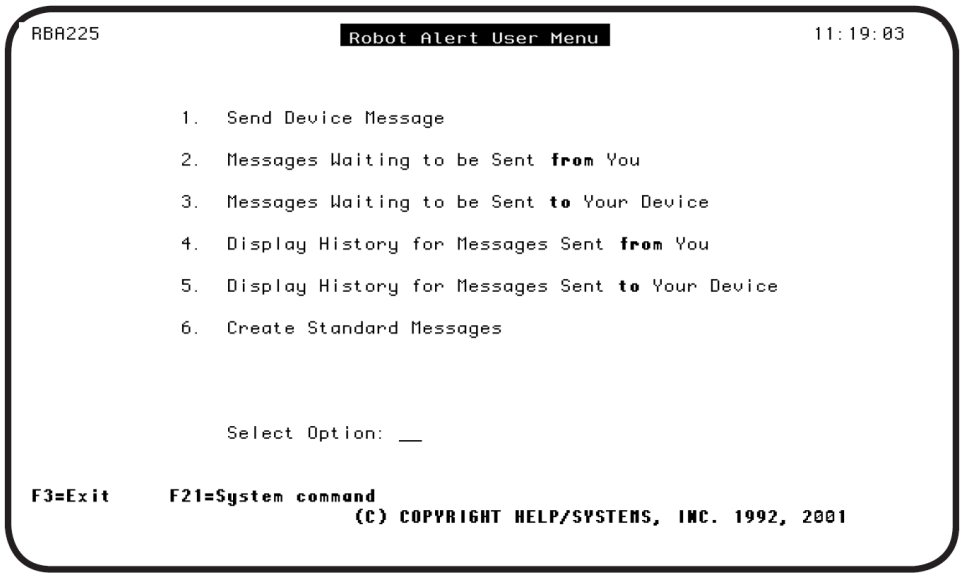
Enter **3** to change the message's priority on the queue (1 is the highest priority; 9 the lowest).

To change a message's priority, you must have the necessary security privileges.



Viewing Message History

Robot Alert keeps a history of all messages you have sent or received. From the Robot Alert User Menu, you can display the message history by selecting option **4**, Display History for Messages Sent from You, or by selecting option **5**, Display History for Messages Sent to Your Device.

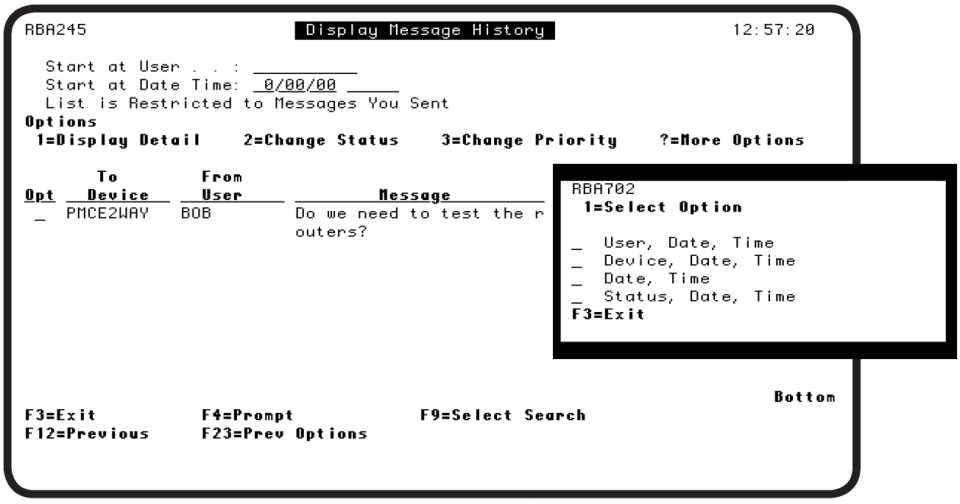


Options **4** and **5** on the Robot Alert User Menu allow you to view Robot Alert device message history.

Option **4** displays a history of device messages that you have sent.

Option **5** displays a history of messages that have been sent to your device.

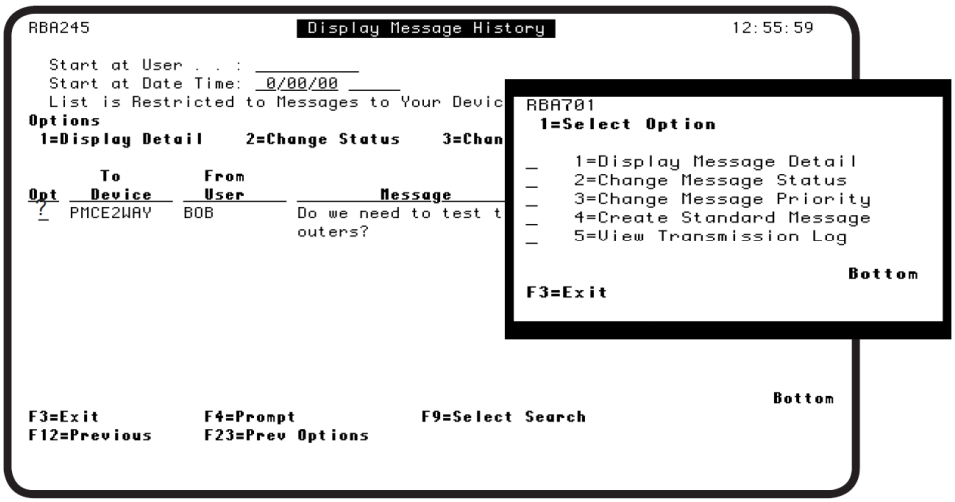
Selecting option **4** or **5** displays the Display Message History panel. The example below shows option **4**, Display History for messages Sent from You.



Press **F9** to display the history information in different ways. A window displays allowing you to search using four options. Once you have selected a search option, the history displays again, showing only the messages that met your search criteria.

Message History Options

On the Display Message History panel, you can enter a **?** in the Opt column next to a message for various device history options.



Option **1** displays detailed information for the selected message, including the response from a two-way device.

Option **2** displays a menu of statuses to select from.

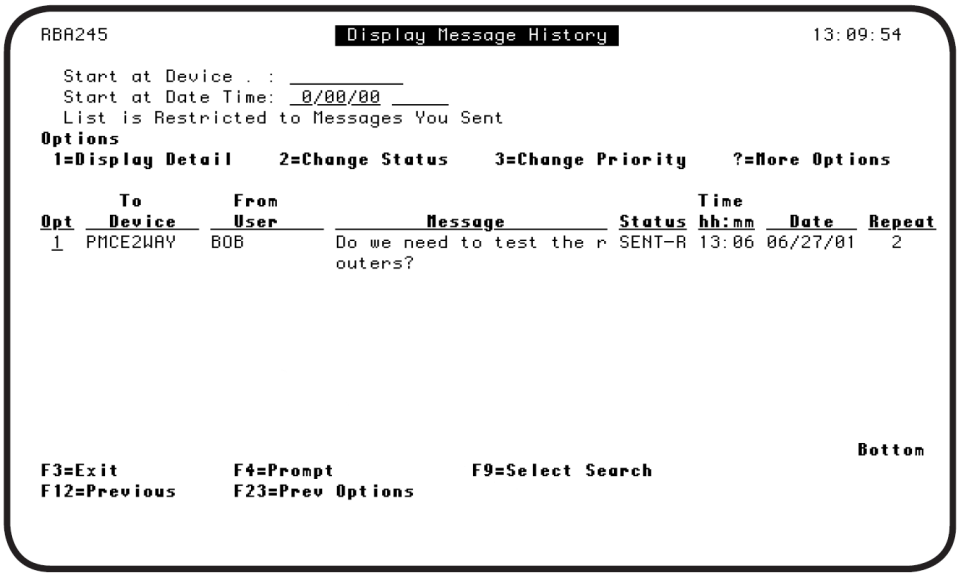
Option **3** displays a menu of priorities to select from. .

Option **4** displays the Enter Standard Message window. .

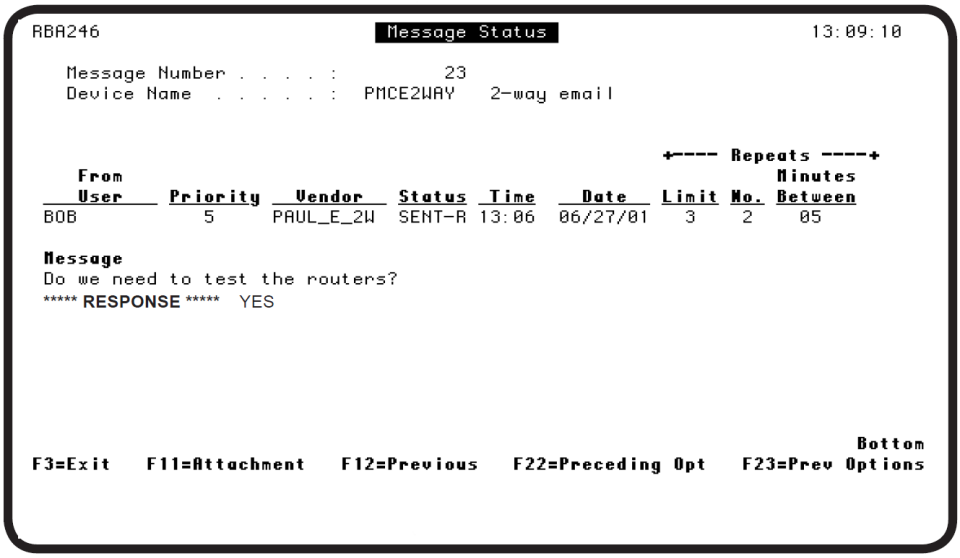
Option **5** displays the View Transmission Log panel. The log is used by the administrator to troubleshoot communication problems.

Viewing the Response from a Two-Way Device

To see the response from a two-way device, select the message with option **1** from the Display Message History panel. The Message Status panel displays the message and the response.



Select the message with option **1** to display the message response.

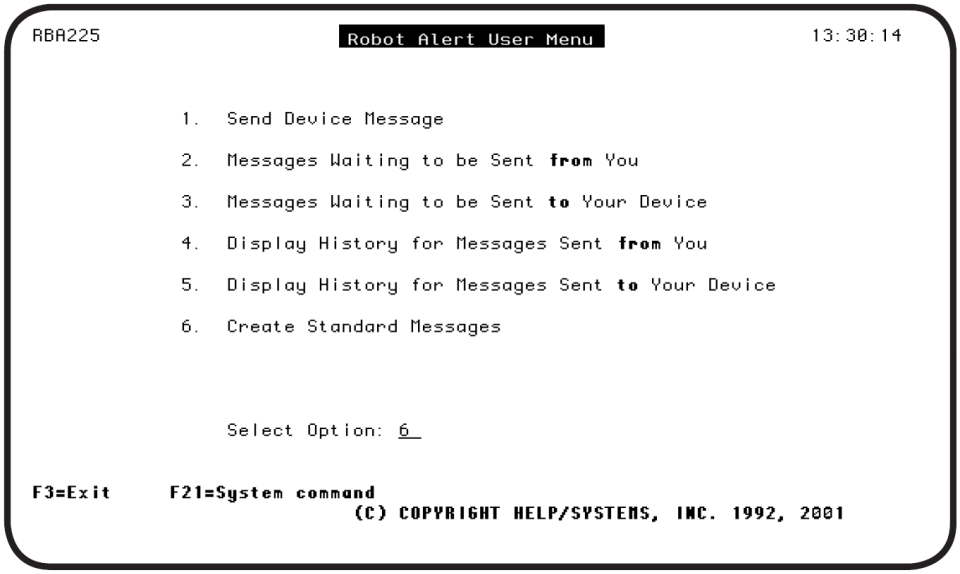


The *****RESPONSE***** YES message only displays when the two-way device has responded.

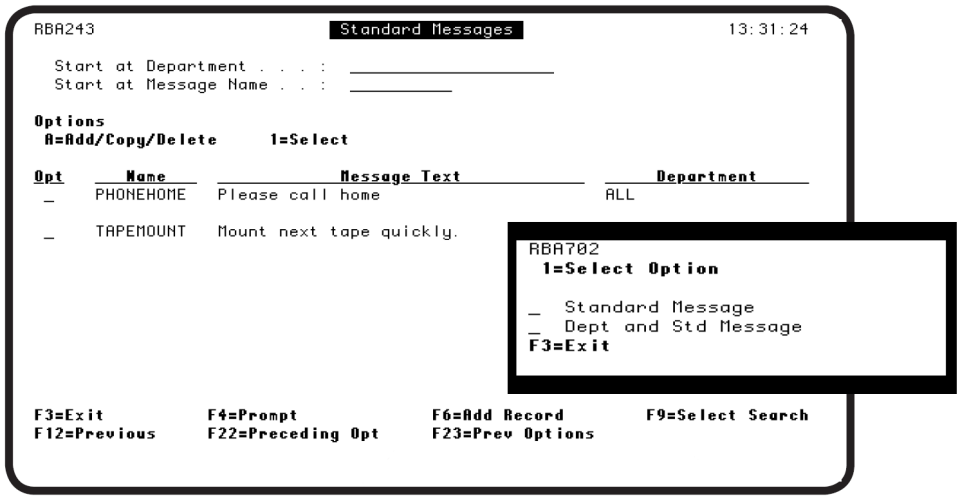
Creating Standard Messages

Standard messages are messages that you send frequently. By setting up a group of standard messages, you avoid unnecessary typing. You can also create a standard message from a message that has been sent (refer to the Message History Options topic earlier in this section).

To set up a standard message, select option **6**, Create Standard Messages, from the Robot Alert User Menu. The Standard Messages panel displays, listing all standard messages that have been created.

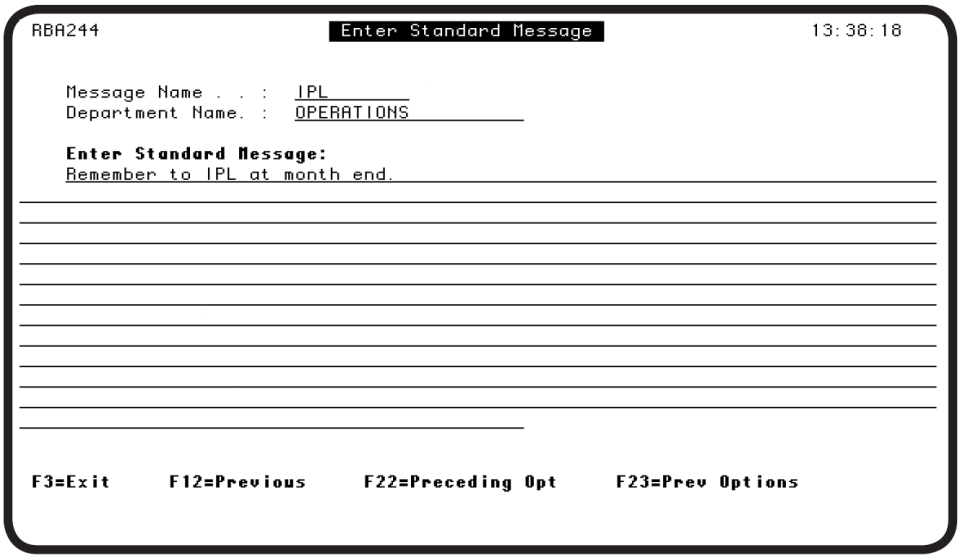


Select option **6** to access the Standard Messages panel. If you have not yet set up any standard messages, the panel will be blank.



Press **F9**, Select Search, to specify a search method. You can search by standard message, or by department and standard message.

Press **F6**, Add Record, to create a standard message. The Enter Standard Message panel displays.



Enter the name of the standard message you're creating. If this message is being created for a specific department, enter the department name. Otherwise, you can leave the Department Name field blank.

Enter the standard message text. When you're finished, press Enter. Press **F3** to return to the Standard Messages panel when you have finished entering standard messages.

Receiving Emails from Microsoft Office365 Accounts Using OAuth2 Protocol

Robot Alert can receive emails from Microsoft Office365 (Azure) accounts using the OAuth2 protocol. Use the instructions below to configure the Microsoft Azure Tenant and set up Robot Alert for this process.

System Requirements

The following are the requirements for Microsoft Azure and IBM i systems.

Microsoft Azure

- You must have Administrator rights on your Azure Tenant.
- You must use a Microsoft email account that is only used for sending and receiving Robot Alert messages.

IBM i

- IBM i 7.2 or above.
- Latest IBM PTF Cumulative.
- Digital Certificate Store enabled (usually in /QIBM/USERDATA/ICSS/CERT/SERVER/DEFAULT.KDB).
- Robot Alert 6.03 or higher.
- Firewall settings must allow the IBM i to communicate with the internet.

Configuring Microsoft Azure

Use the following steps to register a Client App named “Robot Alert” in the Azure portal.

1. In a web browser, open the Azure portal: https://portal.azure.com/#home
2. Under Manage Microsoft Entra ID, click **View**.
3. Click **App registrations** from the left menu.
4. Click **New registration**.
5. In the Name field, type Robot **Alert**.
6. In the Supported account types section, choose who can use this application or access this API by selecting the radio button next to one of the three account types. The Help me choose... link supplies definitions for the different account types.

7. Click **Register** to register the Robot Alert application. The Overview page displays information, including the Application (client) ID and Directory (tenant) ID which are used later when configuring the Robot Alert vendor.
8. Copy the Application (client) ID and Directory (tenant) ID values into a text editor to use in the Robot configuration.
9. Create a Client Secret. The client secret will be used later when creating a vendor in Robot Alert.
    a. Click **Certificates & secrets**.
    b. In the Clients secrets section, click **New client secret**.
    c. Enter a description into the Description field.
    d. Select when the client secret expires.
    e. Copy the generated client secret into a text editor as it is required later. The value will be hidden on return to this screen.

    > **IMPORTANT:** Copy the client secret value immediately because it will not be displayed again after the initial creation.

    > **TIP:** You can add a new secret at any time and delete the old one, but you then have to update the Robot Alert vendor.

10. Add API Permissions for Microsoft Graph. Adding API permissions allows applications to access the configured resources.
    a. Click **API permissions**.
    b. Click **Add a permission**.
    c. Select **Microsoft Graph**.
    d. Select **Application permissions**.
    e. Scroll down to **Mail** and expand the option.
    f. Select **Mail.ReadWrite**.

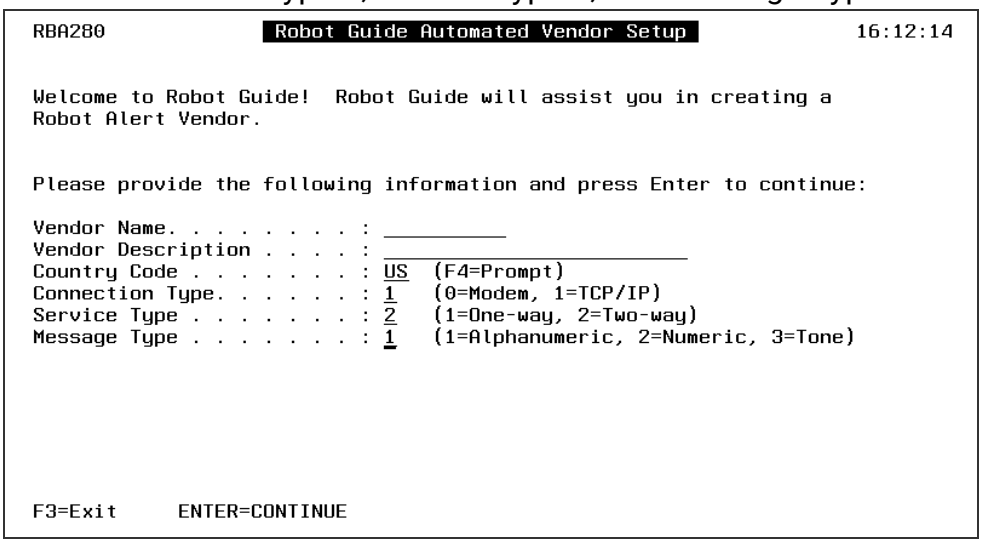
    > **NOTE:** Mail.Send is not required.

11. Ensure that the following values are copied and available for the configuration of Robot Alert.
    - The OAuth Server Name (SNI): (www.graph.microsoft.com)
    - The Tenant ID for the account.
    - The Client ID for the Robot Alert App.
    - The Client Secret for the Robot Alert App.

Robot Alert IBM i Vendor Configuration

Use the following steps to create a vendor that uses OAuth protocol.

1. From the Robot Alert Administration Menu, select option **3**, Directory Menu.
2. From the Directory Menu, select option **1**, Vendor Maintenance Menu.
3. From the Vendor Maintenance Menu, select option **1** to create a vendor using Robot Guide.
4. Enter a Vendor Name, Vendor Description, and Country Code.
5. Enter Connection Type **1**, Service Type **2**, and Message Type **1**.



6. Press **Enter** to continue.
7. Select OAUTH Protocol by entering **1** on the Opt line in front of OAUTH.
8. Press **Enter** to continue.
9. For Outbound Information, enter your Outbound TCP/IP Host.
10. For Reply Information, enter the Microsoft Email Address that you have set up to only be used for Robot Alert.
11. Press **Enter** to continue.
12. Enter the OAUTH Server Name (SNI), Tenant ID, Client ID and Client Secret as saved from the Microsoft Azure account.

    Press **Enter** to continue and save the vendor.
13. After the vendor has been created, you are given the option to create devices.

Appendix

The topics in this section include additional information about Robot Alert.

Commands

RBAACK

Acknowledges a response-required device message. You can select the messages to be acknowledged by device ID, broadcast list, device queue, vendor, message number, and/or message text.

RBAALTDEV

Allows you to create or remove alternate devices. Alternate devices are devices that are used when the primary device is in a held state at the time it is needed.

RBAAUTOSTR

Allows you to indicate whether or not you would like Robot Alert to start automatically with the subsystem RBTSYSLIB/RBTSLEEPER.

RBACFGMDM

Allows you to configure your modem by specifying the line description.

RBACFGSMS

Allows you to configure a SMS 2-way terminal.

RBADEDCOM

Allows you to dedicate a communication job to a specific vendor.

RBADRGAPP

Prepares the instance of Robot Alert for activities such as being the target of HA/DR replication on a backup partition, moving the instance to another system, deleting the instance, or switching swappable disk subsystem to another system.

RBAEND

Stops Robot Alert transmission jobs.

RBAGUIDE

Starts the Robot GUIDE Automated Setup process.

RBAHLDALR

Puts Robot Alert on hold status or releases it from hold status, depending on the option you select. When Robot Alert is on hold it continues to receive messages and queue them by priority, but it will not send any messages until it is released. This command is useful when you're updating a Fortra product on your system.

RBAHLDCOMJ

Holds or releases a Robot Alert communication job. A communication job is held as soon as it completes processing. Releasing a communication job does not restart it—it cannot be restarted until Robot Alert is released.

RBAHLDDEV

Holds or releases a Robot Alert device. Releasing a held device with the PURGE option removes all held messages created for the device. After a device is held, any messages sent to the device have a HELD-D status if no alternate device is specified. Broadcast lists cannot be held or used as alternate devices; devices on broadcast lists can be alternate devices.

RBAHLDVND

Holds or releases all Robot Alert devices attached to a specific vendor. Releasing a held device with the PURGE option removes all held messages created for the device. After a device is held, any messages sent to the device have a HELD-D status if no alternate device is specified. Broadcast lists cannot be held or used as alternate devices; devices on broadcast lists can be alternate devices.

RBAINSTALL

Allows you to install Robot Alert.

RBALOCK

Allows you to lock or unlock Robot Alert.

RBAREADY

Gives failed device messages a READY status so they can be resent. You can select the messages by device ID, broadcast list, vendor, message number, and message text.

RBAREGAPP

Prepares the instance of Robot Alert for use.

RBASNDLST

Displays the Select Device panel. Use this panel to select the device IDs or broadcast lists to which you want to send a message.

RBASNDMDM

Allows you to send a modem command by specifying the line description.

RBASNDMSG

Displays the Send Device Message (RBASNDMSG) panel. Use this panel to enter a device message to be sent by your program to the specified device ID or broadcast list.

RBASTATUS

Gives messages with a specific status a READY status so they can be resent. You can select the status (FAIL-V, FAIL-P, FAIL-R, HOLD, or LIMIT) and the messages by device ID, broadcast list, vendor, message number, and message text.

RBASTR

Causes Robot Alert to start transmitting device messages.

RBASWAP

Lets you switch vendors without going into the device maintenance panels. You can switch vendors for one device, or all devices.

RBASYNCLIN

Lets you change the alert line description.

RBAUSER

Displays the Robot Alert User Menu.

RBTALR

Displays the Robot Alert Main Menu.

Modem Objects

The following objects are created for each modem communication job defined to Robot Alert:

Library	Object Name	Object Type	Description
QSYS	RBALnn	*LIND	Line Description
QSYS	RBACnn	*CTLD	Control Unit Description
QSYS	RBADnn	*DEVD	Device Description

Glossary

Broadcast List

Lists that allow you to send the same message to multiple devices for the following reasons:

- To page a group of people who always receive the same message
- To page the person on duty automatically
- To notify the next person in the chain of command as part of an automatic problem escalation system

There is no limit to the number of broadcast lists, or the number of lists on which a device can be listed. You can secure a device name so only a select group can send messages to it. The broadcast list time restriction function requires Robot Schedule, Fortra's job scheduler. You can enter a special work calendar for your broadcast list into Robot Schedule.

Communication Job

Batch jobs that take communication requests from the Traffic Manager and make the actual connection to the vendor. Communication jobs can be either TCP/IP or modem.

Device

Any object to which you can send a message to and/or receive a message from. This includes (but is not limited to) cell phones, pagers, workstations, and hand-held devices such as palmtop computers (Palm) and Personal Digital Assistant (PDA) devices.

Email Client

An application end users can use to create and send email, download email from an account on an email server, and manage their downloaded email. Users must use email clients to send and receive email.

Email Server

An application that runs on a server, stores email and processes incoming requests. An email server creates email messages from client requests, transfers mail to other email servers, receives mail from other email servers, stores email messages and transfers email messages to email clients. End users do not access email servers directly.

Paging Vendor

A company that offers paging service by providing dial-up lines into their systems so products, like Robot Alert, can send pager messages. Some paging vendors offer the ability to send messages over the Internet as an alternative to using a dial-up line.

Palm Top Computer

A handheld electronic organizer that fits into a shirt pocket, usually contains an address book, scheduler, and to-do list, and can download email. Users use a pen interface and Graffiti handwriting recognition to enter data. HotSync technology synchronizes data between the palm computer and a PC. Also called a Palm.

PDA

A Personal Digital Assistant (PDA) is a handheld computer that serves as an organizer for personal information. It generally includes at least a name and address database, to-do list and note taker. PDAs are pen-based, using a stylus to tap selections on menus and to enter printed characters, and may also include a small on-screen keyboard which is tapped with the pen. Data is synchronized between the PDA and desktop computer via cable or wireless transmission.

POP3

Post Office Protocol, version 3 (POP3) is the TCP/IP and Internet standard for retrieving email messages from the email server. POP3 is a protocol that is used to talk to email servers to download email messages. Most email servers support the POP3 protocol. Email servers that support POP3 exclusively are referred to as POP servers. POP3 and SMTP work together to send and receive emails. POP3 is defined as an Internet Standard in the following RFC documents:

RFC 1939 – Post Office Protocol – Version 3
RFC 1957 – Some Observations on Implementations of the Post Office Protocol (POP3)
RFC 2449 – POP3 Extension Mechanism

Protocol

A detailed specification outlining how to make one computer communicate with another, usually on a different system. For Robot Alert, protocol refers to the programs used to communicate with various paging vendors and email servers.

RFC Documents

Request for Comment (RFC) documents are used to define Internet standards, and can be located at http://sunsite.auc.dk/RFC, or other places, on the Internet.

Safe and Non-Safe Characters

Characters are classified as Safe or Non-Safe for email encoding. The Non-Safe character set contains all the Safe characters plus several other characters which must be handled differently on an EBCDIC platform (defined in RFC document 1521).

Safe and Non-Safe Character Sets

Safe Characters

%&'*+-0123456789
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZabcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

Non-Safe Characters

!"#$().:;<=>?[\]^_{|}¬‘%&'*+-0123456789
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZabcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

The following characters must be encoded:

!"#$().:;<=>?[\]^_{|}¬‘

SMTP

Simple Mail Transfer Protocol (SMTP), a protocol used to talk to email servers and send email messages, is the TCP/IP and Internet standard for sending email. Most major email servers support the SMTP protocol, and email servers that support SMTP exclusively are referred to as SMTP servers. SMTP and POP3 work together to send and receive emails.

The SMTP protocol is defined as an Internet standard in the following RFC documents:

RFC 821 – Simple Mail Transfer Protocol
RFC 1869 – SMTP Service Extensions
RFC 1870 – SMTP Service Extensions for Message Size Declaration

SNPP

Simple Network Paging Protocol (SNPP), the protocol used to talk to the paging vendors over the Internet, is a TCP/IP standard for using the Internet to send pager messages. The SNPP protocol is defined as an Internet standard in RFC 1861 - Simple Network Paging Protocol - Version 3 - Two-way Enhanced.

Standard Message

Messages that you send frequently. By setting up a group of standard messages, you can avoid unnecessary typing because Robot Alert allows you to save and reuse these messages. You can also create a standard message from a message that has been sent.

TCP/IP

A collection of networking protocols that have been used to construct the global Internet. The name is taken from two of the fundamental protocols in the collection, Transmission Control Protocol (TCP) and Internet Protocol (IP). These protocols work together to provide a basic networking framework that is used by many different application protocols, each tuned to achieving a particular goal.

Traffic Manager

The job that monitors for incoming messages and performs many important functions. The Traffic Manager sorts messages by communication type, vendor, and priority, and packages them into communication requests. The Traffic Manager also starts the communication jobs and performs error checking on them at regular intervals.

Traffic Manager 2

The job that keeps track, using a timer, of when to process message replies.

Two-Way Device

A device that can receive a message and send a response.

Two-Way Message

A response-required message sent to a two-way device. Robot Alert performs two-way messaging by sending a message to a two-way device and checking for a response from that device at a later time.